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Happening today

● **RCB'S PURSUIT** of back-to-back IPL titles will run into the season's most disciplined bowling attack when they face Gujarat Titans in Qualifier 1, with a direct place in the final at stake. Both ended league stage on 18 points but RCB claimed the top spot due to better net run rate.

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THE WORLD



IRAN'S TOP ENVOYS IN QATAR TO DISCUSS DEAL TO END WAR [PAGE 12](#)

Nation's best DMs: Entries for Indian Express Governance Awards open until June 30



Express News Service
New Delhi, May 25

THE FOURTH edition of The Indian Express Excellence in Governance Awards is open for entries until June 30, with a distinguished jury set to evaluate innovations in public administration across 15 categories.

Launched in 2019, the awards honour District Magistrates nationwide for innovations that have positively impacted citizen welfare and government efficiency — and help spread best practices across government, innovation, leadership and learning.



SCAN THE QR CODE TO APPLY

Applications are open across 15 categories including education, healthcare, swachhata, gender and inclusion, social welfare, agriculture, e-governance, skill development, MSME and industries, start-up and innovations, climate change and sustainability, water, energy, urban governance and livability and jury awards.

The jury for this edition [»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2](#)

‘CYNICAL NARRATIVE BEING GENERATED... INDIA CANNOT AFFORD FEAR-MONGERING’

Sitharaman flags ‘3F’ concerns: Fuel, fertiliser, foreign exchange

Says ‘unimaginable’ hike in fertiliser prices, high crude and gold prices creating ‘challenges on external front’

Akash Mandal & Siddharth Upasani
Mumbai, New Delhi, May 25

UNDERLINING PRIME Minister Narendra Modi's call earlier this month to conserve foreign exchange, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday emphasised the importance of “three Fs: fuel, fertiliser and foreign exchange”.

Taking on critics of the Indian economy amid the ongoing West Asia crisis, Sitharaman said the naysayers were creating a “cynical narrative”. Not only is this wrong, but it is also “fear-mongering” and “India cannot afford fear-mongering”, she said.

Sitharaman was speaking at

Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



the 37th foundation day event of the Small Industries [»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2](#)

E. EXPLAINED

Fertiliser & forex

In 2025-26, India imported 28.2 million tonnes of fertilisers worth \$14 billion. But the actual figure, inclusive of the value of imported inputs such as natural gas and ammonia, was over \$27 billion and could soar even higher in the current fiscal. [REPORT, PAGE 8](#)

INSIDE [PAGES 9, 13](#)
SHOULD RBI DEFEND RUPEE, OR LET IT FALL?

GOVT DIALS STATES TO WATCH SUPPLY AT OMC PUMPS

Four hikes in 11 days: Petrol, diesel prices now up by over Rs 7/litre

OMC losses down, but still about Rs 600 cr/day

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, May 25

AFTER HOLDING retail fuel prices for over two-and-a-half months amid the surge in global rates due to the West Asia crisis, public sector oil marketing companies (OMCs) have hiked the prices of petrol and diesel by over Rs 7 per litre in less than two weeks.

While seemingly steep, the cumulative price increase so far

• RISING PRICES

	Retail price (₹/litre)	Price hike (₹/litre)		
	Petrol	Diesel	Petrol	Diesel
May 25	102.12	95.2	2.61	2.71
May 23	99.51	92.49	0.87	0.91
May 19	98.64	91.58	0.87	0.91
May 15	97.77	90.67	3	3

Petroleum Planning & Analysis Cell; Delhi prices

— done through four hikes — has been the lowest among [»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2](#)

Karnataka change of guard on agenda as Siddaramaiah, DKS called to Delhi for talks



Karnataka CM Siddaramaiah, his deputy D K Shivakumar and Congress MP Randeep Singh Surjewala in Bengaluru, Monday. PTI

Manoj CG
New Delhi, May 25

THE CONGRESS high command has summoned Karnataka Chief Minister Siddaramaiah and Deputy CM D K Shivakumar to Delhi for a discussion Tuesday on leadership change, a complex and tricky topic that it has been deflecting for some months.

Sources in the party said the leadership wants to address the

issue and put an end to the power tussle between the two and the persistent bickering in the state.

Sources said leadership change would be on the table when Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, Leader of the Opposition (LoP) Rahul Gandhi, AICC general secretaries K C Venugopal and Randeep Singh Surjewala meet the two leaders separately and together. [»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2](#)

CITY [PAGE 4](#)



SC SAYS CBI MUST ‘IMMEDIATELY’ PROBE TWISHA DEATH

Blocking of X handle: ‘Cockroach Janta Party’ founder moves Delhi HC

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, May 25

ABHIJEET DIPKE, the founder of the satirical online platform ‘Cockroach Janta Party’ or CJP, has moved the Delhi High Court against the blocking of the CJP's X handle.

Padma Vibhushan for Dharmendra

President Droupadi Murmu with BJP MP and actor Hema Malini, who received the Padma Vibhushan on behalf of her late husband, actor Dharmendra, at Rashtrapati Bhavan, Monday. PTI: [PAGE 7](#)



CITY [PAGE 4](#)



GYMKHANA MEMBER MOVES HC, SAYS ORDER MALICIOUS

AFTER DAWOOD AIDE BROUGHT BACK ON APRIL 28

India working on extradition of another drug kingpin, criminal from Turkey

Divya A
New Delhi, May 25

JUST WEEKS after the extradition of Salim Dola, an alleged drug trafficker and close associate of fugitive don Dawood Ibrahim, from Turkey, New Delhi and Ankara are learnt to be

working on the extradition of two more criminals wanted by India — Navpreet Singh from Punjab, who is wanted in several narcotics-related cases, and Mohammad Sartaj from Madhya Pradesh, linked to cases involving threats and violence. Dola, who is allegedly

linked to international drug syndicates, was extradited to India on April 28. His return reinforced the security partnership between India and Turkey, which faced strain in their ties for the past year or so. Earlier this month, another [»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2](#)



3 ‘illegal Bangla immigrants’ housed at centre in Murshidabad

Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata, May 25

WITHIN 48 hours of the West Bengal BJP government ordering establishment of holding centres in all districts across the state for essentially Bangladeshis and Rohingya, a detention facility was opened in Murshidabad, while preparations are on to set up another in Malda. A senior district police officer told *The Indian Express* that three people suspected to be illegal immigrants from Bangladesh had already been brought to the Murshidabad centre.

Both Malda and Murshida-

bad border Bangladesh. In an order dated May 23, the Bengal Home & Hill Affairs Department had ordered all district magistrates to set up ‘holding centres’ for illegal Bangladeshis and Rohingya in their areas in the state.

The three-storey building in [»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2](#)

● **VISHAL HAD TROUBLE WALKING SINCE HE WAS BORN WITH KNOCK KNEES; ‘I TOLD MYSELF THAT IF YOU HAVE TO BECOME GREAT, YOU HAVE TO MAKE SACRIFICES,’ HE SAYS**

From standing knee-deep in sand as a child to India’s fastest quarter-miler

Pritish Raj
Ranchi, May 25

THIRTEEN YEARS back, when Thennarasu took his son, Vishal T K, to a stadium in Jolarpet town in Tamil Nadu, it wasn't to make him a runner. His son had trouble walking since he was born with knockknees. Thennarasu, a dairy farmer who had played football for the state, had heard that burying his child's legs knee-deep in the long jump pit could help straighten them.

When at the stadium, after his daily stand-pit ritual, Vishal would sit and watch long-distance runners. Then one day,

he joined them and thus began his track and field journey. On Saturday in Ranchi, Vishal, 23, crossed the 400m finish line in 44.98 seconds — the first Indian in history to go below 45. Thennarasu raced onto the track and the two embraced.

“What I felt after he crossed the finish line can't be expressed in words,” Thennarasu said. “Not even in my dreams.” He paused. “But when he started progressing and doing well, I could see he had a hunger to win and one day he would do something big.”

India has a proud history of quarter-milers. The country's most celebrated runner

happens to be the late Milkha Singh who had clocked 45.6 seconds in 1960 Rome Olympics.

Like Milkha, Vishal's tale too has many hardships. He left home at a young age to move to the Sports Hostel in Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium in Tamil Nadu. He ran 100m and 200m and was good at it. He had no plans to change.

“The stadium became my home at a very early age. I used to miss my parents a lot and didn't have any idea about the magnitude of what I could achieve,” he said. “But I told myself that if you have to become great, you have to make sacrifices. I never thought of running 400m,” he said. “But



Vishal T K with his father, Thennarasu, after becoming the first Indian to run a sub-45 seconds 400 metres race. AFI

my coach Sreenivasan told me I would do much better at the quarter-mile.”

Sreenivasan had scouted

him through the Sports Development Authority of Tamil Nadu programme and his first thought was simple: Why is this

guy running 100 and 200m? “I have seen the anatomical structure of his body. He is a tall runner and his speed is very good. He didn't have the explosive strength of a 100m sprinter but his tall frame and strides were really good for 400m. I was convinced he would do well in the 400m,” Sreenivasan said. “It took me some time to convince him.”

Vishal was 21. Switching events at that age — abandoning years of training — is not a decision athletes take on a whim. “I trust my coach. I knew if I give 100%, new or old event, doesn't matter.” In 2024, Vishal clocked 46.77 seconds as his season best. Good enough to

earn a call to the national camp and a meeting with Australian coach Jason Dawson.

Dawson had a reputation for demanding total commitment from his athletes. He had been frustrated by national campers who came and went. Vishal came and stayed. “He just asked me to trust him and we'll get the results,” Vishal said. “I told him — coach, I'm all yours. Just make me a better runner.”

Sreenivasan, who gave up his own charge of Vishal to send him to Dawson, told him: “I know the basics but Jason will take you to the world level.” Three months after clocking his first sub-46 run — 45.57 seconds at the Asian Athletics Cham-

pionships in May 2025, missing the podium by 0.02 seconds — Vishal shattered the national record at the Inter-State Championships with 45.12 seconds. Then, in Ranchi, 44.98.

“He took me from 46.77 to 44.98,” Vishal said. “I trust him blindly and so does he.”

The father with modest goals of taking his son to the stadium so that he could walk normally, never imagined he would be flying on the track one day to enter the record books. And when it happened, he ran across a track to hold his son — the fastest Indian quarter-miler who has ever lived. Thennarasu didn't say anything for some time. He just held on.

LIKELY TO BE RAZED

PWD inspection finds ‘structural flaws’ in Kolkata’s 70-ft Messi statue

Tanusree Bose
Kolkata, May 25

KOLKATA'S ICONIC 70-foot statue of Lionel Messi, unveiled last year by the football superstar himself, could now be removed after an inspection, following a complaint by the local residents, found “structural flaws” in it.

The Public Works Department on Monday conducted a formal inspection of the statue, and found that it had “structural deficiencies” and its centre of gravity was “off the mark”, triggering safety concerns, sources in the administration said.

The sources shared that it has been decided by the authorities to remove the structure after the inspection conducted within hours of a complaint filed by residents.

Earlier in the day, a police complaint said to be filed by some local residents alleged that merely five months after its installation, the statue was noticeably “swaying” or “shaking” whenever the city saw strong winds.

The complaint, lodged at the Lake Town Police Station, had sought immediate action from the authorities concerned, with some residents seeking repairs or even permanent relocation of the statue to prevent any untoward incidents, the police said.

The statue, near the Lake Town Clock Tower, was unveiled on December 13, 2025, when Messi visited Kolkata to kick off his GOAT India tour. But within about five months, it could now be demolished or relocated — following suit days after the football statue outside the Salt Lake Stadium was removed.

A labourer present at the site of the statue told reporters, “From the feet to the body, the statue is shaking. It is possible



The statue was unveiled when football icon Lionel Messi visited Kolkata last year

that something below has cracked. The entire statue is shaking. If such strong winds continue, it may even fall.”

Following the complaint, the police contacted the local administration and the South Dum Dum Municipality. The District Magistrate then directed engineers from the PWD to inspect the structure. Within hours, the PWD engineers submitted a report stating that the structure is in a bad condition and could fall in the incoming monsoon rains, sources said.

They added the PWD claimed the government had not obtained a no objection certificate before installing the statue on what they claimed was PWD land. Due to these concerns, it has now been decided to remove the statue. Controversies have surrounded the Messi statue ever since its inauguration. Back then, football fans had complained on social media that the statue did not resemble the football icon.

Police to act against 2 Kanpur hospitals after ITBP jawan’s mother loses hand

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, May 25

A FRESH medical inquiry report has found “gross negligence” on the part of two private hospitals that allegedly delayed treating an ITBP jawan’s mother, resulting in her right hand being amputated. The report noted that critical delays and lapses in treatment ultimately led to the amputation.

An initial inquiry conducted by a medical panel constituted by Kanpur’s CMO was deemed inconclusive, with officials saying it failed to establish accountability for the alleged lapses in treatment.

“The fresh report has identified the delay in treatment by the hospitals as gross negligence. We are now proceeding to register a case against the two hospitals where the victim was treated,” said Additional Commissioner of Police (Kanpur) Vipin Tada. The complainant, Vikas Singh from Fatehpur, is posted with the 32nd Battalion of the Indo-Tibetan Border Police at Maharajpur in Kanpur.

Last Saturday, senior ITBP officials arrived at the Kanpur Police Commissionerate, along

with several personnel, to raise concerns over the case. Initially, the presence of a sizeable contingent outside the police office triggered rumours that paramilitary personnel had “gheraoed” the commissionerate. But both the police and the ITBP denied the claims and clarified that the meeting had been scheduled in advance.

Kanpur Police Commissioner Raghuraj Lal had said there had been no confrontation or disagreement between the police and the paramilitary force. According to him, the ITBP Commandant and Medical Officer had been formally invited to discuss certain aspects of the inquiry so they could be re-examined in greater detail.

A police officer added that once reports of an alleged stand-off began circulating in the media, the ITBP Commandant was immediately asked to withdraw the personnel to avoid further misunderstanding. The Commissioner said that in connection with the matter, a letter has been sent to the ITBP Headquarters and its Director General that a departmental and disciplinary inquiry should be conducted at the level concerned.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Sitharaman flags ‘3F’

Development Bank of India (SIDBI) in Mumbai.

She said Modi’s appeals must be understood in the right context. “We should please understand the context of these three Fs: fuel, fertiliser and foreign exchange. And the foreign exchange, in this context, is the purchase of gold. So, we need to understand this and we should also appreciate that the challenges are more externally driven. We must also recognise that India’s domestic economic situation remains positive and resilient even today,” she said.

She said that high and volatile international crude oil prices, along with an “unimaginable” increase in fertiliser prices and high gold prices, were creating “some challenges on the external front”.

However, she said, India remains a robust economy. She added that the “naysayers” who say that “it’s all falling down, it’s crumbling” were those who want to “decry the achievements of our own people”.

“And therefore, ... all the good that is being done by the common people themselves, that is forgotten, and a pessimistic, cynical narrative is generated, which is just not right. It’s not right is one thing, but it is wrong because it is fear-mongering. India cannot afford fear-mongering. We need to give confidence to the people with our words and with our actions, and that’s what you’re seeing at various levels,” the Finance Minister said.

Earlier this month, Modi urged the public to change their consumption behaviour by reviving Covid-era measures such as work-from-home and virtual meetings, avoiding non-essential foreign travel and gold purchases for a year, and prioritising local goods, among others. These actions would help save the country’s foreign exchange reserves as most of these activities and purchases require import.

Since then, the government has announced a host of measures to stem the rupee’s fall. Plagued by continued foreign

fund outflows from the domestic financial markets -- Foreign Portfolio Investors have dumped Indian bonds and stocks worth \$24.4 billion since the war began in late February -- and weak net Foreign Direct Investment inflows, the rupee has slumped by nearly 5% since February 27 and almost breached the 97-per-dollar mark last week.

Since then, it has gained some ground and closed at 95.23 per-dollar on Monday, with the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) said to have intervened heavily in the last few days to stop the rupee from falling further. This has taken a heavy toll on the RBI’s forex reserves. As on May 15, the reserves were down around \$40 billion compared to pre-war levels. Further, the RBI’s gross forex sales of \$29.6 billion in March was the highest in 13 months and occurred even as net FDI during the month was in positive territory for the second month running.

Meanwhile, some of the measures taken by the government to save forex include a sharp hike in the import duty on gold, silver and platinum; restrictions on duty-free gold im-

ports under a key export scheme; and four price hikes for petrol and diesel sold at retail pumps.

As the rupee repeatedly touches new all-time lows, economists have warned that India faces a Balance of Payments deficit for the third straight year in 2026-27. With inflation likely to increase in the coming months due to the energy shock, and growth predicted to take a hit, experts have warned that India faces a crisis.

The RBI’s latest forecast, made in early April, pegs India’s GDP growth in 2026-27 at 6.9%. However, economists have been warning over the last month or so that growth this year could be closer to 6-6.5%. The central bank’s Monetary Policy Committee, which will meet on June 3-5, cut the policy repo rate by 125 basis points to 5.25% in 2025 and has not made any changes to it so far in 2026. But some economists are increasingly seeing the possibility of an interest rate hike as early as next month due to the upside risks to inflation from the elevated global crude oil prices and the rapidly weakening rupee.

Petrol, diesel now up by over Rs 7 per litre

major economies globally and pump prices in India are still among the lowest in the world, except for countries that heavily subsidise fuel prices, according to industry sources.

Prior to these price increases, the OMCs were incurring cumulative daily under-recoveries of about Rs 1,000 crore on petrol, diesel and liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) sold to households. Although domestic LPG prices have not been hiked since early March, the increase in petrol and diesel prices has reduced the losses to under Rs 600 crore per day now, Petroleum Ministry Joint Secretary Sujata Sharma said Monday. She didn’t comment on how much fuel prices could be increased going forward.

In the latest revision, the price of petrol was hiked by Rs 2.61 to Rs 102.12 per litre in Delhi, while diesel price went up by Rs 2.71 to Rs 95.20 per litre, with corresponding changes in other parts of the country.

Fuel prices vary across India due to differences in state-level levies. Since May 15, when the first fuel price hike in over four years was announced, petrol price has gone up by Rs 7.35 per litre, while diesel is up by Rs 7.53 per litre in Delhi, an increase of 7.7% and 8.6%, respectively.

According to industry sources and analysts, the quantum of price hikes effected so far will ease the pressure on the OMCs — Indian Oil, Bharat Petroleum and Hindustan Petroleum — although they are still retailing petrol and diesel below the market price. More cali-

brated and staggered price hikes cannot be ruled out yet.

Prashant Vasisht, senior vice president and co-group head, corporate ratings, ICRA, said the OMCs’ losses despite the four rounds of hikes remain “unsustainable”. “The under-recoveries of oil marketing companies remain stubbornly high due to increasing losses in domestic LPG sales, and high premium to the crude marker. ICRA estimates that at crude price of \$120-125/barrel and considering past 10-year average crack spreads of auto fuels, oil marketing companies are incurring a loss of about Rs 700-800 crore daily on the sale of auto fuels and domestic LPG, even after factoring the fuel price hike. This high level of under-recoveries is unsustainable,” he said.

Global crude oil prices have surged by over 50% due to the West Asia war, which broke out on February 28, and the consequent closure of the Strait of Hormuz. But in a bid to insulate domestic consumers, the government-owned OMCs hadn’t passed on the higher rates for retail petrol and diesel until May 15. In fact, the prices of the two auto fuels had not been increased for four years; they were reduced once during the period -- before the 2024 Lok Sabha polls.

Discussions on an increase in petrol and diesel prices had gathered pace within the government, with a consensus that it was necessary. The key considerations were the timing and the quantum: whether to an-

nounce a steep hike in one go or adopt a staggered approach, according to a top government official. Evidently, a staggered approach was chosen.

A one-shot steep price increase wouldn’t have been politically palatable, and would have had a shock factor to it, industry sources said. Calibrated price hikes give the government the opportunity to pass on the higher prices to consumers gradually, while keeping a tab on the public reaction and the inflationary impact on an ongoing basis, instead of the inflationary shock and backlash that a steep hike may lead to.

According to industry sources, fuel prices in India continue to be among the lowest in the world, with every major developed economy retailing petrol at prices translating to over Rs 150 per litre in rupee terms. The average for the European Union countries is Rs 179 per litre of petrol and Rs 184 per litre of diesel. Most of India’s neighbouring countries are also selling fuels at higher prices, with petrol retailing at over Rs 135 per litre in Pakistan, Myanmar, Nepal and Sri Lanka, and diesel at Rs 125 or more. As per their estimation, the global weighted average of increases amid the West Asia crisis is 22.4% for petrol and 27% for diesel.

“India, therefore, prices petrol and diesel at or below most of the developing world and at roughly half the European pump, while still raising (prices) less than any non-subsidising peer through the present disruption. Every other

major importing economy has passed on the cost to its consumers... India has not. The Indian revision of just over Rs 7 a litre... is the smallest material upward movement of any major economy outside the directly subsidising Gulf producers,” said a source.

The Indian crude oil basket, which averaged \$70 per barrel last year, averaged over \$114 in April; in May, it has averaged at about \$108 per barrel so far. Refiners are incurring high additional costs due to emergency sourcing from the spot market and surging shipping and insurance rates. Oil imports in 2025-26 stood at about \$135 billion. If oil prices sustain at \$100 in the current fiscal and import volumes don’t fall, the oil import bill could be upwards of \$200 billion for the year.

The crisis has put the OMCs under severe financial stress. On May 12, Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri had said that the combined losses of the three refiners-cum-fuel retailers were projected at Rs 1 lakh crore in the April-June quarter if prices stayed where they were, enough to wipe out their collective profits for the entire 2025-26 (FY26).

Before hiking retail fuel prices, the government had slashed excise duty by Rs 10 per litre on petrol and diesel late March to blunt the impact of high international prices on the OMCs, but the retailers continue to bleed. The excise duty cut has resulted in the government foregoing revenue of about Rs 14,000 crore a month.

Siddaramaiah, DKS called to Delhi for talks

While those close to Shivakumar have spoken about the existence of an unwritten rotational chief ministership formula, the high command has been silent on this issue.

The Congress leadership, sources said, is not averse to a leadership change, but wants the transition to be smooth and acceptable to all, given that the Rajya Sabha and MLCElections and polls to the five corporations under the Greater Bengaluru Authority (GBA) are around the corner. The issue came up for discussion when Kharge, Gandhi, and Venugopal met here last week.

While Siddaramaiah favours a Cabinet reshuffle, Shivakumar wants the party leadership to decide on the leadership change first. Shivakumar — the state Congress president since July 2020 — has been mounting pressure on the leadership for a change of guard for several months now. Sources said the central leadership would broach the

subject with the two leaders. “We have not made any decision. We want to hear both of them,” a senior Congress leader said.

But everything, sources said, hinges on how Siddaramaiah reacts. Siddaramaiah is the only Congress CM from the Other Backward Classes (OBC) community. Those backing him believe that replacing him with a Vokkaliga (Shivakumar) could derail Rahul Gandhi’s social justice plank. Over the years, Siddaramaiah has assiduously worked on building the Ahinda, an acronym in Kannada for a coalition of the Alpasankhyataru (Minorities), Hindulidavaru (Backward Classes), and Dalitaru (Dalits).

Those close to him say that while the Ahinda vote base is solidly behind Siddaramaiah, Shivakumar does not even command the full support of the Vokkaligas, who are divided between Congress and the Janata Dal (Secular). Congress president Kharge, a Dalit,

too fancies an outside chance because of this, but age, some leaders say, is not on his side. The 83-year-old had lost out in the CM race thrice in the last three decades. Kharge is among the four Rajya Sabha MPs from Karnataka who are retiring next month.

Kharge refused to comment when asked about the high command’s meeting with the two leaders, saying, “I cannot comment on this. Rahul Ji will speak.” Age is one factor that the Shivakumar camp talks about, too. Their argument is that Siddaramaiah is 78 and will be over 80 by the time Karnataka goes to the polls in 2028. They say the party cannot go for Assembly elections under an octogenarian, who has already declared that he has no desire to contest again.

Can he be expected to lead a spirited fight against the BJP when he has nothing to gain, they ask. Those favouring a change of guard argue that Shivakumar is resourceful and will

leave no stone unturned to ensure that he retains the CM post. Siddaramaiah, sources said, could land in Delhi with several ministers and MLAs in tow. Congress leaders say he still has the support of a majority of the MLAs, but rule out a rebellion if the high command decides to replace him. The Congress leadership had earlier this month picked V D Satheesan as the Chief Minister of Kerala, overlooking Venugopal, a close confidant of Rahul Gandhi, who had the support of the majority of the newly elected MLAs.

“I’m invited to Delhi. Tomorrow there is a meeting at 11 am. I don’t know the subject. But I am invited. Last night, K C Venugopal called me and intimidated me about the date and the meeting,” Siddaramaiah told reporters in Bengaluru. To a question regarding speculation surrounding his meeting with the high command, he said, “It is always there.”

Extradition of another drug kingpin, criminal from Turkey

wanted fugitive, Prabhdeep Singh, was extradited from Azerbaijan on May 13 by the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI), in coordination with the Delhi Police’s Special Cell. Prabhdeep was wanted in connection with the recovery of 358 kg of heroin in 2021.

Absconding since 2023, Prabhdeep is alleged to have handled the India-based operations of an international drug

syndicate allegedly run by Navpreet Singh alias ‘Nav’, 34, whose last known location was Turkey, according to sources. The request for Navpreet’s extradition was submitted to Turkey in 2023-24, said sources.

Mohammad Sartaj, 42, is wanted in a bunch of cases related to threats and violence. The request for his extradition was submitted last year.

Despite shifting geopolitical alignments in West Asia, especially in the wake of Operation Sindoor and Iran-Israel and Israel-Gaza conflicts, Turkey has shown willingness to cooperate on matters related to law enforcement, said a senior official who didn’t want to be named.

India and Turkey share a formal extradition treaty, which was signed in 2001 and

came into force in June 2002. The framework allows both countries to formally request the transfer of fugitive criminals and individuals wanted for terrorism and other severe crimes.

While the extradition process can be lengthy, the two countries have had functional security cooperation, resulting in the detention, deportation and extradition of wanted indi-

Bengal detention facility

Bahadurpur near the Lalgola market in Murshidabad where a detention centre has now been opened also holds an office for fishermen, a bank and a community hall used for marriage and other purposes.

Police and administration inspected the building a day before it was announced as a ‘holding centre’ on Sunday. Police and civic volunteers have been appointed to man it.

Sources said the three alleged Bangladeshis brought to the centre had been picked up from Bhagabangola and Lalgola Police Station areas. The police officer said: “Proper arrangements have been made for food and water. Further investigation is on regarding the three.”

In Malda, a holding centre is being prepared in a government building meant for training of Self Help Groups, in English Bazar town’s Chandan Park area. Work is on to install CCTVs, and sources said that 12 policemen, three civil defence personnel and three civic volunteers will man the centre. A cook will also be provided.

In its May 23 order, the state government had laid down “the procedure to be followed for deportation of Bangladeshis / Rohingya apprehended for staying illegally”, including “setting up of Holding Centres in districts for apprehended foreigners as well as for the released foreign prisoners awaiting deportation/repatriation in accordance with

the MHA guidelines”. Before that, on May 20, CM Suvenudh Adhikari said the government will follow the “detect, delete and deport” system for illegal Bangladeshis in Bengal. State officials said this was in line with the directive issued by the Centre on May 2, 2025, on the procedure to deport illegal Bangladeshis and Rohingya, which the previous TMC government had stalled.

The government notification said that after suspected illegal residents have been identified, an enquiry would be conducted, with the name, parentage, residential address, details of near relatives and other information to be sent to authorities concerned of the areas where they claim to belong, with a report expected within 30 days. During this, the suspected person is to stay at the holding centre.

If no report is received within 30 days, the Foreigners’ Registration Officer is authorised to take necessary action to deport the suspected Bangladesh or Myanmar national. In case the report confirms that they are illegal migrants, police are to capture their biometrics, and the BSF or Coast Guards ensure their deportation.

A promise to check illegal immigration was one of BJP’s campaign agendas, and its government has been acting on priority on the issue. In its very first Cabinet meeting, it announced handing over land to the BSF for fencing along the border with Bangladesh.

Governance Awards

brings together some of the country’s most distinguished administrators: Jury Chair Wahajath Habibullah, former chairperson of the National Commission for Minorities and former Chief Information Commissioner; K M Chandrasekhar, former Cabinet Secretary; Nirupama Rao, former Foreign Secretary; and Amarjeet Sinha, Senior Fellow, Centre for Social and Economic Progress, former Advisor to the Prime Minister and Member, Public Enterprises Selection Board.

The awards have grown

steadily since their inception. The third edition in 2025 drew around 450 applications, with Railway, I&B and IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw presiding over the ceremony along with Guest of Honour, Dr Jitendra Singh, Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science & Technology and Earth Sciences, and MoS in the Prime Minister’s Office, Personnel, Public Grievances & Pensions, Atomic Energy, and Space.

District Magistrates can submit their entries at excellencegovernanceawards.indianexpress.com.

‘Cockroach Janta Party’

that raised “national security concerns”.

The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) asked X to withhold the account under Section 69(A) of the Information Technology Act, 2000. This provision allows the central government to restrict public access to information in the interest of sovereignty, security, public order, or preventing incitement to offences.

The account remains accessible from locations outside India.

Dipke (30), who is based in Boston, United States, had told The Indian Express that he has been receiving constant threats, and is worried about his family in India.

“I do not want anything to happen to my family because this is a choice I made, not them,” Dipke had told this paper.

The satirical account was launched in response to a remark by Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant about those who “attack the system”.

Pulling up a lawyer who had filed a petition seeking directions to the Delhi High Court over the designation of a Senior

Advocate, a status he himself was aspiring to, the CJI had said: “There are already parasites of society who attack the system, and you want to join hands with them? There are youngsters like cockroaches, who don’t get any employment or have any place in (the) profession...”

The remarks triggered an uproar, following which the CJI said it was “totally baseless” to suggest that he had criticised the youth. “What I had specifically criticised were those who have entered professions like the Bar (legal profession) with the aid of fake and bogus degrees. Similar persons have sneaked into the media, social media, and other noble professions as well, and hence, they are like parasites. It is totally baseless to suggest that I criticised the youth of our nation. Not only am I proud of our present and future human resource, but every youth of India inspires me,” he had said.

Dipke had criticised the CJI’s remark in a post on X. The next day, he had announced a platform for all “cockroaches” and shared a link to an online “membership form”, which had sparked a social media trend.

SC on NEET paper leak

material from unauthorised access and leaks.

It had asked the committee to recommend updates to NTA’s policies and Standard Operating Procedures to align with best practices. The court

had also asked it to explore the viability of NTA engaging in international cooperation with examination bodies to share best practices, security measures and innovative solutions.

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DROP IN WATER LEVELS AT WAZIRABAD POND HITS PRODUCTION AT MAJOR WATER TREATMENT PLANTS

Delhi seeks additional Yamuna water from Haryana for four weeks to avoid supply cuts

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, May 25

AS WATER levels at the Wazirabad pond continued to fall sharply amid peak summer demand, the Delhi government has sought additional water from Haryana for four weeks to avoid additional supply cuts across the Capital, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

“We have managed the situation in March, April and May, which is nearly over. The issue is primarily for June. If the request does not materialise, then further curtailment of water supply may become necessary,” a government official said.

According to Delhi Jal Board (DJB) officials, the level of Wazirabad pond – a water reservoir located upstream of the Wazirabad Barrage on the Yamuna – stood at 668.7 feet on Monday, critically below the standard level of 674.5 feet required for normal operations.

The drop has affected production at major water treatment plants (WTPs), with the Wazirabad WTP curtailing production by nearly 34% – the lowest so far this season among the nine WTPs in the Capital. While all other WTPs are witnessing a reduced output of around 10%, only Sonia Vihar and Bhagiriathi plants are running optimally, said sources.

A source in the Delhi government said, “Due to a drop in the Yamuna water level at Wazirabad, production at Chandrawal and Wazirabad WTPs has been affected. Both plants are operating below optimum capacity.”

The source further said that to minimise the impact on con-



Yamuna river bed near the Sonia Vihar treatment plant in New Delhi on Monday. TASHI TOBGYAL

sumers, water has been diverted from the Haiderpur canal system.

“Some areas may experience temporary low water pressure or short supply...,” the source added.

While Delhi requires around 1,250 MGD of water daily, officials said, the current shortfall linked to reduced production at Wazirabad and Chandrawal WTPs is estimated to be around 70 MGD.

“In June, due to rising temperatures, water demand increases. At the same time, there are evaporation losses and neighbouring states require

more water for irrigation for the paddy sowing season,” an official from Delhi Jal Board (DJB) said. Officials said around 1,000 cusecs of water would be required in the canal system to enable diversion towards Delhi, along with around 70 MGD daily support through the Wazirabad pond.

They added that water supply is being rationalised in affected areas and tankers are being deployed where production has been curtailed. Tail-end localities are expected to witness the maximum disruption through temporary low pressure and short supply, they said.

Delhi currently receives around 1,050 cusecs from Haryana, Bhakra and Yamuna systems, and an additional 250 cusecs could substantially ease the immediate crisis, officials said.

Officials from the Haryana Irrigation department, meanwhile, pointed to long-pending transmission infrastructure issues between Hathnikund canal in Haryana and Munak canal system in Delhi.

Senior officials in the DJB told *The Indian Express* that nearly 800 cusecs of water is lost in transmission and that a project to create a parallel carrier system has remained de-

layed for over three years despite substantial expenditure of Rs 700 crore.

“A project that should have been completed is still pending. Had the parallel chain from Jagadhri in Haryana to Munak been completed, the current stress could have been reduced,” a source in the Haryana government added.

“Drinking water is always treated as a priority. But Delhi also needs to address transmission losses within its own network. Even Delhi’s own economic surveys have pointed to nearly 20% transmission losses,” the official in

• Skywatch



Forecast: May 26, 2026:
Mainly clear sky, heatwave conditions at isolated places

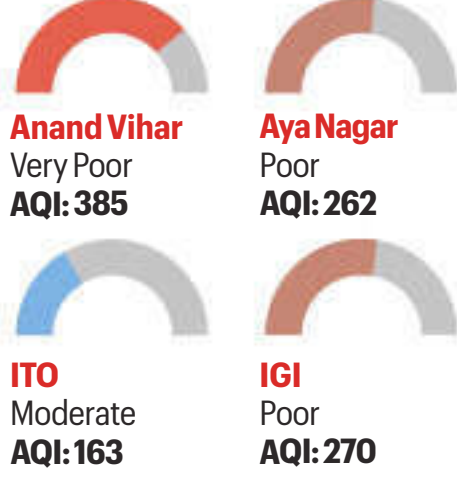
MAX: 43-45
4.6°C above normal

MIN: 30-32
3.4°C above normal

• *Sunrise: 5:25 AM (May 27)*
• *Sunset: 7:11 PM (May 26)*

• *Moonrise: 2:52 PM (May 26)*
• *Moonset: 2:35 AM (May 27)*

• AQI Tracker



- Good (0-50)
- Satisfactory (51-100)
- Moderate (101-200)
- Poor (201-300)
- Very Poor (301-400)
- Severe (401-500)

Haryana said.

Delhi depends heavily on water from neighbouring Haryana, Uttar Pradesh and Punjab. The Wazirabad pond acts as the primary holding area for Yamuna water before it is processed at major treatment plants, including Wazirabad and Chandrawal, before supply to the Capital.

After hottest May night in 14 years, record power demand; rain relief likely this week

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, May 25

AFTER ANOTHER punishing spell of heat, Delhi is likely to see very light to light rain, thunderstorms and dust storms later this week even as the city recorded its hottest May night in 14 years on Monday. The Capital also saw another new record on Monday as it clocked the highest-ever peak power demand of 8,439 megawatt (MW). The peak power demand is expected to cross 9,000 MW this summer, said officials.

According to the India Meteorological Department (IMD), Safdarjung, Delhi’s base weather station, recorded a minimum temperature of 32.4

degrees Celsius on Monday, 5.7 degrees above normal. This was the highest minimum temperature recorded in May since May 27, 2012, when the minimum temperature had shot up to 34.2 degrees Celsius.

The maximum temperature at Safdarjung settled at 43.5 degrees Celsius, around 3.3 degrees above normal.

The IMD said warm night conditions were recorded at many places in the city as minimum temperatures rose by 3-6 degrees Celsius during the past 24 hours. The minimum temperatures across the city remained in the 30-32 degrees Celsius range, while maximum temperatures stayed around 43-44 degrees Celsius.

However, some relief is expected with the weather department forecasting very light to light rain accompanied by thunderstorm, lightning, dust storm and strong surface winds reaching 40-50 kmph, occasionally gusting to 60 kmph, towards early Tuesday.

A fresh western disturbance is likely to affect Northwest India from May 28, bringing another spell of rain activity to the Capital. The IMD has forecast very light to light rain with thunderstorm, lightning and gusty winds of 40-50 kmph, reaching 60 kmph, on May 28 evening or night.

The rain spell is expected to bring a sharp fall in temperatures. According to the IMD,

maximum temperatures are likely to remain largely unchanged till May 27 before falling by 7-8 degrees Celsius thereafter. Minimum temperatures are also expected to remain high till May 28 before falling by 5-7 degrees Celsius.

From May 29 to May 31, the Capital is expected to see generally cloudy skies with very light to light rain accompanied by thunderstorms, lightning and gusty winds. The maximum temperature may drop to 35-37 degrees Celsius on May 29 and further to 34-36 degrees Celsius on May 30.

Meanwhile, official data shows the power demand has already crossed the 8,000 MW-mark four times within a week.

बिहार लोक सेवा आयोग

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आवश्यक सूचना

33वीं बिहार न्यायिक सेवा प्रतियोगिता परीक्षा

33वीं बिहार न्यायिक सेवा प्रतियोगिता परीक्षा (वि.सं.-12/2026) से संबंधित अभ्यर्थियों को एतद्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि माननीय सर्वोच्च न्यायालय, नई दिल्ली द्वारा Writ Petition(s) (Civil) No(s). 1110/2025 में दिनांक- 22.05.2026 को पारित अंतरिम न्यायादेश के आलोक में दिनांक - 03 जून, 2026 (बुधवार) को आयोजित की जाने वाली (प्रारम्भिक) प्रतियोगिता परीक्षा स्थगित की जाती है।

हस्ता./-
परीक्षा निबंधक,
बिहार लोक सेवा आयोग, पटना

Amid austerity push, restriction on govt staff buying new vehicles

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 25

IN AN effort to cut government expenditure, reduce fuel consumption and address fiscal imbalances, the Finance department of the Delhi government, in a fresh notification, has ordered a complete ban on the purchase of all types of petrol, diesel, Compressed Natural Gas (CNG) and hybrid staff cars for government staff, officials said.

This comes amid the government’s broader push towards fuel conservation in the wake of the global energy disruption caused by the West Asia crisis.

“Consequent upon emergence of prevailing situation, various measures been enacted by Government of India and in order to cut Government expenses, reduce fuel consumption and address fiscal imbalances, especially due to rising global oil prices,” read the order.

“...There will be a complete ban on purchase of all types of petrol/ diesel/ CNG/ hybrid staff cars including purchase of these types of staff cars against condemnation of old vehicles, till further order,” read the order.

Further, officials have also been encouraged to hold virtual meetings, in order to minimise travel.

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EXTRACT OF THE AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND TWELVE MONTHS ENDED 31ST MARCH, 2026 (₹ In Crore)

S. No.	Particulars	STANDALONE RESULTS				CONSOLIDATED RESULTS			
		FOR THREE MONTHS ENDED		FOR TWELVE MONTHS ENDED		FOR THREE MONTHS ENDED		FOR TWELVE MONTHS ENDED	
		31-MARCH-2026 (Audited)	31-MARCH-2025 (Audited)	31-MARCH-2026 (Audited)	31-MARCH-2025 (Audited)	31-MARCH-2026 (Audited)	31-MARCH-2025 (Audited)	31-MARCH-2026 (Audited)	31-MARCH-2025 (Audited)
1	Total Income from Operations	2,256.84	2,281.37	9,059.45	8,863.37	2,263.30	2,287.83	9,078.97	8,887.02
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items and Share of net profit/(loss) of joint ventures)	339.98	404.85	1,623.34	1,731.38	341.71	391.59	1,620.90	1,721.98
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax, Share of net profit/(loss) of joint ventures (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	339.98	404.85	1,623.34	1,698.06	341.71	391.59	1,620.90	1,688.66
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	258.23	302.14	1,221.81	1,271.98	263.50	300.14	1,245.74	1,293.10
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period (Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax))	267.94	293.42	1,240.93	1,268.29	274.07	291.31	1,265.64	1,289.18
6	Equity Share Capital	380.81	304.65	380.81	304.65	380.81	304.65	380.81	304.65
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the previous year			12,508.91	12,044.83			12,561.54	12,076.81
8	Earnings Per Share (of ₹ 5/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)								
1.	Basic (₹)	3.39	3.97	16.04	16.70	3.46	3.94	16.36	16.98
2.	Diluted (₹)	3.39	3.97	16.04	16.70	3.46	3.94	16.36	16.98

The Standalone and Consolidated Financial results of the Company for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026 have been reviewed by Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors in its meeting held on May 25th, 2026. The statutory auditors of the Company have carried out audit of the above results for Quarter and year ended March 31, 2026.

Note: The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarter and year ended Financial Results for March 31, 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarter and Year ended Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchanges Websites www.nseindia.com, www.bseindia.com and on company's Website www.concorindia.co.in

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For & on behalf of the Board of Directors

Sd/-
(Vivek Gupta)
Director (Finance) & CFO
DIN: 11674836

Delhi excise policy case: 3 AAP leaders appoint lawyers after ‘satyagraha’ stand

Arvind Kejriwal, Manish Sisodia and Durgesh Pathak. FILE

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, May 25

AFTER VOLUNTARILY refusing to appoint legal counsel to represent them in the CBI plea against the excise policy case discharge of 23 accused before the Delhi High Court, Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) leaders Arvind Kejriwal, Manish Sisodia and Durgesh Pathak Monday reported their legal representatives before the court.

Vakalatnamas, a document authorising a lawyer to represent a litigant before court, have been filed by advocates Mudit Jain, Vivek Jain, Karan Sharma to represent the three.

The three advocates have represented the AAP leaders in the past during proceedings in the trial court and the Delhi HC.

Aam Aadmi Party chief Kejriwal, Sisodia and Pathak had opted to remain legally unrepresented before Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma after she had refused to recuse herself from hearing the CBI’s revision plea challenging the discharge of 23 accused in the liquor policy case.

The leaders had expressed

apprehension of bias if Justice Sharma decides the case, citing that her children are on the Union government’s advocates’ panels and are assigned cases by Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, who is representing CBI in this case.

The leaders had also objected to Justice Sharma’s alleged “public association with the RSS’s legal front Akhil Bharatiya Adhivakta Parishad”.

The three leaders’ decision to remain legally unrepresented before Justice Sharma, as claimed by them, was a “satyagraha” move.

On May 14, Justice Sharma initiated suo motu criminal contempt against the three Aam Aadmi Party leaders, and four others, and simultaneously transferred the CBI and ED’s pleas in the alleged liquor policy scam out of her court.

The matters are now before Justice Manoj Jain. On May 19, the HC issued fresh notice to the trio.

Taken up briefly on Monday, the court posted the matter to July 16, when it will draw up a schedule for hearing.

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सार्वजनिक सूचना

सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि प्राधिकरण बोर्ड की 92वीं बैठक दिनांक 7.01.1998 में लिये गये निर्णय के अनुपालन में ग्राम बेगमपुर के 108.223 हे० भू-अर्जन प्रस्ताव के सम्बंध 5 प्रतिशत विकसित आबादी भूमि आवंटन किये जाने हेतु प्रस्तावित व्यक्तियों की अंतिम सूची में अंकित कृषकों का विवरण निम्नवत है:-

क्र० सं०	ग्राम का नाम	कृषक का नाम व पता	खाता संख्या	खसरा संख्या	कृषक के हिस्से की नौएडा के पक्ष में अर्जित का क्षेत्रफल (व०मी० में)
1	बेगमपुर	चतुर सिंह पुत्र रामजीलाल नि० मुबारिकपुर, नौएडा, गौतमबुद्धनगर	19/20	106	7590.00

उपरोक्त सूची में वर्णित किसी विवरण के सम्बंध में लिखित आपत्ति प्रकाशन के दिनांक से 15 दिनों के अन्दर भूलेख विभाग, मुख्य प्रशासनिक भवन, सेक्टर-06, नौएडा के कार्यालय में प्रस्तुत की जा सकती है।

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Sr. no.	Folio No.	Name of Shareholder(s)	Kind of securities and face value	No. of securities	Distinctive Number(s)
1.	H5S0077833	Shalini B Badigar and Bhaskar Hanumantha Badigar	Equity Shares of ₹1/- each	2,160	56530191-56532350
			Equity Shares of ₹1/- each	359	2374951458-2374951816
2.	H5K0013111	Koteswar Silla and Pushpa Silla	Equity Shares of ₹1/- each	7,700	16159061-16166760

For The Tata Power Company Limited

Sd/-
Vispi S. Patel
Company Secretary
FCS 7021

Place: Mumbai
Dated: May 25, 2026

NEW DELHI MUNICIPAL COUNCIL

OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR (TAX)
PALIKA KENDRA : NEW DELHI

PUBLIC NOTICE

PROPERTY TAX BILLS FOR THE YEAR 2026-27 (Attention of Property Tax Payers of NDMC)

Public Notice is hereby given as required u/s 70 of the New Delhi Municipal Council Act-1994 to inform all the concerned that the Assessment List for the year 2026-27 in respect of all lands and buildings of NDMC area has been prepared and authenticated in pursuance of public notice issued on 14.04.2026 according to provision of Section-70 of the NDMC Act-1994. The said list is available with the officials of Tax Department in Room No. 9006, 9th Floor, Palika Kendra, New Delhi and is open for inspection free of charge during office hours to all the concerned owners, occupiers and lessees of lands and building comprised therein or the authorized agent of such persons. In respect of the assesses who were the petitioners before the Hon'ble High Court of Delhi on Bye Laws-2009, the Rateable Value shown against them in the assessment list is provisional and liable to be changed after the decision on the Notices issued against these properties based on Section 63(1) of the NDMC Act. Meanwhile, the assessment list in respect of these cases would be treated as provisional. Aforesaid list is also available on the NDMC website www.ndmc.gov.in.

The concerned Tax payers may login by using PID No. as user ID and D&C No. as password, to view details of a particular property owned by them. NDMC is in the process of sending the property tax bills to all the owners and if any tax payers do not receive the bill by 04.06.2026, duplicate bill can be collected from the office of the Sr. Accounts Officer (Tax) at 9th Floor, Room No. 9009, Palika Kendra, New Delhi-110001 between 10:00 A.M. to 01:00 P.M.

Further, it is also informed that 10% rebates as mentioned in the property tax bills would be allowed on payment of tax on or before 30.06.2026 and 5% rebates are applicable up to 30.09.2026.

Director (Tax)

epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi



Twisha Sharma's brother performs rituals a day after her cremation, in Bhopal on Monday. PTI

'Unfortunate... saying judiciary not permitting fair trial': SC says CBI must 'immediately' probe Twisha death

Divorced daughter better than dead daughter, says Solicitor General

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 25

THE SUPREME Court said on Monday that CBI should "immediately" take over the probe into the alleged dowry death of model-actor Twisha Sharma amid growing allegations that the judiciary was obstructing a fair investigation given that the deceased's mother-in-law, Giribala Singh, is a former judge.

"We appreciate the state's prompt action. They recommended a CBI investigation... Ask CBI to take over the investigation," Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant said while presiding over a three-judge bench. He added that a narrative was being created that the judiciary was obstructing a fair trial. "One section has started saying that because the mother-in-law is a former district judge... It is quite unfortunate that they have started saying that the judiciary is not permitting a fair trial," he said.

"We are slightly in pain because some of the sections, and we will request our media friends not to go for the statements of the victim's family or the other family. Let things move as per law and procedure. The authority, the investigative agency, will follow up. Statements are being recorded."

Maintaining that they had "absolutely no doubt on the state police", he said, "They must be there, and they will continue to deal with absolute fairness and impartiality. We do not want to demoralise the state police. They must be doing a very good job."

"We don't want to cast aspersions against anyone... We are only intervening because this is the kind of narrative that is being created. Therefore, it is in the interest of all that some independent agency should take over it," he added.

Solicitor General (SG) Tusshar Mehta, appearing for the Madhya Pradesh Police, replied, "That would be done. Why this has started — one of the potential accused, the learned former judge, started giving interviews, hopping from one channel to another, almost ma-



Twisha Sharma

lining the deceased..."

He maintained that the state had recommended a CBI probe to avoid fingers being pointed at the MP Police.

The CJI said the action was "very fair and completely above board". "Once the state has recommended (CBI probe), there is no need for us to issue a direction," Justice Kant added. "No, CBI would take over," the SG said.

When the CJI said, "And they should do so immediately", Mehta said, "I will ensure that it (necessary formalities) happens today." The court recorded Mehta's assurance.

In its order, the court said, "We would like to impress upon the family members of the victim, as well as the accused that instead of making statements in public or before media platforms, they should get their version recorded before the investigating agency so that no prejudice or adverse impact is caused to the investigation."

To the media, it said, "...we also request the media to avoid recording statements of the persons who are likely to be potential witnesses or accused, as it may unnecessarily prejudice the outcome on certain issues, which are yet to be investigated."

"We will also request the general public to refrain from speculation and have trust and faith in one of the premier investigating agency...", it added.

The SG also said, "One thing is clear, the girl has lost her life whether it's by suicide or some criminal act. For parents, the moral is that it's better to have a divorced daughter than a dead daughter. When she is repeatedly saying I'm living in hell, please save me... For parents, it's better to take that call immediately rather than losing the daughter."

GOVT MOVE SMACKS OF PREMEDITATED AND COORDINATED DESIGN: PETITION

Gymkhana member moves HC, says order malicious, part of takeover plan

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, May 25

THE DELHI High Court will hear on Tuesday a suit filed by Vijay Khurana, described as a longstanding member of the Delhi Gymkhana Club, asking the court to restrain the central government from taking back the land occupied by the elite, almost century-old club in the heart of Lutyens' Delhi.

Khurana, who has claimed that he is "supported by over 500 other members" of the club, has described the government's move as a "malicious and colourable exercise — the last in a series of acts... to gain control over the institution".

On May 22, the Land and Development Office under the Union Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs wrote to the secretary of the club initiating the "re-entry and resumption of [the] premises" at 2, Safdarjung Road.

Clause 4 of the 1928 lease deed says the premises can be "re-entered", or taken back, in full or part, if it is required for a



Outside Delhi Gymkhana Club on Monday. ANI

public purpose. The government has said the re-entry is necessary for "strengthening and securing Defence infrastructure".

Khurana has submitted that the government has over the years adopted a "continuing and concerted course of conduct to progressively assume

control" over the club and its assets.

He has referred to the proceedings initiated under the Companies Act in 2020 alleging mismanagement of the club, after which the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) had placed the management and affairs of the club

"under substantial governmental influence and control".

"The sequence, timing and nature of the impugned action demonstrate a premeditated and coordinated design rather than any genuine or emergent public requirement. The vague invocation of "public purpose" is merely a facade to achieve a

collateral objective, namely complete governmental control over (the club) and its assets," says the petition.

The government's invocation of Clause 4 of the perpetual lease deed is "vague", and the notice "neither identifies any specific public project nor discloses any material, assessment, approval or necessity justifying repossession" of the property, it says.

The invocation of the clause is "entirely mechanical, unsupported by particulars and reflective of complete non-application of mind", it says.

Khurana has alleged that the notice "manufactures an artificial urgency by directing surrender of possession within fifteen days without disclosing any emergent circumstance warranting such extraordinary action".

It is also "entirely silent" on "mandatory safeguards" such as determination of compensation in respect of the premium, buildings, and structures on the premises, the payment of

compensation in the manner contemplated under the perpetual lease deed, and compliance with the contractual mechanism governing the resumption of possession, he has argued.

Khurana has also referred to a 2009 notice issued by the Deputy Land & Development Officer withdrawing an earlier re-entry order of September 29, 2000.

The 2009 declaration by the government recorded, "Your ownership and titles stand restored to you. You are now bound by the covenants of the original lease deed executed on 28.2.1928," Khurana has said.

According to the petition, "such proprietary rights cannot be extinguished by executive notice. Under Article 300A of the Constitution, any deprivation of property should be by authority of "substantive law that is fair, just and reasonable, in pursuance of a genuine public purpose, with notice, hearing, reasoned decision and payment of fair compensation".

Since March, Delhi Race Club & Indian Polo Association also moved HC against eviction

Sohini Ghosh & Amaal Shiekh
New Delhi, May 25

THE CENTRE'S order to the Delhi Gymkhana Club to vacate its 27.3-acre premises by June 5, citing the need to "strengthen and secure defence infrastructure", is the latest in a series of such moves. Since March, the Indian Polo Association and the Delhi Race Club have also moved the Delhi High Court against eviction notices issued to them by the government.

In December 2023, the Land Development Office (L&DO) under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs had revised Gymkhana Club's rent retrospectively from April 2018, based on prevailing institutional land rates.

The revised demand amounted to Rs 4.1 crore per year, which the Club had termed a hike of "10,000 times the original rent". While the Club, since 2023, sought HC's intervention to quash a series of notices, the total dues demanded had climbed to Rs 47.59 crore by April this year.

The Club has cited several grounds — from the lack of an opportunity to be heard, a bar on retrospective revision of rent under the Centre's own 1983 of-fice order and an inability to pay, given that it has been under a court-appointed management since an order issued by the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT).

On May 7, Justice Purushendra Kaurav of the HC directed the Club and the L&DO to hold a joint meeting. By May 14, the Club told the court that an amicable resolution was being explored, and the matter



Land needed to strengthen defence infra, says Govt. GAJENDRA YADAV

was deferred to July 21.

In March this year, the L&DO also served simultaneous 15-day eviction notices on two of Delhi's oldest sporting institutions — the Indian Polo Association (IPA), which manages the Jaipur Polo Ground near Race Course Road, and the Delhi Race Club (1940) Limited, spread across 53 acres on Kamal Ataturk Marg. Both institutions moved the HC.

On March 25, Justice Mini Pushkarna stayed the proposed evictions in two separate proceedings, holding that if the government wished to resume the land, it would have to follow due process.

In case of the IPA, the government moved the Estate Officer under the Public Premises (Eviction of Unauthorised Occupants) Act, 1971. A show-cause notice was issued to the IPA on April 17.

The IPA argued that the lease had continued by conduct, that the government had accepted rent payments as recently as April 2025, covering the period up to March 2030, and that its status as a National

Sports Federation set it apart from ordinary occupants of public premises.

On May 20, the Estate Officer rejected all objections and ordered eviction. He held that payments accepted after March 1993 amounted to "use and occupation charges" and not rent under a valid lease, that the PP Act left no room for the Transfer of Property Act's "holding over" doctrine, and that unauthorised occupation of public premises constitutes a continuing wrong, making limitation inapplicable. The IPA challenged the order before the HC.

The following day, a separate bench heard IPA's petition seeking appointment of an arbitrator under its 1951 lease deed — which the court itself described as "subsisting up to 31.03.2030". A notice was issued to the government, which has four weeks to respond.

In the Delhi Race Club case, after Justice Pushkarna's March 25 stay on the eviction notice, the civil suit was disposed of in April on the understanding that "the defendant shall not dispossess the plain-

tiff without resorting to due process of law".

On April 17, the Estate Officer issued a fresh show-cause notice under Section 4 (1) of the PP Act. The Club filed a writ petition before the HC in which it relied heavily on an earlier round of litigation dating back to 1999, when the government had issued a similar notice under the Act. That notice was ultimately quashed by the HC in 2012 on the ground that the government could not treat the Club as an "unauthorised occupant" without first formally terminating the lease under the 1926 deed.

The Delhi Race Club argued the same defect applied now.

Justice Amit Sharma, noting the "chequered history of previous litigation," issued notice and stayed further proceedings before the Estate Officer. The government filed an appeal, arguing the stay was premature — the show-cause notice "neither determines any rights of the parties nor results in eviction."

Judgment in that appeal is expected on Tuesday.

The Union government subsequently appealed against the April notice.

It said that the writ petition was only directed against a preliminary show-cause notice, "which neither determines any rights of the parties nor results in eviction by itself", and that "the premature interference at the show-cause notice stage has the effect of stalling the statutory adjudicatory process and defeats the legislative intent of providing a specialised mechanism for eviction and related disputes concerning public premises".

Club to Centre: Don't disrupt ops until there is clarity if alternative land will be allotted

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, May 25

THE GENERAL Committee overseeing the Delhi Gymkhana Club has urged the Union government not to disrupt its operations until there is clarity on whether an alternate appropriate plot of land will be allotted to it. The committee — constituted by the Centre — also requested that investments made in its facilities be reconsidered along with the fact that Club relocation will require rebuilding those facilities at a significant cost.

In a letter dated May 23, written to the Land and Development Office (L&DO), the Club's officiating secretary, Rajesh Bhatnagar, requested that the timeline for vacating the premises be reconsidered and sought an urgent meeting with officials from the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs.

In the letter, the Club said that there should be "no dislocation of the Club and its operations" until certain issues are clarified. These include whether the government is considering allotting an "appropriately located alternate plot of land" for relocation and recognition of the Club's expenditure over decades on improving infrastructure and facilities for members. It also said that any relocation would require rebuilding facilities at substantial cost and sought protection of the interests of permanent employees and staff.

The response came a day

after the L&DO initiated the process of "re-entry and resumption" of the 27.3-acre Delhi Gymkhana Club premises at Safdarjung Road. The Centre said the land was required for "strengthening and securing Defence infrastructure and other vital public security purposes". The L&DO asked for the premises to be handed over on June 5, failing which "possession shall be taken in accordance with law".

In the letter, the Club further said that since the committee took charge, it had worked to improve administration and finances. According to the letter, the Club moved from facing a loss of around Rs 12 crore in 2021-22 to a projected profit of around Rs 9 crore in 2023-24. It also streamlined several operational processes, the letter added.

Further, it said that the notice comes at a time when communications are already underway in relation to the actions by L&DO regarding enhancement of lease rent.

Founded in 1913 as the Imperial Delhi Gymkhana Club and renamed after Independence, the Club has close to 14,000 members which include the elite of Delhi — from political leaders to top businesspersons, and members of the bureaucracy, judiciary and armed forces. Since April 2022, the Club has been run by the General Committee, after the National Company Law Tribunal allowed the government to take over its administration.

Man stages 10-month-old daughter's kidnapping, arrested for her murder

He did not want to raise the second daughter, police told

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 25

ON SUNDAY, Deepak (25), who works as a van driver at a private school, allegedly called up the Bhalswa dairy police station in Northwest Delhi to say that his 10-month-daughter has been kidnapped. Multiple police teams were set up to look for her but soon, police said, the officers found that the father's claims did not add up to their analysis of the CCTV camera footage collected from the area around his house in Mukundpur Part-II, police said.

Suspicious, the officers subjected Deepak to rigorous questioning. On Monday, he was arrested after he allegedly admitted that he had killed the infant because he did not want to raise a second daughter.

The child's body was found inside a septic tank on the roof

of Deepak's house in Mukundpur. "During questioning, Deepak admitted to killing his daughter. He said that he was under financial stress and did not have the means to raise a second daughter," said DCP Hareshwar Swami.

"The accused initially fabricated a kidnapping story to mislead the police," the DCP added.

During the investigation, Deepak initially claimed that his daughter had disappeared when he had stepped out to buy biscuits and milk for around five minutes. "When he came back, he said, he woke up his wife and asked where their daughter was. The whole family started looking for the child, and then he called the police," said an officer. A kidnapping case under Section 137(2) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) was registered.

Senior officers of Outer North District were part of the team that launched intensive search operations. CCTV footage from surrounding areas and possible escape routes was analysed on priority basis. "We didn't find the girl being taken out of the house by anyone in any CCTV footage. And Deepak's story was inconsistent in many aspects," said a police officer.

A sustained questioning saw Deepak change the timeline of events multiple times, the officer added. He was eventually arrested after he told police that he allegedly strangled the infant and threw her body into the septic tank before claiming she was kidnapped.

Section 103(1) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita related to murder was subsequently added to the case, said officers.

HEAD CONSTABLE Ramesh Kumar adjusts the strap of his newly issued air-conditioned helmet before stepping into the harsh afternoon sun at Central Delhi's busy Tughlaq Road roundabout, where he has been deployed to manage traffic. Amid scorching temperatures, the heat radiating off the asphalt is relentless, the kind that leaves uniforms drenched within minutes.

But for the last two-three days, Kumar says, the cooling devices — launched on a trial basis — have offered some relief from the extreme heat.

"Usually, sweat keeps dripping from the head and face. With the AC helmet, the head stays cooler," Kumar says while regulating traffic.

Along with the helmets, the officers have also been given portable fans to ward off the heat.



A Traffic policeman wears AC helmet on Monday. TASHI TOBGYAL

Kumar is among a group of Delhi Traffic Police personnel currently testing portable cooling devices, battery operated fans and air-conditioned helmets introduced to help officers cope with the Capital's heatwave conditions.

A senior police officer said the devices have been distributed in various parts of the city on a trial basis to assess their effectiveness during long

outdoor duty hours.

"On a trial basis, these have been distributed among traffic personnel deployed at different locations across the city. Feedback is being taken from officers on the ground," the officer said.

At present, the devices have been distributed among traffic personnel keeping in mind locations where traffic arrangement is heavy, the

officer added.

The initiative comes in the wake of Delhi continuing to reel under the grip of a heatwave, with several areas recording temperatures above 40°C this summer. Traffic personnel, who spend hours in long outdoor shifts — standing at intersections navigating exhaust fumes and hot winds — are among the worst affected by the gruelling heat.

The AC helmet assigned to Kumar is lightweight, weighing around 500 to 600 grams, and is battery-operated and rechargeable. According to officers involved in the trial, the device can function for nearly eight to ten hours on a single charge. "In direct sunlight, it definitely helps," Kumar says. "The ventilation and airflow reduce the heat around the face and head", he adds.

The AC helmets, too, are being tested as part of the pilot project. Equipped with miniature cooling and ventilation

systems, the helmets are designed to reduce heat buildup during prolonged deployment under the sun.

On the initiative, Manish Kumar, Special Commissioner of Police (Traffic), said, "They are at the proof of concept level, we are checking the efficiency and how easy they are to work with".

Alongside the cooling devices, the Delhi Traffic Police has also deployed hydration vans in the New Delhi traffic circle to ensure officers stay well hydrated while they are out on their outdoor shifts.

The vans, carrying ORS solutions and lemonade, make rounds across duty points where personnel have been stationed to manage vehicle and pedestrian flow. The hydration vans provide a much-needed breather to officers who routinely battle dehydration, fatigue and heat exhaustion while regulating traffic during peak summer months.

SC refuses to intervene; ballot papers to be used in Punjab municipal elections today

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, May 25

THE SUPREME Court on Monday refused to direct that Punjab municipal elections scheduled for Tuesday, May 26, be held using EVMs even as it said the State Election Commission (SEC) should have considered the observations in its 2024 judgment that returning to ballot papers is a “regressive step”.

A three-judge bench presided by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant noted that only one day remained for the conduct of the elections. “There is no time left. What can be done,” asked the CJI.

The bench also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi said conduct of municipal election rules permits both ballot paper and EVM voting and only if the former is deleted can the latter be held to be the only option.

The court was hearing an appeal challenging the May 22 order of the Punjab and Haryana High Court refusing to intervene in the matter on the ground that the petition was filed belatedly on May 18, and there was hardly any time left for the elections.

Appearing for petitioner Ruchita Garg, a social worker, Senior Advocate Nachiketa Joshi and Advocate Alabhiya Dhamija said this was not correct. Joshi said the election notification was issued only on May 13 and the petition was filed without any delay on May 15, but the HC took it up for hearing only on May 19.

Joshi pointed out that June 1 is the last date by which the entire election process is to conclude and hence, there is still time to issue directions to hold the elections within that window.



An official leaves for duty ahead of the voting, in Ludhiana on Monday. GURMEET SINGH

The CJI said, “There was no need for you to wait for the formal notification of election schedule being issued. You knew the elections were due... It’s not the first round of litigation. You could have requested the HC to tell them to make all the necessary arrangements.”

Joshi said, “But unless the communication comes out, it was presumed they would be doing it through the EVM process. It is only in the circular which comes out on May 13 and 14 that (said) it will be ballot paper. And the very next day, on May 15, we filed it. There is not even a day’s delay in filing.”

Joshi said the SC had, in a 2024 judgment, in Association For Democratic Reforms (ADR) vs Election Commission taken into consideration how in India we had moved on from physical ballot papers to EVMs.

Justice Bagchi said, “We are also in agreement with you the Election Commission is

required to take into consideration the observations in the ADR judgment that it is a regressive step to go back (to ballot papers). On the point of a regression or an unwise step, after an election process has commenced, it would be extremely ill advisable to injunct or to regulate that election process. We can make observations for future elections.”

Joshi said the Election Commission had filed affidavits saying EVMs “are available and we will immediately provide them”. “They indicated they are waiting on the border and whenever the state says, immediately it will be provided; even the training facility will be provided. So where was the question (of ballot papers)?” Justice Bagchi said, “Until and unless The Representation of the People Act and the (conduct of municipal election) Rules are amended to delete ballot paper voting, the decision... to do a ballot paper voting will be within the jurisdictional domain of the SEC.”

Joshi said the decision has to be guided by some unavoidable reason. “Unless some exigencies are shown by the state.”

Justice Bagchi said, “We are not going to second guess that”.

The CJI said the question of ballot papers vs EVMs was not being raised for the first time. He said had the petitioners approached at the appropriate time, directions could have been issued. “You people never raised it... What do you expect the authorities to do in a couple of hours,” CJI Kant asked.

Justice Bagchi said, “The Election Commission does not conduct municipal elections. So, the person conducting the election, the State Election Commission, is not before us.”

‘Govt-created crisis’: Opposition slams fuel price hike

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 25

FOLLOWING ANOTHER hike in fuel prices, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge targeted Prime Minister Narendra Modi over rising inflation, unemployment and the state of the economy, alleging that the BJP-led government had failed to provide relief to people facing financial distress.

The CPI(M), following the conclusion of its three-day Central Committee meeting, issued

a statement in which it termed rising prices of fuel, together with the austerity measures, “an enormous burden on the people”. The Samajwadi Party alleged the BJP had ushered in an era of inflation in the guise of Amrit Kaal.

Kharge alleged that the country’s economy was “collapsing” and that the Prime Minister had “no vision” to govern the country effectively, adding that people across the country were burdened by rising prices and unemployment.

Holding the PM directly responsible for the increase in petrol, diesel and cooking gas prices, the Congress president termed the situation a “government-created crisis”, stressing that prices of essential commodities had risen sharply, making survival difficult for the poor and lower middle class.

Drawing a comparison with the Congress-led UPA government, Kharge said former Prime Minister Manmohan Singh had protected citizens from the burden of rising global

crude oil prices through subsidies even during international economic crisis while the NDA government, in contrast, was “only engaged in exploiting the public”.

The CPI(M) said the fuel prices were hiked immediately after the election results were announced and, in the last 11 days, petrol and diesel prices have been raised by over Rs 7 per litre through multiple hikes.

“The rising prices of fuel, together with the austerity measures are an enormous

burden on the people, who are struggling to ensure that they get at least one proper meal per day,” it stated.

The Samajwadi Party, in a post on X, stated, “The BJP’s inflation onslaught shows no signs of stopping, making life unbearable for the people! Petrol and diesel prices hiked for the fourth time in 10 days. Petrol up by 2.61 rupees and diesel by 2.71 rupees per litre. By calling it Amrit Kaal, the BJP has ushered in an era of inflation. We don’t want BJP anymore.”

Former V-P supports demands to declare cow as ‘national animal’

Asad Rehman
New Delhi, May 25

AMID GROWING demand from Muslim organisations to declare the cow as the “national animal”, former Vice-President of India Mohammad Hamid Ansari on Monday backed the idea, stating that if the “root cause of the problem can be finished off, then it should be done”.

Speaking to *The Indian Express* on Monday, Ansari said: “I read in the news that there were some voices demanding the cow to be declared the national animal. I felt it was a very rational demand. Because if you can finish off the root cause of the problem, then that should be done.”

When asked the reason be-



Better if peace and harmony are maintained in the country, says Hamid Ansari. FILE

hind him backing the demands from Muslim bodies, Ansari said: “It is better if peace and harmony is maintained in the country instead of fighting.”

Asked if his demand is for the Central government to declare the cow as the national animal, Ansari said: “That is a

problem for the Central government (to ponder over) ... In order to stop the slaughter of cows, if such a step is taken, then it is a good thing.”

Ansari served as the V-P of India from 2007 to 2017.

Ansari’s comments come just days ahead of Eid-ul-Azha (Bakrid) after several Muslim organisations backed the demand made by Maulana Arshad Madani, president of the Jamiat Ulama-e-Hind (Arshad Madani faction), to declare the cow the “national animal”.

Office-bearers of Muslim organisations say that they expect such a decision to help curb the political exploitation of the issue of cow slaughter, and will put an end to incidents of mob lynching and other atrocities in the name of the animal.



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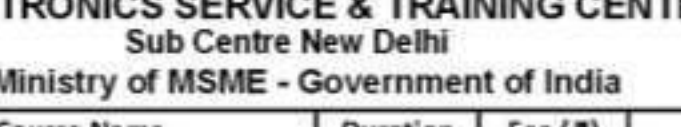
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SMART Move

FIVE MONTHS after Prime Minister Narendra Modi urged police forces to adopt the 'SMART policing' mantra — strategic, meticulous, adaptable, reliable and transparent — during the all-India Conference of DGPs and IGPs, the Delhi Police has moved to roll out the idea across the city. A soft copy of a poster prepared by the force's Perception Management and Media Cell, bearing the SMART acronym and the Prime Minister's photograph, has been circulated to all the DCPs in the Capital with the instruction to print and display it at police stations, units and other police premises.

Office turns War Room

A CONGRESS office in a state capital where elections are due early next year saw some high-voltage drama on Saturday as a senior state leader and the head of the party war room got into a physical altercation. While no statements have been made in public by either person, party leaders in the state have been talking in whispers about the incident. The altercation, according to sources, was over a text message sent by the war room head to an MP over a political programme. While the incident has resulted in tension in the state unit, the Congress high command and senior leadership are mostly oblivious of the incident, said the sources.

Placement Suspense

THE IPS trainees of 2025 batch — they cleared the civil services exam in 2024 — are facing a unique problem. May is about to end and they have not yet been allotted their state cadres. What is leading to the unease is that their IAS counterparts have already been allotted their cadres. For the IPS trainees, even the state-wise vacancies, a necessary step for cadre allotment, have not yet been released. The challenge is that an officer can be allotted any state in the country and needs to undertake cadre studies to pick up the language of the state and its policing culture. After their passing out parade in October — the end of phase 1 of training — this year, the IPS officers will be sent for district training in the state cadre they are allotted. They should ideally know the language before that happens for the district training to be useful. The endless suspense over the cadres they will be allotted is the main buzz at the Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel National Police Academy at Hyderabad right now.

Live-in rules, polygamy ban: Assam introduces UCC Bill

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, May 25

LESS THAN two weeks after the second Himanta Biswa Sarma-led NDA government took oath in Assam, it has introduced a Uniform Civil Code Bill for the state, following the templates of those in Uttarakhand and Gujarat, including compulsory registration of live-in relationships and penal provisions for non-compliance.

The 154-page Bill introduced Monday drew criticism from opposition parties Congress, Rajiv Dal and TMC, which demanded wider consultations before it was tabled. It will come up for discussion and consideration later this week.

The Bill states that its aim is to "govern and regulate the laws relating to marriage and divorce, succession, live-in relationships, and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto". It states that the proposed legislation will extend to the whole of Assam and "applies to residents of Assam who reside outside the territories to which the code extends." However, it exempts Scheduled Tribes, whose population in Assam stood at 12.44% in the 2011 Census.

Over the last few years, the NDA government has enacted multiple legislations relating to marriage, including the Assam Prohibition of Polygamy Act 2025 and the Compulsory Registration of Muslim Marriages



Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma meets Bhutan PM Tshering Tobgay on Monday. A minister said the visit is expected to open new avenues of goodwill between Assam and Bhutan. PTI

and Divorces Act 2024. The UCC Bill seeks to build on these by setting out conditions for marriage, including that the man must be at least 21 years old and the woman 18. It also requires that neither party has a spouse living at the time of marriage, and that neither is party to a marriage that has not yet been dissolved or annulled by a decree of divorce. It also requires that "neither party has given consent to the marriage by force, coercion, deception or fraud"; and that the parties are not "within the degrees of prohibited relationship". The Bill lists 37 such 'prohibited relationships' — including first cousins.

The draft law seeks to mandate the registration of all marriages, where at least one of the parties is a resident of the state, with an appointed sub-registrar within 60 days of the marriage. Similarly, it seeks to mandate the

registration of all divorces within 60 days of the decree.

The most extensive part of the Bill relates to succession. A note by the Assam government highlights the provisions for devolution of the estate of a person who dies intestate — or without a legal will — saying that it "creates a uniform, gender-equal order of preference for intestate inheritance among Class-I heirs, which equitably includes the spouse, children, and parents of the deceased".

Like in Uttarakhand and Gujarat, a critical part of the Bill relates to live-in relationships, requiring their registration within the state with an appointed sub-registrar. It even extends to "any resident(s) of Assam staying in a live-in relationship outside the territory of the state" to "the Sub-Registrar within whose jurisdiction such resident(s) ordinarily resides."

Vijay's TVK eyes solo majority as AIADMK wilts under 'Op L'

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, May 25

DAYS AFTER abandoning negotiations to induct rebel AIADMK legislators into the Cabinet, the ruling Tamilaga Vettir Kazhagam (TVK) has begun what leaders across Tamil Nadu politics are privately describing as a far more ambitious project: reducing its dependence on allies altogether and pushing solely towards the important number of 118 in the House.

The first visible move came Monday. Three AIADMK MLAs — S Jayakumar from Perundurai, K Maragatham Kumaravel from Madurantakam (SC), and P Sathyabama from Dharapuram (SC) — resigned from the Assembly and met TVK minister Aadhav Arjuna before formally joining the ruling party. Officially, they resigned as legislators. Politically, they appeared to be volunteering for a different experiment: contesting again under Vijay's "whistle" symbol in the subsequent by-elections.

And inside political corridors, the operation already has a nickname. "Operation L," said a former AIADMK minister close to party general secretary Edappadi K Palaniswami, smiling carefully when asked what the "L" stood for. "Lottery. Or Leema. Or Leave. Read it whichever way you want," he quipped. The remark, which came from a visibly upset AIADMK leader, was laced with bitterness, sarcasm and frustration. It was a reference to the alleged role of politically connected financial networks, the powerful Arjuna (the son-in-law of the Lottery baron Santiago Martin) within the TVK, and the



Maragatham Kumaravel, Sathyabama, and Jayakumar with other TVK leaders in Chennai. PTI

financially powerful presence of AIADMK MLA Leema Rose Martin (Martin's wife), who is seen by sections within the party as favouring an arrangement with the TVK coalition. It was also a dark pun on the AIADMK's "Two Leaves" symbol, suggesting that with legislators steadily "leaving", one of the leaves itself was being peeled away.

According to TVK and AIADMK sources, Vijay's party has internally shifted from coalition arithmetic to majority arithmetic. The numbers explain the urgency. The TVK currently has an effective strength of 107 MLAs after Vijay vacated one of the two seats he won. The party governs comfortably for now with support from the Congress, CPI, CPI(M), VCK and IUML. But several senior leaders inside TVK increasingly believe a first-generation party built around a single charismatic leader cannot remain permanently dependent on post-pol allies.

The target, therefore, is straightforward: 118 MLAs from TVK alone. With the Trichy East by-election already inevitable

following Vijay's resignation there, TVK strategists now believe synchronised by-elections in multiple constituencies could slowly transform the coalition government into a de facto single-party government. "If these seats go together, momentum matters," said a senior TVK functionary. According to top TVK sources, at least seven or eight more MLAs are expected to resign in the coming weeks.

The political irony is striking. Only days ago, the same AIADMK rebel faction led by C Ve Shanmugham and S P Velumani believed they were negotiating entry into Vijay's Cabinet. Several rounds of discussions reportedly revolved around ministerial allocations before the TVK abruptly abandoned the idea under pressure from the Left parties, VCK and sections within its own leadership. Now many rebels feel stranded.

The AIADMK increasingly resembles two parallel rescue operations happening simultaneously. One group is resigning. Another — the rebel faction — is finding ways to reconcile with EPS's leadership.

The proposed legislation says such a relationship will not be registered if the partners are "within the degrees of prohibited relationship", if either person is married or already in another live-in relationship, if either is a minor, or if "the consent of one of the partners was obtained by force, coercion, undue influence, misrepresentation or fraud as to any material fact or circumstance concerning the other partner, including her/his identity".

It proposes penalising those who stay in such a relationship for more than a month without submitting a statement to the sub-registrar, with imprisonment upon conviction for up to three months or a fine of up to Rs 10,000, or both. It proposes a greater penalty of up to six months' imprisonment and a fine of up to Rs 25,000 if the sub-registrar receives "a complaint or information" on an unregistered relationship, sends the couple a notice to submit a statement of their relationship, and they fail to do so.

It also seeks to require the submission of a "statement of termination in the prescribed format and in the prescribed manner to the Sub-Registrar" at the end of such a relationship, and enables a woman "deserted" by her live-in partner to claim maintenance. It says "any child of a live-in relationship shall be a legitimate child of the couple."

'Don't take it so sentimentally': CJI on plea against 'CJP'

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 25

AMID THE social media chatter over 'Cockroach Janta Party', founded as a satirical response to his remark on those who "attack the system", Chief Justice of India Surya Kant on Monday asked a lawyer not to take the issue "sentimentally".

Raising a PIL, the lawyers said a malicious narrative was being used to malign the judiciary despite a clarification by the CJI. The PIL seeks directions that courtroom exchanges not be used for commercial purposes. A separate PIL has sought an investigation into the activities associated with the 'Cockroach Janta Party'.

"Even after the clarification of the Hon'ble CJI, a distorted and malicious narrative is being (spread)", The Chief Justice replied, "Don't take it so sentimentally". The Chief Justice turned down a plea for an urgent hearing on the PILs.

Earlier this month, pulling up a lawyer, CJI Kant compared unemployed youth drifting into journalism and activism with the insect. The remarks drew criticism, following which the CJI clarified: "What I had specifically criticised were those who have entered professions like the Bar (legal profession) with the aid of fake and bogus degrees. Similar persons have sneaked into the media, social media, and other noble professions as well, and hence, they are like parasites. It is totally baseless to suggest that I criticised the youth of our nation."

'NOT CONFINED TO SOCIAL MEDIA, WE'RE ON THE GROUND'

Buzz over 'CJP' has Youth Congress's antennae up: 'We are the real cockroaches'

Manoj CG
New Delhi, May 25

COCKROACHES ARE incredibly resilient insects that have been around for hundreds of millions of years, by some estimates since the time of dinosaurs. Over the past couple of weeks, they have dominated the news cycle, with satirical online platform Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) raising the government's hackles and inviting a ban on its social media accounts.

While the cat-and-mouse game between the government and the CJP goes on — it returned to X with an alternative account — there is another claimant for the mantle of the "real cockroach". Congress's youth wing, the Indian Youth Congress (IYC), has got in on the act through memes and songs via its alternative X account, the Indian Youth Cockroaches, and a website. And to emphasise that it is different and the real deal, it also had a message for the CJP.

"Real cockroaches are not just online revolutionaries. You have to be on the ground and fight the system," read one of the IYC's social media posts on Sunday, accompanied by a video clip of a Youth Congress protest in Surat against the BJP-led Centre over the NEET paper leak. The message was clear: it is not just a satirical platform confined to the online world. Another post the day before had taken a jab at the CJP's founder, Abhijit Dipke, who is Boston-based. "Indian Youth Cockroaches > Boston Cockroach," it read. And on Monday, the Congress-backed account posted more videos of protests by "real cockroaches".

While the IYC has been flooding its social media handles with memes and songs, its leaders claim they are neither playing catch-up with the CJP nor copying it. They say the outfit has been protesting against Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan over the NEET paper leak since it came to light. It held a press conference on May 12 and organised a street protest the following day.

The cockroach entered the



Youth Congress president Uday Bhanu Chib (right) during a protest over the NEET row in Bengaluru last week. PTI

Indian political lexicon on May 15 when CJI Surya Kant compared unemployed youth drifting into journalism and activism with the insect. The remarks drew criticism, following which the CJI clarified that it is "totally baseless" to suggest that he criticised the youth. "What I had specifically criticised were those who have entered professions like the Bar (legal profession) with the aid of fake and bogus degrees. Similar persons have sneaked into the media, social media, and other noble professions as well, and hence, they are like parasites. It is totally baseless to suggest that I criticised the youth of our nation," he had said.

The IYC claims it got to work on a website — that has since been taken down — but Dipke's website went live a day before its site did. "It got traction because some politicians endorsed his website and it exploded on the internet," said IYC's social media head Manu Jain.

The Youth Congress says it has been churning out cockroach memes from May 16 onwards. But the outfit was perhaps a day too late and got eclipsed by Dipke's platform and the subsequent controversy generated by the ban on its account. The Youth Congress, its leader says, came out with something called the "Cockroach Times" on May 16 itself.

"We are not in a competition with anybody. We are the real cockroaches on the ground fighting for the youth, be it on NEET or on the issue of unem-

ployment. Most of the AI videos that the CJP is using are created by us. We are taking the lead," Jain said, emphasising the difference between his outfit's efforts and that of Dipke. "We are the ones who are fighting on the streets and facing cases every day. So we call ourselves the real cockroaches."

"Our website was blocked by the government, but now we are back with another website, youthcockroach.org. Our website is up and we are trying to connect with the youth," Jain said.

IYC president Uday Bhanu Chib also emphasised the difference between the two "cockroaches". "We laid a siege to Education Minister Pradhan's residence. All our state units have been holding protests," he said. He said the organisation's social media wing could be using the cockroach theme to tap into the algorithm. "We are not confined to social media; we are on the ground," he said.

While the Congress or its top leadership has so far not weighed in on the satirical movement, many in the party believe that millions following the CJP's handles on social media, especially Instagram, shows there is underlying anger and disenchantment among the youth that the mainstream Opposition has not been able to tap into. A section of the leadership also believes that the youth and student wings of the party should be more dynamic and fleet-footed.

'What is a cockroach's life span?' Haryana CM's jibe at platform

Liz Mathew
New Delhi, May 25

REJECTING SUGGESTIONS of disenchantment among the youth, Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Monday alleged that the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), a satirical political platform recently launched by digital strategist Abhijit Dipke, was another narrative manufactured by the Opposition. Comparing it to the "Constitution in danger" campaign ahead of the 2024 Lok Sabha polls, Saini said the movement would be short-lived.

"Cockroach ki ayu kitni hai (what is the lifespan of a cockroach)?" the Chief Minister said when asked about the CJP and the traction it has gained on social media.

"I interacted with youth this



Nayab Singh Saini at an event on Monday. @NAYABSAINIBJP

morning as well. I spoke to many of them. But I did not see any disappointment among them. Not even one young person told me he was frustrated," Saini said at an interaction in the national capital.

"The Opposition had built a narrative before the Lok Sabha elections that the Constitution would be in danger if the BJP

crossed 400 seats. The Congress leader who carries a copy of the Constitution and says it is under threat has forgotten how many times his own party altered it in the past. I do not know who writes the script for him," Saini said, referring to the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi.

"In the last 11-and-a-half years, Prime Minister Narendra Modi has taken several steps to protect the Constitution. When Article 370 was abrogated, he was protecting the Constitution to ensure 'One nation, one Constitution,'" the CM claimed.

Ahead of the 2024 Lok Sabha elections, the Opposition INDIA bloc led by the Congress had campaigned on the claim that the BJP's target of winning 400-plus seats was aimed at changing the Constitution.

BJD adrift, BJP govt left unchallenged in Odisha — and a clear path ahead

CAPITAL CONTEXT BY LIZ MATHEW

A WEEKLY LOOK AT POLITICS IN A STATE FROM THE VANTAGE POINT OF NEW DELHI

AS THE BJP attempted to figure out what went wrong in the 2024 Lok Sabha polls, one of the states that must have provided it some solace is Odisha. The party managed to unseat former ally BJD, which had been in power since 2000, and marked its entry into the first major eastern state.

Months before the crucial panchayat elections in the state in early 2027, the BJP appears unfazed, with no force visible on the ground that can challenge it. The BJD, however, remains in a precarious position — its domi-

nance of state politics for more than two decades is now a thing of the past — and the Congress is in doldrums. While former Congress MLA Mohammed Moqim launched a new regional political party called the Odisha Janata Congress, it has failed to have any impact and speculation about a new outfit by the disgruntled BJD leaders also turned out to be a false alarm.

In such a scenario, the panchayat elections will provide an insight into the political landscape of the state, showing if the BJD can arrest its slide and put up a fight against the BJP and if other alternatives can emerge.

The BJP appears to be well ahead of its rivals because of the TINA (there is no alternative) factor. "The government is not popular and the BJP is losing its

support on the ground. Naveen Patnaik's political future, given his age, is uncertain and a third front or a third force is still a non-starter. Odisha is left without a choice," said author-journalist Ruben Banerjee, who has written a book on Patnaik.

CM Mohan Charan Majhi, who was a surprise choice for the top post, still has not been able to win people's hearts, several BJP leaders from the state said. "He is accessible, but does not wield power. However, in internal politics, he seems to be emerging as a winner thanks to the support he is getting from the top leadership as well as the RSS," said an insider.

For Patnaik, the problem continues to be his former secretary V K Pandian, who was blamed by many in the party for



PM Narendra Modi meets CM Mohan Charan Majhi on Monday. PTI

the 2024 rout. Pandian had taken control of the BJD in the run-up to the elections, but the knives came out in the aftermath of the loss, with several BJD leaders citing Patnaik's excessive dependence on him. The fear of the Tamil Nadu-born bureaucrat-turned-politician

becoming Patnaik's official successor eclipsed the BJD's electoral prospects, his detractors alleged. With the criticism mounting, Patnaik stepped away from the limelight and receded to the background soon afterwards.

But he was not gone. Pan-

dian, it is learnt, continues to remain close to the former CM and calls the shots in the BJD even now. A party leader said Pandian's continued presence at Naveen Niwas, the former CM's residence, puts a "question mark" on the party's future.

"It is like Naveen Patnaik has pressed the eject button. You do not know where the party is going. However, the party is not crumbling at the ground level. The cadre are there. You just need one promising leader..." said a leader.

Many BJD leaders hold out hope, saying the party held on to its vote share in the 2024 Assembly elections in the face of a BJP surge. They also take solace from history, holding out hope for a BJD return as Odisha's political ground has always been a fertile

one for regional parties.

The cracks in the BJD were for all to see in the Rajya Sabha elections held in March in which businessman and former Union Minister Dilip Ray, an Independent backed by the BJP, won against the BJD-Congress combine because of cross-voting. The moves of Ray and BJD co-founder Bijoy Mohapatra led to speculation that a new outfit made up of disgruntled BJD leaders could be in the offing.

However, BJP sources said Ray is unlikely to upset the BJP apple cart. "A new regional party can make space in Odisha politics only if it is founded by an acceptable leader... Otherwise, the BJP will go unchallenged as there is no force visible on the horizon as of now," said a former MP from the state.

RS MP quits BJD; set to join BJP

SENIOR BJD leader and Rajya Sabha MP Debashish Samantaray, who had earlier accused the party of "deviating from its core ideology", resigned from the party Monday — the third leader to do so since the BJD lost power in Odisha in 2024. He is set to join the BJP soon, sources said.

Samantaray met Rajya Sabha Chairman and Vice-President C P Radhakrishnan and tendered his resignation. In his resignation letter to party president Naveen Patnaik, Samantaray said he had been "systematically belittled in the party". ENS



US Secretary of State Marco Rubio with his wife, Jeanette Rubio, at the Taj Mahal on Monday. AP

Rubio visits Taj Mahal, Amber Fort with US envoy Gor

Press Trust of India

Agra, Jaipur, New Delhi, May 25

US SECRETARY of State Marco Rubio on Monday visited the Taj Mahal in Agra and the Amber Fort in Jaipur along with his wife Jeanette Rubio and US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor, ahead of the crucial Quad foreign ministers' meeting on Tuesday.

"Thank You For Allowing Us To Visit One Of The Love Treasures Of The World," Rubio wrote in the visitors' book.

The visit to the Taj was followed by a trip to the Amber Fort in Jaipur, where the Rubios were given a traditional Rajasthani welcome at the 16th-century monument and

attended cultural performances featuring folk dances.

In Agra, he spent around an hour at the 17th-century marble mausoleum and had pictures taken there. Security was tightened around the UNESCO World Heritage site during the high-profile visit, and tourists already present inside the complex were temporarily asked to move out by security personnel, officials said.

In Jaipur, tour guide Mahesh Kumar Sharma, who took the Rubios around the fort, told PTI that the visit lasted nearly half an hour. He said the US Secretary of State showed particular interest in the fort's water management system and enquired about the source of water supply.

Budgam: Local man arrested in 12-yr-old's rape-murder case

Naveed Iqbal

Srinagar, May 25

A DAY after the body of a 12-year-old girl was found in the Budgam district of central Kashmir, J&K Police arrested a 30-year-old man in connection with the case. On Sunday, police had said that prima facie, it was a case of rape and murder.

Budgam SSP Hariprasad K said Monday that after the child's body was found Sunday, "We started a murder investigation under section 103 of BNSS. Within 36 hours, Budgam police carried out an extended search of the area. Through this, we found material evidence, digital and serological evidence."

Police said that several suspects were picked up, and the demeanour of one suspect was called into question. "Upon examination, evidence has corroborated his involvement in the crime. Name of the accused is Mudassir Ahmad Mir, a local," the SSP said. The accused was later formally arrested.

The SSP claimed the accused "admitted his involvement in the crime" when he was confronted with evidence. "On his disclosure, more material evidence has been recovered," the officers said.

A five-member SIT consti-

tuted on Sunday is continuing its investigation into the case.

According to the officer, the girl had left home on Saturday evening but did not return. The family lodged a missing persons report with the police late on Saturday night, and the body was found early on Sunday morning, around 200 metres from her house.

With regard to the law and order situation, SSP Hariprasad made an appeal to the public to continue their cooperation with police. "We understand your pain, but I would request that this pain be expressed responsibly. Justice is taking its course. We have solved this within 36 hours."

A parallel FIR has been registered at the Budgam police station against revealing the identity of the victim. The SSP urged those sharing pictures or details about the victim to remove those from their online platforms.

The case caused a stir in J&K with all sections of society criticising the incident. Expressing shock and distress, Chief Minister Omar Abdullah had underscored that while the appropriate agencies enquire into the circumstances of her murder, "it's also fitting that we reflect on where we as a society are headed when our young children are not safe."

JAPAN'S MOTEKI, AUSTRALIA'S WONG REACH DELHI; FMs WILL ALSO MEET PM MODI

Energy, maritime security in focus, Quad meets today

Shubhajit Roy

New Delhi, May 25

THE FOREIGN ministers of the Quad grouping will meet on Tuesday and are expected to discuss critical minerals, maritime and energy security, sources told *The Indian Express*.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar will host Foreign Minister of Australia Penny Wong, Foreign Minister of Japan Toshimitsu Motegi and United States Secretary of State Marco Rubio for the meeting at Hyderabad House.

The Quad foreign ministers will also call on Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Sources said the war in West Asia has impacted maritime security and energy security – that will be one of the challenges and concerns which will be discussed during the meeting.

Besides, the four maritime democracies are concerned at the impact of the closure of Strait of Hormuz, and how that will impact freedom of navigation across the chokepoints in the world, including in the Indo-Pacific. So, in that context, the ministers are expected to re-commit to a free and open Indo-

E. EXPLAINED

Clear signal of US commitment

US-CHINA engagement, led by President Donald Trump, has led to some concerns that Quad is not a priority. Rubio's attendance at the Quad foreign ministers' meeting is aimed at sending signals about US commitment. Ultimately, proof of the commitment will be on the outcomes and deliverables.

Pacific – at a time when China is observing the chokehold on the Strait of Hormuz and its impact.

This concern is significant since much of the movement of critical minerals and semiconductors are carried through maritime traffic and their disruption can cause supply-chain challenges in the world's race in the AI industry.

These issues are expected to be discussed by the ministers, who had last met in July 2025 in Washington DC – when Rubio

had hosted the Quad foreign ministers as his first diplomatic engagement after assuming office in January last year. Both meetings were held in the US, hosted by Rubio.

The US Secretary of State is in India for a bilateral visit, and went on a sightseeing trip on Monday to Agra and Jaipur. He held bilateral talks with Jaishankar on Sunday.

Japanese Foreign Minister Motegi Toshimitsu and Australian Foreign Minister Penny Wong arrived in Delhi on Monday. While meeting Motegi, Jaishankar said, "India and Japan have a special strategic and global partnership and that signals that our ties have a larger implication, larger importance and larger impact." He also mentioned the upcoming Quad meeting and said they will discuss how to advance a free and open Indo-Pacific.

In the talks, the two sides deliberated on bilateral cooperation, global and regional issues, especially the West Asia crisis and its impact on energy supply chains.

Jaishankar suggested that both India and Japan are impacted by the conflict as both

are energy importing and trading nations and have maritime interests.

Wong, who reached Delhi in the evening, said, "In these uncertain times, the Quad is a vital partnership – four nations working together to shape a peaceful, stable and prosperous future for the Indo-Pacific region. Together, Australia, India, Japan and the United States are delivering concrete outcomes on shared interests including maritime security, critical minerals supply, infrastructure development and disaster relief."

She will meet Jaishankar for the bilateral meeting on Tuesday evening, and said, "Australia and India's partnership has never been more consequential."

She added: "As Comprehensive Strategic Partners, Australia and India are deepening cooperation in trade and investment, defence and maritime security, climate and energy transition, strategic technology, and education and skills; with an enduring social connection at the heart of our partnership."

This meet will also pave the way for Quad leaders' summit later this year.

• BRIEFLY



Jaisalmer Municipal Council issued a statement saying it had taken cognisance of the matter and blacklisted the contractor. EXPRESS

RAJASTHAN

Rotting cow carcasses dumped at Jaisalmer landfill spark outrage

Rotting cow carcasses at a municipal landfill in Rajasthan's Jaisalmer have sparked allegations of negligence, prompting the civic body to terminate the local contractor's services. Videos from a landfill on Ramgarh Road, around 7 km from the district headquarters, circulating on social media showed hundreds of rotting carcasses, with residents and cow protection groups demanding immediate action. As pressure mounted, the Jaisalmer Municipal Council issued a statement saying it had taken cognisance of the matter and blacklisted the contractor, Goparam, a resident of Suwala in Barmer. The council cited gross violations to cancel his contract.

ENS

Rajasthan HC extends Asaram's bail until July 7

THE RAJASTHAN High Court on Monday extended the bail of self-styled godman Asaram Babu, serving a life sentence for rape of a minor at his ashram in 2013, till July 7 on medical grounds. A division bench of Acting Chief Justice Sanjeev Prakash Sharma and Justice Yogendra Kumar Purohit extended the bail which was initially granted to Asaram on October 29 last year, and which was extended till May 25 on April 29. In its October order, the court had said: "It can be seen that the accused petitioner is in a vegetative condition."

ENS

Teenager hacked to death near Madurai temple

A 17-YEAR-OLD boy was hacked to death by a five-member gang near the Mee-nakshi Sundareswarar Temple in Madurai during the early hours of Monday. The victim, identified as Gu-bendran of North Masi Street, was attacked near a corporation-run parking complex on North Avani Moola Street, close to the temple premises, police said. According to sources, the assault took place around 4 am, when a group that arrived on two motorcycles surrounded the teenager and hacked him repeatedly with deadly weapons before fleeing the area.

ENS

'Mohammad' Deepak's gym faces closure as he struggles to repay loan

Aiswarya Raj

Dehradun, May 25

MONTHS AFTER he was threatened by right-wing groups for taking a stand against the harassment of an elderly Muslim shopkeeper, Deepak Kumar, now popularly known as "Mohammad Deepak", faces the prospect of losing the gym that he has been running.

On January 26, Deepak (38) stood up to a group of men who were harassing a 70-year-old Muslim shopkeeper, who suffers from Parkinson's disease. The group were demanding that the elderly man drop the word "Baba" from his shop's name.

When Deepak intervened, people from the group asked him his name, to which he replied, "Mohammad Deepak".

A video of the incident went viral, thrusting Deepak into the limelight but also bringing unwanted attention. On January 31, several members of the

Bajrang Dal gathered to confront Deepak, but were restrained by the police.

Following the incidents, reports emerged that several people had stopped showing up at Deepak's gym — with membership falling from 150 to just 15.

The "economic boycott" had a significant impact, leaving Kumar unable to meet the monthly rent of Rs 40,000 for the space from which he runs the gym.

The instalments to be paid for a loan he took to build a house have also been affected.

He said the owner of the building where his gym is housed has asked him to vacate after he failed to pay rent for four months.

"I have not been able to consistently pay the rent."

Although a group of lawyers had offered to pay annual membership fees for the gym, Deepak said, "It required more to keep the gym running".

President confers 66 Padma Awards

Achievers and experts from various fields were honoured with the Padma Awards in the Capital on Monday. President Droupadi Murmu conferred two Padma Vibhushan, six Padma Bhushan and 58 Padma Shri awards. The event, held at Rashtrapati Bhavan, was attended by Vice-President C P Radhakrishnan, Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah, among others. Praising the awardees, PM Modi said India's strength lies in such remarkable individuals whose work "enriches our collective journey".

PHOTOS BY RENUKA PURI



President Droupadi Murmu confers Padma Vibhushan on classical musician and violinist N Rajam (Left); former Uttarakhand CM Bhagat Singh Koshiyari receives Padma Bhushan at Rashtrapati Bhavan on Monday



Indian women's cricket team captain Harmanpreet Kaur receives Padma Shri



Actor Prosenjit Chatterjee being conferred with Padma Shri



Folk artist Dharmiklal Chunilal Pandya greets PM Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah as he arrives to receive Padma Shri



Kotak Mahindra Bank founder Uday Kotak receives Padma Bhushan from President Droupadi Murmu on Monday

PIPAVAV PROJECT CASE

Citizen groups push back against SC remarks on green activists & 'stalling'

Jay Mazoomdaar

New Delhi, May 25

GROUPS OF former civil servants, lawyers, legal and environmental activists have issued open letters criticising Chief Justice Of India Surya Kant's remarks last week about attempts by "alleged environmentalists and activists" to stall development projects.

On May 11, a bench comprising CJI Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi heard a plea challenging the National Green Tribunal's (NGT) dismissal of an appeal against the environmental clearance (EC) granted for the expansion of Pipavav Port in Gujarat.

The CJI-led bench granted partial relief. "Although we are

not inclined to agree... that the NGT has dismissed the appeal without assigning any reasons, we grant liberty to the appellant to move a review application before the NGT," it ordered.

However, the CJI's observations during the hearing prompted a pushback.

"Show us even a single project in this country where these alleged environmentalists and activists say we welcome this project," the CJI observed, adding, "Everything you drag to the court." His other observations included: "In this country, this kind of litigation is filed only to stall all development projects. That is the problem"; "See, you people don't want ports to be expanded. How is the country going to progress"; "You went to

NGT and unfortunately that creates a lot of doubts on bona fide. You don't go to any authority pointing out that I am an expert, I find that these are the deficiencies... if at all you are an expert. You are some RTI activist, you are so-and-so activist, an environmentalist, you have so many degrees... Jahan daav Lage wahin (Wherever the opportunities are...)"

In an open letter released on May 22, 71 members of the Constitution Conduct Group, a platform for former civil servants, pointed out that the CJI's remarks may "weaken environmental and conservation safeguards in the country, and influence lower courts to also adopt similar attitudes".

The letter underlined that

"most of the expert and statutory bodies set up by the Environment Ministry... consist only of government or retired government officials" and urged the Supreme Court not to place "blind faith in these appraisal bodies which act as rubber stamps for the government".

The same day, another letter signed by over 600 citizens and civil society groups from across the country said the remarks "risk portraying citizens who seek lawful scrutiny of environmental decision-making as a suspect constituency".

Last Tuesday, 72 members of the National Alliance for Justice, Accountability & Rights, a platform for legal professionals, wrote to the CJI: "Environmental PIL is a jurisdiction cre-

ated and legitimised by the Court itself to scrutinise executive action. To frame recourse to it as a tactic of stalling undermines the spirit of Articles 32 and 226." The environmental clearance for the proposed expansion of Pipavav Port, which was issued in June 2012, expired in June 2024. It was renewed in July 2025 without considering certain contradictions in the project's Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) report and the developer's failure to initiate expansion work due to lack of financial viability, the appellant alleged before the NGT.

On November 26, 2025, the NGT dismissed the appeal at the admission stage.

Before the Supreme Court on May 11, the petitioner argued

that the 45-page NGT order reproduced the project's EIA report across 41 pages before dismissing his appeal "perfunctorily", and sought a hearing on merits.

The bench, however, pointed out that 14 experts of the "highest rank" had conducted the EIA process.

"See how many experts are involved. Do you think (the) NGT is better than these people," the CJI asked, adding that the single expert member on an NGT bench "cannot do anything" about EIAs prepared by so many experts.

However, the appellant's petition underlined that, as an expert adjudicatory body vested with appellate jurisdiction, the NGT was duty-bound to under-

take a merits review, in line with the principle set in 2019 by the SC in Hanuman Laxman Aroskar vs Union of India. "In the present case, the Tribunal has merely relied on the process conducted by EAC and its recommendations, abdicating its own jurisdiction to conduct a merits review," the petition further said a summary dismissal of an appeal goes against the Delhi High Court ruling in Bright Enterprises versus MJ Bizcraft LLP (2017). "A court may feel that the case of a plaintiff is weak but that is no ground whatsoever for throwing out the suit lock, stock and barrel without giving the plaintiff an opportunity of proving and establishing its case."

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Punjabi singer held with 5 kg heroin

Express News Service

Ludhiana, May 25

PUNJABI SINGER Harbeer Singh Sohal has been arrested following the recovery of 5.1 kg heroin and Rs 1.50 lakh cash from his vehicle, a Punjab Police officer on Monday said. The singer was allegedly a "courier" in a drug supply racket allegedly being operated by handlers based in Australia and Canada, said Khanna SSP Darpan Ahluwalia.

Harbeer was earlier arrested by the Mohali police in an extortion racket in 2022, Ahluwalia said, adding the fresh action against him comes following a probe into a March 7 drug trafficking case. Sohal is a resident of village Bhindi Saidan in Amritsar and is currently residing in Kharar in Mohali.





Rescue operations underway at Gulmarg Gondola after the cable car service stopped due to a technical fault on Monday. ANI

Gulmarg cable car snag: 320 stranded tourists rescued in 6-hr operation

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, May 25

THE GULMARG Gondola, the cable car service that takes tourists to the upper reaches of the tourist destination, developed a technical snag on Monday amid inclement weather, leaving over 300 people stranded mid-air for hours before they were rescued.

Director General of J&K Police, Nalin Prabhat, who was monitoring the situation late evening on Monday, said 320 people were rescued in efforts by police, Army and other rescue personnel.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah congratulated those involved in the rescue efforts, saying in a post on X, “Applause to India’s disaster response forces for safely rescuing 300 tourists stranded mid-air in cable cars in Gulmarg, Kashmir. The disaster response teams comprising the SDRF, NDRF, Army personnel, local police, and the administration swung into action and rescued all the passengers stranded in 65 cable cars through a six-hour-long operation. The nation salutes the forces for their valour and skill.”

A total of 65 cabins were stuck along the cables following the technical snag. The incident came to light just after 1 pm on Monday.

Zipline horror: Teen falls 45 feet to death in Agra in front of family

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, May 25

A 16-YEAR-OLD boy on Sunday fell 45 feet to his death during a zipline ride at Agra Chaupati, when the pulley lock allegedly snapped. Police said the zipline malfunctioned just moments after Kunal Agarwal had set off, causing him to fall barely 10 feet from the starting point.

Kunal, a resident of Firozabad, had travelled to Agra with his parents for a family outing. After visiting the Taj Mahal, the family was preparing to return home when Kunal repeatedly urged them to let him try the zipline attraction at Agra Chaupati, a popular adventure zone, in Tajnagri Phase-2.

Police said Kunal was excited as he stepped onto the zipline platform, while his parents and younger brother stood a short distance away watching him. Seconds after he set off, a video shows the teenager suddenly plunging from the height, hitting a platform, before falling to the ground.

Panic spread as family members and bystanders rushed to his aid before he was taken to a nearby hospital, where doctors declared him dead on arrival.

Senior Jharkhand Police officials told *The Indian Express* that if Badal Murmu is still alive, efforts to trace him would continue. A CRPF constable of the 197 Battalion, Badal Murmu, originally from Saraikela-Kharsawan district, was posted at the Kiriburu base camp when he

hope are fading quickly. Jhano says that for almost three years, after every surrender, she hoped that officials would come with “positive news” about her husband. She has submitted multiple letters to the President of India and met the Union Home Minister in person in 2024, but she says there has been no movement in the effort to trace her husband.

Senior Jharkhand Police officials told *The Indian Express* that if Badal Murmu is still alive, efforts to trace him would continue. A CRPF constable of the 197 Battalion, Badal Murmu, originally from Saraikela-Kharsawan district, was posted at the Kiriburu base camp when he

became anxious. “Then, on January 7, two jawans came and asked us about Badal,” she says, adding that this confirmed that he was missing.

Later, the family was informed by locals from Tumbahaka that they had witnessed Badal being held hostage by Misir Besra’s troops.

Patriotic, athletic From the Santal community, Badal was a good athlete who dreamed of joining the Indian Army. “Because of his patriotic feelings, he was always fond of joining the armed forces,” says Mangovind Murmu, 40, Badal’s elder brother, who is a BSF constable.

Mangovind tells *The Indian Express* that their father, a farmer, died in 2024 after his health deteriorated while waiting for his son to return.

He says both he and his brother studied hard and joined the armed forces.

Badal married Jhano in 2018 after returning to Chaibasa following multiple transfers. After joining the CRPF in 2010, he was posted in Srinagar, then Manipur, and later in Chhattisgarh’s Bastar division, where one of his legs was injured in an IED blast during an anti-Maoist operation in 2017. In 2021, he received a gallantry award from the President of India for participating in an operation against Maoists in the Pidiya and Gottapalli forest areas near the Bijapur-Sukma border in Chhattisgarh.

Badal’s brother says the family has been running from pillar to post for three years in their effort to try and trace him.

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‘A complete health check-up’: IIT-M director on CBSE probe

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
New Delhi, May 25

A DAY after Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan announced that teams from IITs would help the CBSE navigate mounting complaints over its new digital evaluation system, IIT Madras Director V Kamakoti said the institute has dispatched a technical team to Delhi to investigate what went wrong with the Board’s re-evaluation portal and to conduct what he described as a “complete health check-up” of the system.

“Today, there was a glitch in the payment. People were able to apply, but they were not able to pay,” Kamakoti told *The Indian Express* on Monday, referring to technical failures students faced while applying for post-result services.

Explaining the nature of the intervention, Kamakoti said the IIT team would examine whether the failures stemmed from infrastructure problems, software deployment issues, or even a potential cyberattack.

“We just go and do a complete health check-up of the website, and also find the root cause analysis, what went wrong, so that in future... they would be careful,” he said. “We will give them certain guidelines on how to deploy, what sort of tests could have been done, was it a problem with the Internet at that point of time, was it some other issue.”

Kamakoti added that IIT-Madras was also looking into whether the portal may have faced a denial-of-service attack. “Maybe it’s a cyberattack also. Some person on that day could have launched a lot of packets, like what you call denial of service,” he said.

According to Kamakoti, IIT-Madras has sent “one faculty and one project staff” member to work from the CBSE headquarters in Delhi.

The project staff member, he said, would help with “data analytics and analysing logs” and a faculty member who he described as “very senior people” who had handled “a lot of work in this direction.”

“Technologies are changing and unfortunately there is always an assault on the education system,” he added. The intervention comes amid one of the most turbulent result seasons the CBSE has faced in recent years after the Board introduced a sweeping overhaul of its Class 12 evaluation system.

For the first time, CBSE shifted entirely to an On-Screen Marking (OSM) system, replacing traditional paper-based evaluation with digital assessment. Concerns over the rollout had surfaced months before the results were declared. During evaluation, many evaluators described struggling with blurred scans, repeated server crashes, and answer books disappearing from the system after evaluation.

The controversy escalated after the results were declared as students, including several who had qualified for JEE Main, began reporting low theory marks in subjects such as physics, chemistry, mathematics, accountancy and economics.

Students and parents to resolve their grievances and are “providing all possible support to students.” Referring to complaints raised by other students, the sources said, “Not only one student, but all such matters are being examined seriously. In some cases, the issues have also been resolved.”

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Students raise concerns over OSM, Board assures necessary action, update

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, May 25

AMID GROWING complaints over glitches and discrepancies in the CBSE re-evaluation process, some Class 12 students have alleged that the scanned copies of their answer books uploaded by the Board do not match their handwriting, raising concerns over possible answer-sheet mismatch in the On Screen Marking (OSM) system.

The CBSE has taken up on “top priority” the cases related to alleged mismatched answer sheets and other concerns faced by students in the re-evaluation process, a source in Board said.

The assurances came after a social media post of a Delhi-based Class 12 student, Vedant, went viral in which he alleged that the physics answersheet uploaded by the CBSE under the re-evaluation process was not his.

As the issue sparked an uproar with several other students also taking to social media with similar claims, the CBSE said on Monday evening that a correct copy of his answer book has been sent to him and necessary action for updating his result is being undertaken accordingly.

“Whatever complaints are coming, online or offline, by any means, CBSE is actively taking them up,” the source said, asserting that the Board remains committed to helping the students.

They said senior officials are continuously engaging with

students and parents to resolve their grievances and are “providing all possible support to students.” Referring to complaints raised by other students, the sources said, “Not only one student, but all such matters are being examined seriously. In some cases, the issues have also been resolved.”

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Indian researchers solve an old puzzle – in chemistry

Amitabh Sinha
New Delhi, May 25

RESEARCHERS AT IIT Madras and Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru, have achieved a major chemistry breakthrough by synthesizing a new carbon-free molecule that copies the unusual ‘sandwich’ structure of the famous carbon-containing ferrocene molecule, solving a problem that had challenged scientists for over seven decades.

Ferrocene, discovered in the early 1950s, is a widely used compound in a variety of modern technologies, whose unique structure -- an iron atom ‘sandwiched’ between two large and flat carbon ringed-molecules -- has attracted a lot of scientific interest. It is used in medicines, batteries, advanced materials and electronics. For decades, scientists have tried to create similarly structured-molecules with elements other than carbon, but could not succeed.

Carbon has a special place in chemistry. There is a whole branch of chemistry, called organic chemistry, dedicated to study of carbon and its compounds. Carbon very efficiently combines itself and other elements to form very stable large and complex molecules. Scientists have been interested in finding whether the special structure of ferroc



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● POLICY

As Kerala sets up department for the elderly, a look at India's ageing challenge

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, May 25

KERALA IS India's most rapidly ageing state. Last week, its new Congress government announced the formation of a department for the welfare of elderly people — the first such initiative in India. Kerala already has a number of policies to help the elderly, overseen by the Social Welfare department so far. But the setting up of a dedicated department appears to signal a greater focus on dealing with the fallout of a demographic transition — something the rest of the country is also set to experience in the coming decades.

A state turning grey, and fast

According to the India Ageing Report of 2023, around 16.5% of Kerala's population was aged above 60 in 2021, compared with the national average of 10.1%. By 2036, this figure was expected to increase to 22.8% against the all-India projection of 15%.

So what's behind the rapid ageing? First, Kerala's total fertility rate has declined over the years to 1.35 children per woman in 2023 according to the state's Vital Statistics data. This is below the national replacement level of 2.1, the rate required for a population to replace itself across generations. Second, life expectancy has increased owing to better healthcare facilities. The third factor is migration. Many from Kerala's working age population migrate and often settle abroad, leaving their parents back home. At the same time, large numbers of migrants return from West Asia after retirement.

● DUTY OF CARE

Women's informal unpaid care and domestic work contributes about 15-17% of the GDP. Formalising the care economy is crucial to not only care for the elderly but also create jobs.

The challenge ahead — and the opportunity

The growing graph of senior citizens has thrown up challenges for Kerala in the health and service sectors, mainly on shifting its focus to geriatric care. This requires nurturing a care economy in the state.

But this challenge is not Kerala's alone. By 2050, the proportion of elderly persons in the country is expected to increase to 20.8% of the population, that is around 34.7 crore. This would necessitate the need to invest in healthcare, social support and care infrastructure. India does have laws and policies to support the elderly. These include the Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Act of 2007 that mandates children and heirs to provide maintenance, and the National Policy for Senior Citizens, 2011, that aims to provide older people with social security. Last month, the Telangana Assembly passed a Bill to dock the salary of those deemed to be neglecting their parents. In 2017, Assam passed a similar law that laid out a 10% salary cut for parental neglect by government employees. But coverage gaps remain. An April 2026 working paper authored by PM-Economic Advisory Council member Shamika Ravi and others flags that the public system of elder care operates with "limited coverage, weak regulatory mechanisms, and financing gaps". The need, say experts, is to look at ageing as not just a welfare issue but a development one.

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८ Jaipur	26 मई शाम 5:00 बजे	4 June 11:00 AM

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● GLOBAL

Nepal gets new Chief Justice, and new row over politics influencing judiciary

Yubraj Ghimire
Kathmandu, May 25

NEPAL'S 33RD Chief Justice (CJ), Manoj Kumar Sharma, rushed to the Supreme Court last week to take charge of his new post at an unprecedented speed. On May 7, a six-member Constitutional Council (CC) headed by Prime Minister Balendra Shah recommended him for the post, and the Parliamentary Hearing Committee confirmed it unanimously. President Ram Chandra Poudel then administered the oath of office to Sharma, but the process unfolded amid major disagreements about his appointment. The events also matter for Nepal in that they follow last year's "Gen Z" protests, which criticised the political establishment, corrupt alliances, and the weakening of state institutions. Similar problems have plagued the judiciary. Questions of seniority According to convention, the senior-

most judge of the Supreme Court is appointed Chief Justice. Sharma was the fourth-most senior judge, after Justice Sapana Pradhan Malla, Justice Kumar Regmi, and Justice Hari Prasad Phuyal. While Justice Regmi welcomed Sharma's appointment, Acting CJ Malla — who would have been appointed if precedent was followed — went on a 20-day leave the next day. She had also ordered the court administration to register a writ petition challenging Sharma's recommendation. If she resigns, it will be the first such instance in Nepal. Sharma studied law at Nepal's Tribhuvan University and then did a master's from Pune University. The CC favoured him ostensibly for disposing of a high number of cases, but data do not support this. He will have a six-year stint, the longest tenure in the past three decades, with ample opportunity to reform the judiciary — something every government and CJ has promised, but followed up with little action.



Nepal's new Chief Justice Manoj Kumar Sharma. NEWS/SONAIR

Judiciary-political party nexus

Nepal's judiciary, especially in the last two decades of radical and constant political change, has increasingly come under

political and executive influence. The principle of separation of powers has not been upheld consistently, with clear links between political parties and judges. This was not always the case. In the late 1960s, Justice Ratna Bahadur Bista (who would eventually become CJ) was called to the Royal Palace. King Mahendra encouraged him to maintain the judiciary's independence and credibility after he decreed against the King's father-in-law in a property dispute. Partisan politics made judges vulnerable to political pressure over time. These links were most explicit in March 2013, when CJ Khil Raj Regmi took additional responsibility of the PM post for a year, heading a coalition government. Top judiciary appointments in Nepal are made on the CC's recommendation. Headed by the Prime Minister, the body consists of the Speaker, the Deputy Speaker and the leader of the Opposition in the House of Representatives, the Chairperson of the National Assembly (Upper House)

and the CJ. But when it comes to recommending the CJ, the Law Minister replaces the incumbent CJ as a member, bringing the body completely under the domain of political parties. Sharma's elevation and criticism Sharma was a protégé of his uncle and former CJ Damodar Sharma. He was appointed to the appellate court about 12 years ago, but lost the job within two years, when the new Constitution (promulgated in 2015) scrapped it and introduced a new judicial system. The government and the Supreme Court then introduced mass appointments of 80 judges to the High Courts. It followed an understanding among then CJ Sushila Karki, who was also made the interim Prime Minister of Nepal after last year's protests, and the three major parties — the Nepali Congress (NC), the Communist Party of Nepal (UML), and the Maoists. Until about a year ago, the CJs, the CC, and the

parties had a quota-based system for judicial appointments that benefited all of them. Sushila Karki has argued that there was nothing wrong in appointing people with political backgrounds as judges, asserting they would be unbiased when stepping into their role as judges. For the Supreme Court, the UML and the NC had made appointments until 2036. Judges under the UML quota were to head the court for seven years. Justice Malla, a UML MP from 2008 to 2012, was expected to head the court until around 2029. But the Balen Shah-led Rastriya Swatantra Party government derailed that plan with Sharma's appointment. Sharma has said he will uphold the dignity of the institutions and ensure their impartiality and credibility. Just recently, though, the new government introduced an ordinance stating that the PM's voice will be the deciding factor in case of a tie in CC appointments, and he will have a veto when in the minority.

● ECONOMY

Should RBI defend rupee, or let it find its own level



UDIT MISRA

THE SHARP slide in the rupee's exchange rate has stroked a debate on the Indian economy. The urgent policy decision before the government and the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is whether to prevent the rupee from sliding further against the US dollar or to let it fall and find its true level. The rupee's exchange rate against the US dollar basically changes depending on the relative demand for the two currencies in the foreign exchange (forex) markets. If Indians demand more dollars (either to buy foreign goods or to invest in other countries) than the rupees demanded by foreigners (either to buy Indian goods or to invest in India), the relative value (exchange rate) moves in favour of the dollar. The worsening of the rupee's exchange rate is reflective of a weakness of the Indian economy.

How can the rupee's exchange rate be artificially improved?

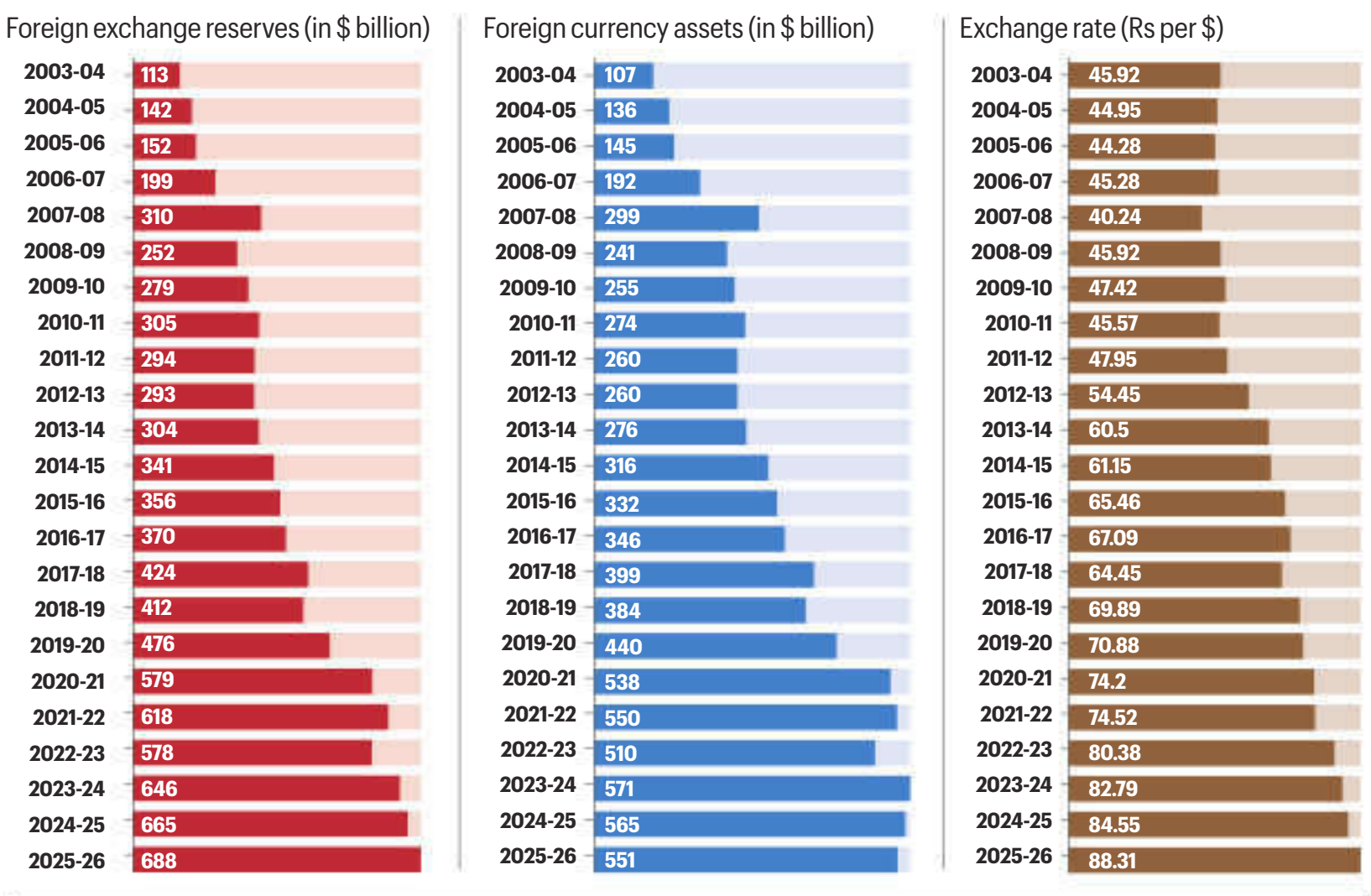
Indians can't hold dollars with them for regular use within the country: all dollars flow back to RBI. This can be employed by the central bank to artificially boost the rupee's exchange rate when needed. The RBI can sell the dollars it has in the forex market, thereby increasing the supply. The central bank buys rupees in return for the dollars, thereby increasing the former's demand. This is referred to as the RBI defending the rupee.

How does the RBI decide when to defend?

The RBI's official policy line has always been that it does not target a certain level of rupee. Rather, the RBI's concern is that the movement in the rupee's exchange rate should be orderly. In other words, the RBI would intervene if it thinks the rupee is falling (or rising against any currency) too fast. This makes sense, as the RBI is charged with maintaining financial stability in the economy. Imagine how difficult it would be for you as a consumer (say a student planning their graduate studies in the US) or a trader if the rupee's exchange rate changed dramatically every day.

Does defending the rupee work? In the short term, it can work. The foreign currency reserves (the main consti-

● Snapshot of India's forex and exchange rate movements



tuent of India's total forex) have stayed roughly at the same level over the past six years as the RBI deployed more and more dollars from its kitty to defend the rupee. There is a flip side too. Over the medium term, the RBI's strategy to sell all that forex is coming a cropper because eventually the rupee has fallen sharply.

Why can't the RBI defend the rupee like it did earlier?

There are two reasons. First, policymakers like to have around 10 months of import cover — enough dollars to continue necessary imports for at least 10 months. After the RBI hits a certain level of forex reserve, it has to take a pause and reconsider. Secondly, and this is a less appreciated aspect and perhaps the biggest constraint that India and the RBI face when it comes to defending the rupee: the quality of India's forex. Most of the forex with the RBI comes to India in the form of investments into the Indian economy, and not as money earned by selling to the rest of the world. As we have seen in the past few years, such money can be pulled out of India if investors take a dim view of growth prospects or if they like some other destination better. Another way to look at this situation is that the forex the RBI holds is more a liability than an asset. For instance, China earns

‘Defending’ the rupee

The RBI can sell the dollars it holds in the forex market, thereby increasing their supply

- It then buys rupees in return for the dollars, increasing the former's demand. This is called defending the rupee

its forex through a trade surplus. The dollars it gets in return are an asset and cannot be pulled out by any investor. But in India, thanks to our continuing weakness in trade, India spends more dollars importing than it earns exporting.

Why not let the rupee find its level?

Mainstream economists regularly advocate this. They argue that a weaker rupee will help India's exporters. Similarly, as the rupee's exchange rate falls, all imports will become costlier and hence their demand will fall. The net result will be an elimination of the trade deficit (the gap between exports and imports). Moreover, if the RBI allows the rupee's exchange rate to fall, then neither would the central bank have to draw down India's forex reserves, nor would the Prime Minister be forced to ask Indians to undertake austerity measures. However, while this recommendation makes sense on paper, in India's case, there are many angularities that suggest that letting the rupee find its level could end up either not having any impact or, in the worst case scenario, exacerbate the slide. Here are some reasons why. ● A large part of India's exports — some analysts estimate as high as 40% — are “re-exports”. In other words, these exports are essentially based on imported goods. As such, a fall in the rupee's ex-

change rate makes the imports costlier for Indians just as they make the export cheaper for foreigners. In other words, the effect cancels out. ● Also, in many export goods, India is a price-taker and not a price setter. Take, for example, most textile goods. India competes fiercely with other countries such as Bangladesh. India cannot set the price of their goods lest they be undercut by their Bangladeshi counterparts. Imagine an Indian exporter selling a T-shirt for \$1 when one dollar was worth Rs 50. Next season the exchange rate falls and becomes Rs 100 to a dollar. In such a case, the foreign buyer will likely force the Indian exporter to reduce the price to say \$0.6 for a T-shirt, since this way the Indian exporter would still earn Rs 10 more than what he was earning before the exchange rate fell. The end result is that a falling rupee may not have boosted exports and export-earnings for Indians, as the argument goes in economic textbooks. ● There is a good chance that letting the rupee find its level, especially when it has just lost a lot of value, could further push down the exchange rate. In other words, depreciation can beget depreciation.

If an Indian importer looks at the rupee fast falling, they are likely to buy more and more dollars from the forex market because they expect the rupee to weaken in the coming weeks and months. But the more they buy dollars, the more the rupee weakens further. An exactly different thing happens to Indian exporters albeit with the same result of exacerbating the rupee's fall. If the rupee has been falling, an exporter may defer accepting a payment because \$100 a couple of months down the line will fetch more rupees. This dries up the supply of dollars that were otherwise scheduled to come into the market, thus further stoking the price of dollars. Something similar happens on the capital account side — with reference to the movement of money for investment purposes, letting the rupee fall may disincentivise investments. Suppose, the Indian stock markets give 10% returns in a particular year, but during the year, the rupee loses 5% of its exchange rate. This means an American investing in India would get only about 5% returns in dollar terms. This would disincentivise future investments, especially if the foreign investors expect the rupee to slide further. In such a case, they may hold back fresh investments. But this, in turn, will further show up as a deficit in India's overall Balance of Payment and will further push down the rupee's exchange rate.

Dust is easiest to clean, time to do it is now

IT IS now well known that the particulate matter (PM) burden on Delhi’s air — responsible for the city’s chronic pollution crisis — is a toxic mix of multiple pollutants. Addressing it requires a multi-pronged approach that combines systemic overhauls with relatively simple interventions at the local government level. Controlling emissions from the transport, industrial and agricultural sectors involves complex solutions with significant implications for economic activity in the city and its surrounding regions. Dust pollution, in contrast, can be reduced through relatively less economically disruptive measures such as regular road sweeping, water sprinkling, covering construction sites, and maintaining roads and pavements. However, as an investigation by this newspaper shows, the city’s limited dust-control infrastructure, especially its Mechanical Road Sweeping Machines (MRSM), remains severely underutilised. The persistent failure to implement such operationally straightforward measures raises serious questions about administrative intent.

In Delhi, dust pollution primarily originates from construction sites, demolition activities, roadside soil and the movement of heavy vehicles. It accounts for nearly 41 per cent of PM10 pollutants and 38 per cent of the finer PM2.5 particles during summer, when dry conditions increase dust levels in the city’s air. Yet, as the investigation reveals, Delhi’s MRSM fleet operates below capacity for much of the year, including during peak-pollution months, and its deployment remains confined to only a few parts of the capital. Coverage across municipal zones is uneven, with better-funded zones receiving more service than others. This skewed usage defeats the purpose of the machines. Dust does not respect administrative boundaries — when one zone is cleaned while another is neglected, particles circulate across the city because of traffic movement and shifting wind patterns.

For far too long, Delhi’s authorities have treated the city’s poor air quality as a seasonal problem, despite a wealth of studies highlighting heavy pollution year-round. Their failure to acknowledge the scale of the crisis prevents the city from deriving the maximum benefit from MRSMs. The fact that the deployment of these machines is concentrated in winter, when smog attracts public attention, shows that the authorities continue to adopt a reactive approach. Delhi needs a coordinated dust-management strategy involving civic bodies, the Public Works Department and pollution-control agencies. Real-time monitoring of MRSM deployment and performance audits could introduce much-needed transparency into the system. Indore’s experience with these machines demonstrates that solutions to dust pollution are neither technologically complex nor financially prohibitive. Unlike geography or crop-residue burning, this is an aspect of pollution over which the Delhi government cannot claim helplessness. Like in its interventions on clean fuel, emission standards and protection of green belts, the Court should nudge Delhi’s authorities.

Health indicators point to gains, and disparities

THE JUST-released Sample Registration System report for 2024 highlights a demographic transformation that is cause for both celebration and concern. The country’s birth rate — the total number of live births per 1,000 people in a population — declined to 18.3 per 1,000 population in 2024, down from 21 in 2014. The Infant Mortality Rate (IMR) has also fallen steadily from 39 per 1,000 live births in 2014-2019 to 24 in 2024. These gains reflect decades of sustained public-health investment. Yet, the national averages conceal a deeper gulf between rural and urban areas, and between states: Chhattisgarh records the country’s highest IMR at 36, with MP and UP at 35 each. Kerala, at the other end, stands at eight; Tamil Nadu, Delhi and Himachal Pradesh at 11. This gap between the best- and worst-performing states underlines persistent local failures.

The broader gains reflected in the data owe much to the cumulative impact of targeted interventions under the National Health Mission. These have expanded immunisation coverage, lowering preventable child deaths, and improved institutional deliveries. But the persistence of rural disadvantage suggests that public-health infrastructure has advanced unevenly, with poorer states and districts still struggling to catch up. The 2024 data places rural IMR at 27 deaths per 1,000 live births, compared with 17 in urban areas — a disparity that reflects enduring inequalities in health-care access, awareness and maternal nutrition.

The fertility data, too, compounds this picture of two Indias. India’s Total Fertility Rate (TFR) has remained flat at 1.9 for the fifth consecutive year, below the replacement level of 2.1. Delhi records the country’s lowest TFR at 1.2, followed by Kerala, Tamil Nadu, and West Bengal at 1.3. But Bihar’s TFR remains the highest at 2.9. The consequences of ignoring this are considerable. Nearly 10 per cent of India’s population is now aged 60 and above, signalling that many of the economically advanced states are ageing rapidly. Read together, the data does not present a single India on the cusp of its demographic dividend, but two demographic realities moving at different speeds. Policymakers must resist the comfort of national averages to confront that divergent reality.

At Cannes, a paler red carpet, a sharper frame

IF THE last great year of cinema on the Croisette was 1994, when the triumph of *Pulp Fiction* reoriented Hollywood’s attention towards European cinematic prestige, could the near-total absence of the American film industry from this year’s edition indicate a much-needed redirection? The low wattage of the red on the red carpet at the 2026 Cannes International Film Festival was not incidental: Hollywood’s anxiety over early negative reviews in a time of industry churn — thanks to streaming services and AI-related disruptions — ensured that the splashiest moment this year was John Travolta’s appearance in a beret.

It is certainly true that in the 30-odd years since Quentin Tarantino’s feature debut won the Palme d’Or, the festival has had the world’s attention thanks to Los Angeles’s brightest stars bringing their charisma to the event. The high point was perhaps Tom Cruise’s appearance at the 2022 edition with *Top Gun: Maverick*, when the French Air Force’s aerobatic team Patrouille de France painted the sky with red, white and blue smoke trails.

What the low-key vibe this year ensured, however, was a renewed focus on the core purpose of the festival. With works by returning auteurs such as Pawel Pawlikowski (who won the Best Director award for *Fatherland*), Cristian Mungiu (who won his second Palme d’Or for *Fjord*) and Andrei Zvyagintsev (whose *Minotaur* won the Grand Prix), Cannes became a celebration of the art of cinema, not just an affirmation of its glamour.

Dead ends on the road from Bengal, both sides need new directions

THREE WEEKS since the results, the dust of assembly elections has all but settled, and though the outcome in West Bengal was a rupture, a political sameness is again descending. The stillness is broken erratically — now, by the victor extending its strong arm to swat down the impudent Cockroach Janta Party, and then, by rumblings within the vanquished party. But in general, both seem headed back to square one, BJP as well as TMC.

The BJP dare not pause too long on the CJP phenomenon because that might mean wondering if, like the irrepressible cockroach, dissent finds a way — even in the guise of a reclaimed slur, even in the aftermath of a famous victory. It might mean acknowledging that the people speak, and need to be heard, not just when they cast their vote every five years, but also in between. On the other side, if the TMC stops to listen to the voices within that are raising questions about its own complicities in its defeat, it might have to recognise that the onus of political correction, and action, is on it.

This avoidance of the political imperative is also framed in readings of the West Bengal verdict. Especially in the non-BJP camp, whose future depends on finding the way forward from Bengal, they sound like an abdication of responsibility.

The election was won, and lost, it is being said, because of “SIR”, or “Hindu consolidation” or “anti-incumbency”. All three have truth in them. All three are framed as political dead ends.

First, the SIR. The Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls cast a long shadow over the Bengal election, with about 27 lakh voters in the “under adjudication” category deleted controversially, and not given time to appeal. Going by the

scoreboard, the deletions did not impact the result significantly — the deletions are larger than the margin of victory in 49 seats, of which only 26 figure in the BJP’s list of 206. But numbers alone do not tell the full SIR story.

The SIR residue lingers on in disturbing questions about the un-level playing field, the questionable role of the umpire, the Election Commission, and of the Supreme Court. It is there in the dispiriting message to vulnerable voters, especially of the Muslim minority. Going forward, therefore, whether or not the SIR helped the BJP swing the Bengal election is not the main SIR question.

As the exercise unfolds in other states, apprehensions touched off by the Bengal SIR must be addressed diligently. The Opposition’s apocalyptic pitch on the “stolen election”, however, which frames its own search for a villain and fall guy, comes in the way of a patient politics of vigilance and monitoring.

The second explanation for the verdict — anti-incumbency — has long been sanitised of people’s real concerns, and emptied of political meaning. It is invoked by outgoing incumbents as an unstoppable force, as if it could not have been countered by good governance or politics. It suits an incoming government, too, to treat anti-incumbency as a black box, not as a set of discontents that now need to be addressed by it.

The refusal to look anti-incumbency in the eye is even more evident in West Bengal, where by questioning the verdict’s legitimacy, the TMC avoids a confrontation with ground-level reasons for the erosion of its popularity. Like the oppressive shadow network it inherited from the party-society under Left rule, for in-



VANDITA MISHRA

Opposition needs to ask if it undermines itself by treating Hindu consolidation as something without a political counter, as almost the end of politics

stance, and made its own. TMC cadres and political-entrepreneurs became the state, insinuating themselves into all spaces, extracting and extorting. They dissolved the boundaries between party and government, blurred lines of accountability.

After Bengal, the TMC and national Opposition have resorted to another increasingly visible strategy of avoiding the political responsibility that flows from the electoral verdict. They point, helplessly, to a Hindu consolidation that is now cast as an iron law of political nature, much like anti-incumbency.

On this third explanation, there is an active convergence of BJP and non-BJP — it suits the BJP that its opponents see Hindu consolidation as the trumping electoral argument and logic. The Suwendu Adhikari government’s first flurry of decisions — from banning *namaz* on streets to imposing ‘Vande Mataram’ in madrasas — underlines this. The new government is triumphantly owning the space the BJP has worked to expand and that its opponents have ceded to it. This also helps it to defer for now, or indefinitely, its pressing governance challenges.

The Opposition needs to ask if it undermines itself by treating Hindu consolidation like anti-incumbency — as something without a political counter, as almost the end of politics.

In fact, a big question after Bengal could be this: In the era of BJP dominance, what does the politics of secularism mean? At a time when the distortions of secularism-in-practice have made it easy for the BJP to fling the label of “appeasement politics” at its opponents, and when the label sticks, how can secularism-as-principle be recast or retrieved?

● WORDLY WISE

The cinema is not an art which films life: The cinema is something between art and life.

— Jean-Luc Godard

From Ghazipur, UP, to J&K: Healing drug addiction wound



AJAY SINGH

I KNEW his name before I knew what heroin could do to a person. He was from Ghazipur, one of the brightest students in our hostel at Banaras Hindu University. Sharp, funny, full of ambition. Then, gradually, he wasn’t. The transformation crept in quietly, until one day it was complete. He was one of thousands around BHU who had been consumed by a trade that operated brazenly, with political protection and impunity.

Ghazipur is not incidental to this story. Amitav Ghosh chose it as the opening of his Opium War trilogy for good reason — this district in eastern Uttar Pradesh sat at the heart of a narcotics trade that reached from Myanmar to Indian cities. The Ghazipur syndicate, operating through the 1980s and 1990s, was linked to Khun Sa, then among the world’s most powerful drug traffickers, based in Myanmar. The Narcotics Control Bureau and the Central Bureau of Narcotics launched sustained campaigns. The trade grew anyway. And then, as happens when a crisis grows too large to police, it became invisible, filed away as someone else’s problem.

This is why, when Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha announced a campaign to eradicate drugs from the lives of young people in Jammu and Kashmir, I did not dismiss it as rhetoric. Sinha is from Ghazipur. He was a student leader at BHU during the years when the trade was at its most devastating. He has seen what a generation looks like when it is lost to addiction.

The drug problem in J&K is, in some ways, even more entrenched. The region borders the Golden Crescent — Pakistan, Afghanistan, and Iran — one of the world’s largest opium-producing zones. Heroin and brown sugar are readily available. Pakistani supply networks have extended the reach of this trade into Punjab and Rajasthan as well.

The damage shows most clearly in Punjab. Visit the areas around educational institutions and you encounter stories that never make the news: Families who speak in whispers, parents who grieve privately, children who disappeared not to vi-

olence but to a slower, quieter ruin. The state has shown remarkable resilience — religious institutions in particular have stepped into the vacuum — but community resistance cannot substitute institutional commitment.

In J&K, the drug menace has been a festering wound for decades. Its connection to the financing of separatism has long been suspected; the reluctance of mainstream political parties to engage with the issue seriously has been, at best, a failure of courage and, at worst, something more troubling.

Sinha’s campaign has drawn enthusiastic participation from local communities. This is significant. Public health crises of this nature require communities to believe change is possible, and to invest energy in it. But the deeper question is whether this energy can be institutionalised, and whether the example travels. In Ghazipur, in Varanasi, in the metros and tier-two cities where addiction statistics have climbed steadily, there is no comparable movement. Professional politicians have little appetite for this. It demands something more difficult than a rally — the patient work of rebuilding individual lives. That requires sustained funding, trained counsellors, family support systems, and a political class willing to treat addiction as a public health emergency rather than a moral failing. It requires, as someone once said of a different long struggle, not weeks or months but years of commitment without the guarantee of visible results.

Sinha has the background, the credibility, and apparently the resolve to see this through in J&K. The test will be whether what begins in the Valley can become a model for how political will, community participation, and institutional support can be brought together to fight a crisis hiding in plain sight. The students of Ghazipur, of BHU, of Punjab, of every city where this catastrophe is unfolding, deserve nothing less.

The writer is former press secretary to the President of India



ANJAL PRAKASH

Rapid urbanisation within the city has increased vehicular traffic and construction activities, while natural ecosystems that once helped cleanse the air have been steadily lost

Haxton, regional director of UNICEF, at IG Stadium in New Delhi. The torch, lit at Nehru Stadium, was carried by a group of about 450 runners, and Flying Sikh Milkha Singh and P T Usha jointly handed over the torch to Alva.

Dacoits murder Dalit family

THREE MEMBERS of a Dalit family were tortured to death by the gang of dacoit Hanuman Kurmi at Kanakalan village, under Shankargarh police station in Allahabad district, the police said. The victims were identified as Jagdeo Chamar, his wife, Shakuntala and son Shivgovind. The dacoits, who gouged out the eyes of the victims and dealt them crushing blows with a hammer, later carried the bodies in a tractor and dumped them across

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Clearing Delhi’s dust requires machines — and more



ANJAL PRAKASH

RAMPANT URBANISATION, poor infrastructure, and neglect have pushed Delhi towards an unprecedented air quality crisis. The struggle of night-time road-sweeping workers reveals how far we have to go. Every night, a fleet of mechanical road-sweeping machines travels through the streets, clearing dust from the roads of the capital. An investigation by *The Indian Express* (‘Delhi’s killer dust’, May 25) has brought to light the challenges faced by these vehicles and their drivers in the battle for clean air.

Street-cleaning machines are countered by poor roads and unfinished construction projects. Many roads in Delhi are uneven, blocked or under construction, creating difficulties. During high-pollution seasons, dust accumulates quickly and gets churned up by passing vehicles. Workers have to constantly get out of the machine, clear debris manually, and direct the machine through blocked or congested routes. While Delhi continues expanding its Metro network and encouraging electric vehicles, these measures have not kept up with the needs of an ever-increasing population. Rapid urbanisation has increased vehicular traffic and construction activities, while natural ecosystems that once helped cleanse the air have been steadily lost. Pollution and construction regulations are ineffective or poorly applied. Strict building codes and periodic environmental controls are needed to prevent the impact of construction dust. Then, there are the workers who operate the machines at night, who have the arduous job of cleaning the streets. They have no special protective gear. Many suffer dizziness, struck by the consequences of toxic pollution that their city has been ignoring for years.

Delhi must invest in better urban infrastructure. In addition to developing efficient public transport, there is an immediate need to construct better roads, drainage systems, and green belts. There is a need to instil a sense of responsibility among developers, businesses, and government agencies in terms of not only adhering to environmental laws but also adopting sustainable practices. Regular audits, disclosures, and public involvement in city planning can provide accountability and awareness about responsible and sustainable practices to protect air quality.

It’s also time to galvanise communities in monitoring and advocacy for cleaner air. Innovative tools like a mobile app that tracks air quality will enable citizens to learn more and do more in their own lives. The battle against Delhi’s air crisis cannot be won simply by deploying machines to sweep roads. What is required is a radical change in the ethos of urban development, investment in infrastructure and a refocussing of governance to protect the health and lives of people.

The writer is a professor of Public Policy at Flame University, Pune. He is a lead author of IPCC’s Special Report on Climate Change and Cities

40 YEARS AGO

May 26, 1986



Killings in Punjab

FIVE PERSONS, including two terrorists, were killed in separate incidents in the state in the past 24 hours. Three persons were shot dead by suspected terrorists in two incidents. Two persons, Ashwini Kumar and Surinder Kumar, standing at the bus stop of Teja Kalaan village in Gurdaspur district were shot dead by two cycle-borne terrorists. In the second incident, an agriculturist, Kashmira Singh, was shot dead by a group in Jangla village.

Race Against Time

THE RACE Against Time ended when Margaret Alva, Minister of State for Sports and Youth Affairs, handed over the torch to David

the border in Madhya Pradesh.

CMs reject twin-cities formula

THE FORMULA of twin cities adjoining Panchkula worked out by Justice E S Venkataramiah, chairman of the territorial commission to identify Hindi-speaking villages to be given in lieu of Chandigarh, has not been approved by the Haryana Chief Minister, Bhajan Lal, and the Punjab Chief Minister, Surjit Singh Barnala. The commission will have to give its verdict identifying Hindi-speaking villages to be given to Haryana. Barnala had a two-and-a-half hour meeting with Justice Venkataramiah to discuss the proposal with him. Bhajan Lal, too, had met Justice Venkataramiah.

Young must lead us to Viksit Bharat, Amrit Kaal is the era of hard work



C P RADHAKRISHNAN

WHEN I was a boy studying in Tiruppur, I had many dreams about our nation. Questions would constantly arise: When will Bharat regain its greatness? When will it rise as a powerful nation on the world stage? When will our poor and underprivileged sisters and brothers get a life of dignity? I am happy to see that the thoughts that I had in my teenage years are now becoming reality. I would often remind myself of Swami Vivekananda's words: "Arise, awake, and stop not till the goal is reached." These words, proclaimed from the soil of Tamil Nadu, possess immense power to inspire patriotism and commitment. Over the past decade, I have been pleased to see our country functioning with tremendous vigour and determination. We now have the opportunity to witness the truth of Thiruvalluvar's words: "Those who are steadfast in their determination will achieve exactly what they have envisioned."

At a time when economic slowdown and uncertainties prevail across the globe, Bharat's economy is growing strongly. The enthusiasm of the government and the people to make this an era of sustained development is the reason for this progress. What is even more significant is that our economic development has been inclusive.

In the past 12 years, almost 25 crore Bharatvasis have come out of extreme poverty. So far, around 4 crore permanent houses have been built for the homeless. More than 12 crore people have been provided with piped drinking water connections. We aspired to become a nation free from open defecation and within 60 months, the country made this possible for 60 crore people. Under the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Yojana, 5 kg of food grains are being provided free of cost to 80 crore people every year.

I have seen, from a young age, people in villages suffering because they were unable to access medical facilities. Today, the



ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

nation is implementing the Ayushman Bharat scheme with a commitment to ensuring that healthcare is accessible to all. More than 44 crore people now have insurance cover of Rs 5 lakh; in the past year, 2.5 crore people received free treatment under this scheme.

Our farmers produced 357 million tonnes of food grains in 2025, elevating Bharat to the position of second-largest food producer. It has also become the second-largest rice-producing country. Under the PM Kisan Samman Nidhi, over Rs 4 lakh crore has been directly transferred to farmers' accounts so far.

Opportunities are now open for our Nari Shakti to fully contribute to the nation's development. More than 3 crore women have become Lakhpati Didis and Namo Drone Didis. Women have come forward in every field, be it agriculture, education, medicine, science or space technology. Women are now getting permanent commissions in the armed forces and are taking part in combat roles. The Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam will further enhance their participation in Parliament and state legislatures.

When we see the younger generation coming forward with enthusiasm for start-ups, it reminds us of the words of Subramania Bharati: "Come, come,

We have set a goal that by 2047, Bharat should become a leading global power and reach a position of guiding the world. This era of hard work is the 'Amrit Kaal'

come and accomplish what you have envisioned; Let the whole nation rise in unity and prosper; Come, come, come and achieve a great deed."

For the youth, seven new IITs have been established. The number of IITs has increased to 21 from 13. The number of AIIMS has tripled to 23 from 7, and medical colleges have more than doubled to 823 from 387. The number of seats for medical students has increased from 51,348 to 1,29,603.

We are also advancing toward world-class standards in infrastructure. The railways have been electrified to almost 99 per cent. Across the country, 164 Vande Bharat Express trains have ushered in a new era. The number of airports has doubled to 163 from 74, and air travel has become accessible for ordinary people under UDAN. The railway budget allocation for Tamil Nadu, around Rs 880 crore in 2014, has increased to Rs 7,600 crore in 2026–27. The new Pamban Bridge between Rameswaram and Pamban is Bharat's first vertical lift bridge, creating opportunities for spiritual tourism and economic development. World-class four-lane and eight-lane roads, and road connectivity extending even to remote villages, have been developed. In Tamil Nadu, more than 4,000 km of na-

tional highways have been constructed since 2014. In the Northeast, national highways covering nearly 7,200 km have been constructed. These developments have been realised due to close monitoring by the Prime Minister under PRAGATI.

The pre- and post-matric scholarship schemes and Eklavya model residential schools have benefitted students belonging to Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes respectively.

The border villages, once considered the last villages of Bharat, have now become the first villages and are being developed through the Vibrant Villages Scheme. I happily recall the Prime Minister referring to the northeastern states as the nation's Ashtalakshmi. Recently, when I visited Nagaland, Mizoram, Tripura, and Sikkim, I saw tremendous improvement in transport facilities as well as infrastructure.

The progress the country has achieved in science, technology and innovation fills us with pride. During the pandemic, Bharat ensured that vaccines were developed indigenously and made available free of cost to all at a rapid pace, and provided vaccines to more than 100 countries. The successful launch of Chandrayaan-3 has catapulted Bharat into an era of advanced space exploration. In AI, global companies are choosing Bharat as their hub. We have also secured the second position in mobile phone production globally.

For decades, our country has faced not only the challenges of terrorism but also insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism. Through bold policy decisions and the upholding of law, peace prevails in the nation, and the doors of development have been opened in these areas.

We have set a goal that by 2047, Bharat should become a leading global power and reach a position of guiding the world. This era of hard work is the *Amrit Kaal*. Just as the thirst for freedom existed in the heart of every freedom fighter, the thought of the nation's development should now grow in the minds of today's youth. The words of Swami Vivekananda, "Let us all work hard, my brethren; this is no time for sleep. On our work depends the coming of the India of the future," show us both inspiration and direction. Let us strive together to create a Viksit Bharat through our hard work.

The writer is the Vice President of India

Needed in Delhi: A change of personnel, not just policy reform



ARVIND SUBRAMANIAN

HENRY KISSINGER would mock the European Union's incapacity for collective decision-making by asking "whom should we call?" at a time of crisis. As the rupee plummets, and India confronts serious economic challenges, there is a similar sense of "who is in charge?" And the answer to that question, which must now be said, is: "Whoever they are (or not), change them."

Why is a change in personnel overdue? For a start, near-crisis moments require conveying a sense — creating a perception or narrative — that someone decisive is at the helm. The need of the hour is for a credible interlocutor with a clear message, like a Mario Draghi who said, "We will do whatever it takes."

Consider the two key centres of economic decision-making. From New Delhi, there is silence and drift, and from Mumbai there is a sense of events overwhelming the protagonists. Even the Prime Minister's exhortation to private sacrifice had the effect of raising the alarm but the long trip abroad that followed only reinforced the sense, at home, of a vacuum of decision-making and the absence of a clear agenda of follow-up actions.

There is, however, a more substantive reason for changing personnel across the board, which relates to what the government must stop doing as opposed to what more it must do. Consider this. The rupee crisis today is only partly related to the Iran war and the consequential shock to energy-dependent India. It reflects as much or more doubts about India's medium-term growth prospects. One supporting piece of evidence is that the rupee was the worst-performing amongst comparator emerging market countries even before the war.

In the two or three years preceding the war, no country with the exception of Turkey experienced as much of a currency decline, despite as much of an effort by the central bank to defend the currency. Between 2022 and February 2026, the rupee declined by over 20 per cent despite the RBI interventions in spot and forward markets, amounting to about 50 per cent of the stock of foreign assets.

The behaviour of the rupee has highlighted what the official numbers have obscured for some time — that investors are losing confidence in the Indian economy. They have, belatedly, recognised the message from one indicator that has been flashing red for some considerable time: Private corporate investment. This peaked at 17 per cent of GDP in the early 2000s and today is at half that amount. There was a brief post-Covid blip but that has faded. Weak private investment is the key problem for the Indian economy and reviving it is the critical challenge.

But how does this translate into a call to change personnel and not simply a call to policy "reform". The problem is that, to the government's credit, it has implemented several reforms recently aimed at reducing the costs of doing business.

It has cut and simplified the Goods and Services Tax (GST), rationalised and improved labour laws, liberalised foreign direct investment into more sectors (FDI), and above all, concluded a free trade agreement with the European Union and provisionally agreed to a trade deal with the United States. And it has two committees entrusted with deregulating the economy. The government can throw up its hands and legitimately plead, "What more can we do?" These reforms have, however, not reassured investors. The key distinction that hints at a resolution of the paradox — and explains weak private investment — is between actions taken by the government on paper that affect the costs of doing business and the deeper instincts of the government that affect the risks of doing business on the ground.

These instincts include: Tilting the regulatory playing field in favour of a few, large corporate houses at the expense of other investors, domestic and foreign; favouring BJP states over opposition-run ones in allocating resources and directing investment flows; weaponising the state's coercive apparatus to target political opponents and business; over-zealously and arbitrarily implementing tax laws, and undermining India's federal decision-making structures. They neither engender confidence nor trust. Once could think of the call to policy reform as extending the "to do" list. In contrast, addressing the bad instincts problem is more like a "not to do" list. Changing personnel at ministerial, technocratic and bureaucratic levels is one — perhaps the only — way the government could signal a departure from these instincts and habits. The government must recruit fresh talent, prized for its quality, independence and new ideas, not loyalty and cheerleading. Officials must become more open and realistic about acknowledging the ongoing challenges.

Sameness of personnel and staleness of ideas are fatal for all political systems. Even politically dominant rulers must limit message-management and embrace churn. The truth is that this leopard has to change its spots or else the Indian economy will continue paying the price.

The writer is an Indian economist and the former chief economic advisor to the Government of India (2014-18). He is currently a senior fellow at the Peterson Institute for International Economics, Washington DC

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Energy goals

THE FALLING rupee is not the real problem, it is simply a warning sign. The real issue runs much deeper, and that is India's heavy dependence on imported energy (The energy challenge is urgent, step up to it, *IE*, May 25). What gives real hope is that India is not starting from zero and we are already moving in the right direction. The editorial rightly points out that switching to electricity for cooking and building world-class public transport are achievable goals. These steps would not only reduce our import dependence but also create millions of jobs and improve people's lives.

Sarjerao Eknath Narwade, Sangli

DISCUSSIONS ON energy security often focus on increasing supply, but insufficient attention is paid to reducing demand ('The energy challenge is urgent, step up to it, *IE*', May 25). India cannot achieve lasting energy resilience through imports or new capacity alone. The cheapest unit of energy is the one that is not consumed. Improving building efficiency, promoting electric public transport, reducing transmission losses and encouraging energy-conscious consumption can significantly lower dependence on imported fuels. A national mission on energy efficiency would not only strengthen energy security but also support climate goals.

Amit Kumar, Rajpura

Subsidy reform

A NATION that fears reforms is not governing — it is campaigning permanently ('India faces a 1991 moment: It needs to reform, relook at subsidies', *IE*, May 25). Fertiliser subsidies spiralling beyond Rs 2.50 lakh crore, urea smuggled across borders, and poorly targeted food subsidies continuing far beyond intended beneficiaries reflect a system driven by political convenience rather than economic discipline. Leaders know what needs fixing; they lack the courage to do it.

Hari Om Dixit, Deoria



SHAMBHAVI GUPTA

SOCIAL MEDIA and public discourse are flooded with memes about Gen Z in general, and more specifically, about its work ethic. Whether LinkedIn posts or Instagram reels, they tend to scorn this generation, which apparently comprises lazy work shirkers. In a scene from the recent *Devil Wears Prada 2*, watching Miranda Priestly (the editor-in-chief of the fashion magazine *Runway*) put her coat on the stand by herself, her ex-in-tern is taken by surprise — she was used to having it tossed at her. This is attributed to the new HR policy, introduced because "woke" children dislike having jackets flung at them. This becomes a testament to the fact that Gen Z values its self-worth and is not afraid to ask for what, in this case, is basic human decency.

Those belonging to this generation are popularly construed as overgrown children instead of responsible adults who understand the weight of their actions. They are often contrasted with millennials, who tend to have a work ethic that prioritises only work and total subversion to authority. One of the many reels on Instagram on this theme shows a millennial dragging himself to work despite being extremely sick. While this might be an exaggeration, it does display the values of that generation. Now, there

As a teacher in a private school, I wonder how my profession will sustain in the coming years because it thrives on extending oneself beyond work hours

is a cultural shift towards a generation who know how to prioritise their mental and physical health, build boundaries, disconnect from work after hours, and live their lives. Here, I must acknowledge that I am referring specifically to a certain class that has the vocabulary and privilege to behave in this way.

As a teacher in a private school, I wonder how my profession will sustain in the coming years because it thrives on extending oneself beyond work hours. Some schools are considerate and give enough free periods in the day, but even those are not enough to prepare for classes, design worksheets and exam papers, grade the work, do administrative tasks like lesson planning, write report cards, class-teacher duties and so on. Many tasks get pushed for home, and no matter what, there is always something that was due yesterday. Teaching is often labelled as a "calling" and not a job. Therefore, making a positive impact on the world, rather than monetary considerations, is believed to be the primary motivator for engaging in this field. This includes extending oneself indefinitely to ensure the best for one's students and school, but is it fair that a calling should demand constant sacri-

fice without adequate remuneration or boundaries that respect and protect one's time and efforts? The matter of extended work hours gets further complicated with students and other stakeholders expecting teachers to be available beyond working hours for queries and other tasks.

This often brings me to consider the work ethic of Gen Z. Their professional zeitgeist rests on refusing to engage in unpaid work beyond hours. Perhaps it is a function of privilege, but often, it is also a stricter awareness of one's rights. It is entirely possible to be passionate about one's work and still want to draw boundaries.

There is a constant struggle between the older generation mourning the loss of a dedicated workforce, and Gen Z wanting to maintain work-life balance. How will a profession like teaching survive in this tussle? It would require, first and foremost, stopping downplaying the issue of overwork and refraining from naturalising it as a part and parcel of the profession. We are often told that the generations who came before us took it in their stride. That "this" blurring of boundaries is "normal". We must begin by acknowledging it is not. Only then will the conversation move towards discussions of restructuring work and its boundaries.

Gupta is a Delhi-based Sociology teacher

From Gen Z, let's learn that work is not life



SAPTARSHI BASAK

"WE HAVE absolutely no fuel oil, absolutely no diesel." Readers might assume this declaration came from an energy minister in an Asian nation crippled by supply disruptions caused by the conflict in Iran. But Cuba — a regime change target of the US since Fidel Castro took over in 1959 — does not depend on the Strait of Hormuz at all for its oil imports. Civilians have been enduring blackouts lasting up to 22 hours a day, while doctors are sometimes forced to manually pump ventilators to keep newborns alive. For more than four months, the country has received virtually no fuel because Venezuelan shipments have dried up

entirely since January, when the US abducted Nicolás Maduro. Mexican shipments, too, have been suspended due to the threat of US tariffs. The US president has since said he hopes to have the "honour" of "taking Cuba" and doing "whatever I want" with it, expressing a rather naked imperial appetite, even as White House documents harp on about national security.

The damage caused by a sanctions-induced crisis is indirect, diffuse, and slow. Critical shortages of electricity, medicines, food, and fuel are not just consequences; human hardship is the very means to achieve the larger goal of regime change. The US has long used sanctions for its compellence strategies in the name of international governance, and, ironically, human rights. A recent *Lancet* study finds that unilateral sanctions imposed by the US and the

EU since 1970 are associated with 38 million deaths across the world.

One of the most notorious cases is Iraq. Joy Gordon's *Invisible War* (2010) documents how the US blocked humanitarian goods from reaching Iraq — objecting to imports of antibiotics and vaccines while accusing the Iraqi government of failing to procure medicines. Other cases include Iran, North Korea, and, of course, Cuba. They are indeed repressive dictatorships that treat their own citizens miserably to consolidate power. But it is also true that

Sanctions don't achieve intended goals, they increase repression, and they harm the wrong people

much of their economic isolation stems from their refusal to buckle to the Western order. Which brings us to the other common aspect of sanctions: They do not work.

Iran, North Korea and Cuba have their regimes intact because sanctions have had the opposite effect. Robert Pape explains in 'Why Economic Sanctions Do Not Work' (1997) that they increase government repression and reduce the likelihood of bottom-up regime change. Defeating Maduro in Venezuela was ultimately a US military operation; sanctions did not weaken his power. In Iran, too, the Americans and the Israelis had to resort to military force, and three months into the ongoing conflict, Tehran is far from capitulating.

Not only do sanctions frequently fail to achieve regime change, but their costs are passed down by the targeted entities —

which often have state backing — to the people. Matthias Neuenkirch and Florian Neumeier argue that US sanctions "indeed are affecting the wrong people" and that it is the people of the sanctioned state that bear the burden, "an outcome that appears especially unfair given that the regimes against which sanctions are directed typically lack democratic legitimisation".

So, sanctions don't achieve intended goals, they increase repression, and they harm the wrong people. What is more remarkable than how consistently sanctions fail in the stated goal is how consistently they succeed in the unstated one: Making ordinary life in the target country unbearable. That is Cuba's reality right now.

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TRUMP SAYS TALKS WITH TEHRAN PROCEEDING ‘NICELY’, URGES MORE ARAB STATES JOIN THE ABRAHAM ACCORDS

‘Unbreakable’: Xi hails ties with Pakistan, praises Iran peace efforts

Reuters
Beijing, May 25

PRESIDENT XI Jinping hailed China’s “unbreakable” friendship with Pakistan on Monday as he met Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif in Beijing, seeking to deepen their “all-weather” partnership.

Xi welcomed the Pakistani leader as an “old friend” at Beijing’s Great Hall of the People and said the two countries had “understood, trusted and supported each other” over decades.

Pakistan is among an exclusive group of countries which China regards as an “all-weather strategic partner”, spanning close economic, trade and security cooperation.

But Islamist militant attacks on Chinese nationals and projects in southwest Pakistan where China has big infrastructure investments have irked Beijing, while Islamabad’s warmer ties with Washington have complicated the relationship.

“No matter how the international situation changes, China always prioritises the development of China-Pakistan relations in its neighbourhood diplomacy,” Xi said.

China called for enhancing cooperation in agriculture, industry, artificial intelligence and talent cultivation with Pakistan, Chinese state broadcaster said.

Iran’s top envoys in Qatar to discuss deal to end war

Hormuz might open 30 days after hostilities end, reports *Nikkei*

Reuters
Washington, Dubai, May 25

IRAN’S TOP negotiator and its foreign minister were in Doha for talks with Qatar’s prime minister on a potential deal with the US to end the three-month-old war, an official briefed on the visit said on Monday, after Washington and Tehran played down hopes for an imminent breakthrough.

The *Nikkei* newspaper reported on Monday that the US and Iran are discussing a plan to open the Strait of Hormuz about 30 days after the two countries reach a deal to end hostilities. Iran would proceed to clear mines from the strait during a 30-day window following an agreement, after which ships from all countries would be able to navigate freely and safely, and Iran would stop collecting transit fees, *Nikkei* reported.

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio told reporters in New Delhi earlier that the US would give diplomacy every chance to



A woman holds an Iranian flag near a billboard depicting US President Donald Trump and the Strait of Hormuz, in Tehran on Monday. REUTERS

succeed before considering whether to deal with Iran in “another way”.

There was a “pretty solid thing on the table in terms of their ability to open up the strait (of Hormuz), get the strait open, enter into a very real, significant, time-limited negotiation on the nuclear matter, and hopefully we can pull it off,” Rubio said.

In a lengthy post on Truth Social on Monday, US President Donald Trump said talks with Iran were going “nicely”, but warned of fresh attacks if they failed. It “will only be a Great Deal for all, or no Deal at all,” he wrote.

Introducing a new angle, Trump said on Monday that he asked Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Pakistan, Turkey, Egypt and Jordan to join the Abraham Accords en masse to normalize relations with Israel as he tries to negotiate with Iran.

Pakistan rejected the proposal. None of the other countries has so far publicly reacted to Trump’s demand.

Trump said he spoke on Saturday to leaders of those countries, as well as the United Arab Emirates and Bahrain, which have already signed the accords, a set of agreements to normalize relations with Israel.

Iran’s President: Restore internet

Tehran: Iran’s President Masoud Pezeshkian has issued an order to reopen international internet access, Iranian state media said on Monday, citing an official. The report cited the head of public relations at Iran’s Communications Ministry.

Most Iranians have been unable to access the worldwide web for 87 days according to the internet observatory Net-Blocks, with only a few citizens having access to expensive and advanced VPNs that circumvent the restrictions. **REUTERS**

“I am mandatorily requesting that all Countries immediately sign the Abraham Accords, and that, if Iran signs its Agreement with me, as President of the United States of America, it would be an Honor to have them also be part of this unparalleled World Coalition,” Trump wrote in a post on Truth Social.

Iran’s foreign ministry spokesperson Esmaeil Baghaei said in a briefing that conclusions had been reached on many topics but that did not mean the sides were close to agreement.

Amid war worries, more than 1.5 mn pilgrims reach S Arabia for Haj

Associated Press
Saudi Arabia, May 25

THE ANNUAL Haj pilgrimage, one of the Five Pillars of Islam, officially began Monday.

More than 1.5 million pilgrims have arrived in Saudi Arabia from outside the country, Saleh bin Saad Al-Murabba, commander of the Haj passport forces, said on Friday.

The faithful have been pouring into the country for the Haj against the backdrop of a tenuous ceasefire in the Iran war and related regional tensions and uncertainty.

Egyptian pilgrim Samya Abdul Moneim said she was grateful to God that she made it to the Haj, which is required once in a lifetime of every Muslim who can afford it and is physically able to make it.

“I am in a state of blessing and happiness,” she said in Mecca on Sunday. “It’s an indescribable feeling, truly. I mean, thank God, I am in a blessing.”

This Haj “is, in effect, a hard reset for me,” Youssef Chouhoud, a political scientist at Christopher Newport University in Virginia, said Monday from the tent city of Mina.

“I pray that I emerge on the other side of this journey with a new sense of purpose and the discipline to see it through.”

Even after a Hormuz deal, moving 1,500 ships won’t be easy

Jenny Gross
London, May 25

WHEN THE Strait of Hormuz finally reopens, shipping companies will need to know which oil tankers get to start moving first, and whom to ask for the go-ahead. Vessels will need guidance on routes. And there’s the question of the potential threat of mines in the strait.

The US and Iran are moving closer to securing a deal to reopen the strait, and captains aboard the roughly 1,500 ships that have been stranded in the Persian Gulf for nearly three months are getting ready.

But a lot has to happen before they can start moving through the narrow and vital waterway, which carried one-fifth of the world’s oil and gas before war.

Even if a final deal is reached, the prewar status quo, when upward of 130 ships transited the strait each day, will be perhaps weeks or even months away. That is also one reason that energy prices, which have climbed in the United States and around the world, are not expected to fall fast.

Before ships can begin leaving the strait, which is 21 nautical miles wide at its narrowest, companies will need to know how

their ships will be prioritized, said Jakob P Larsen, the chief safety and security officer of the Baltic and International Maritime Council, which represents maritime companies, adding, vessels would be asked to follow a speed limit to minimize the risk of colliding or grounding in shallow water. “We will need to know which route to take and then, of course, what kind of coordination or permits or whatever would need to be obtained with which authorities,” Larsen said.

The potential for ships to strike sea mines that Iran is believed to have planted in the strait is a peril. British military officials have said Iran’s mines include ones that sit on the seabed and send gas bubbles to the surface, causing serious damage to a ship’s hull.

Navies including those of the US, Britain, France and Germany would need several weeks to deploy mine-sweepers, the International Energy Agency said in a report. This risk is likely to keep maritime insurance rates high.

Iran has threatened to exercise control of the strait and recently established a regulatory

agency to run operations there.

Ships that have been maintained by skeleton crews of seafarers — about 20,000 in all — have to be restarted.

Drifting in the warm waters of the Persian Gulf, vessels have accumulated barnacles, sea creatures and algae that can impede navigation.

Hapag-Lloyd, the fifth-largest container shipping group in the world, has been able to get one vessel out since the lockdown began. That ship required a lot of cleaning, Rolf Habben Jansen, the chief executive, said recently on a company podcast.

“We also noticed that once

we got her out that the maximum speed she could still achieve was significantly less than normal,” he said.

Lasse Kristoffersen, the chief executive of Wallenius Wilhelmsen, a car shipping and logistics giant with one vessel stranded in the Persian Gulf, said it would take at least 30 to 45 days until shipping in the region returned to normal — if everything went as planned.

The situation would stabilize only when shipping companies felt comfortable moving their stranded ships out of the Persian Gulf and also sending them into the region to load cargo. **NYT**

Tedros: Ebola toll 220, delay in detection worsened outbreak

Reuters
May 25

THE HEAD of the World Health Organization said on Monday that the fast-moving Ebola outbreak in Democratic Republic of Congo and Uganda was outpacing response efforts, giving the latest number of suspected deaths as 220.

Addressing an online meeting of the African Union about the outbreak, WHO Director-General Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus said a delay in detecting Ebola cases meant responders were now “playing catch-up” and the epidemic was likely to get worse before it gets better.

Tedros said he would travel to Congo, the epicentre of the outbreak, on Tuesday with another senior WHO official responsible for addressing health emergencies, Chikwe Ihekweazu.

Earlier on Monday neighbouring Uganda reported two



Red Cross workers in PPE disinfect the grounds outside the house of an Ebola victim in Mongbwalu, DR Congo, on Monday. REUTERS

more Ebola cases, taking its total number of confirmed cases to seven, and Tedros said other countries bordering Congo were at high risk and should take immediate action.

The WHO has declared the outbreak of the rare Bundibugyo strain of Ebola a public health emergency of international concern. Tedros said containing the

fast-moving outbreak was complicated by the fact that Congo’s Ituri and North Kivu provinces were highly insecure and there were no approved vaccines for Bundibugyo virus.

Doctors operating on the front lines of the fight against Ebola in Congo are also grappling with shortages of basic supplies.

Nepal ruling party chief to visit India on June 1

PM Balendra to skip customary official address on Republic Day

Yubaraj Ghimire
Kathmandu, May 25

RABI LAMICHHANE, Chairman of the ruling Rastriya Swatantra Party will be undertaking a two-day official trip to Delhi, as Prime Minister Balendra Shah showed reluctance to visit India or any other country after assuming power in March end.

Lamichhane will be visiting New Delhi on June 1 and return the next day. He will head a three-member party delegation.

There are no details yet on his engagements in Delhi but RSP sources here said he would be visiting the national headquarters of the BJP. There is also



RSP chief Rabi Lamichhane. FILE

speculation that he may be meeting PM Narendra Modi.

“It is not a substitute to the Prime Minister’s visit, but it could be on behalf of the party or even a personal one,” Sasmit Pokhrel, Minister for Education and the government spokesperson, said.

In another development, PM Shah on Monday wrote to President Ram Chandra Poudel requesting him to address the Republic Day function at Kathmandu’s Tundikhel on May 28. Traditionally, the Prime Minister delivers the address.

Risk of fatal blast at chemical tank in California averted, say authorities

California: The risk of a catastrophic explosion at a damaged chemical tank in Southern California has been eliminated following a close overnight inspection that confirmed a crack in the tank relieved pressure and cooled the chemical, authorities said Monday.

Officials said crews conducted tank temperature checks at night to reduce risks to firefighters, avoiding daytime operations when heat from the tank made conditions dangerous.

Orange County Fire Authority division chief Craig Covey said Monday morning that the results of overnight evaluation of the tank — that the temperature inside had dropped and that pressure had been released — was “incredibly positive news.”

However, evacuation orders remained for about 50,000 people in Garden Grove. **AP**

• BRIEFLY

BRAZIL

Prez Lula starts radiation after early-stage skin cancer diagnosis



Brazil's President Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva. FILE

BRAZILIAN PRESIDENT Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva has started preventive radiation treatment after being diagnosed with early-stage skin cancer, doctors treating the 80-year-old leftist leader and his office said on Monday. Lula had a basal cell lesion removed on April 24. “It was decided to proceed complementary treatment with preventive, superficial radiotherapy on the scalp,” doctors at the Sirio-Libanes Hospital said in a medical note, adding Lula will maintain his daily activities without any restrictions. **REUTERS**

GREECE

20 held over alleged EU farm subsidy scam

GREEK POLICE arrested 20 people on the island of Crete on Monday, saying they had dismantled a criminal gang suspected of defrauding the EU of farm subsidies. Among groups’ suspected leaders were two accountants and state employees who assisted farmers with submitting applications to receive funds based on false declarations. **AP**

CAMBODIA

King pardons Opp leader over treason charges

CAMBODIAN OPPOSITION leader Kem Sokha Monday was granted a royal pardon from his 27-year sentence for treason, a month after an appeals court affirmed his conviction and punishment. Hun Sen, the Senate president acting as head of state in the absence of King Norodom Sihamoni, issued the pardon freeing Kem Sokha from house arrest. **AP**

• NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

PAKISTAN

17 killed, 5 hurt after collision between buses

A SPEEDING bus collided with a motorbus parked along a roadside in Pakistan’s northwest on Monday, killing at least 17 people and injuring five others, police said. According to police, the passenger bus collided with another bus that was parked on the roadside due to a mechanical fault. **PTI**

BANGLADESH

15 dead after lorry carrying iron rods overturns

AT LEAST 15 people were killed and 10 others injured as a lorry loaded with iron rods overturned on a major highway early Monday. “The accident occurred on the eastern side of the Jamuna Bridge that connects northwestern Bangladesh with the central part,” local fire station chief Ataur Rahman said. **PTI**

Russia threatens to launch strikes on Kyiv defence targets

Kherson, Kharkiv regions report deaths & injuries

Reuters
May 25

RUSSIA URGED foreign nations on Monday to leave Kyiv before it launches a “series of systematic strikes” against defence targets in Ukraine’s capital, a day after one of its heaviest bombardments of the city since the start of the war.

Russia’s foreign ministry said the strikes were a response to what Moscow says was a deliberate drone strike on a student dorm in the Russian-controlled Luhansk region of eastern Ukraine.

Ukraine’s military denied the Russian accusations and said it had struck an elite drone command unit in the area. “Under these circumstances, the Armed Forces of the Russian Federation are launching a series of system-

atic strikes against Ukrainian military-industrial complex enterprises in Kyiv,” the ministry said in a statement.

The strikes will include specific sites involved in the design and manufacture of drones as well as decision-making centres and command posts, it said.

In Kyiv, rescuers worked on Monday to deal with the aftermath of Sunday’s strikes, which authorities said had killed two people and injured 91.

Moscow fired an Oreshnik hypersonic missile near Kyiv — its third use of the nuclear-capable weapon in the more than four-year-old war.

Around 300 sites across Kyiv were damaged, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said. One of the sites was a newly opened museum commemorating the 1986 Chernobyl nuclear disaster, which was badly damaged in Sunday’s strikes.

“As of today, there is not a single room in the National Chernobyl Museum that has not been destroyed,” museum director Vitalina Martynovska said.

• THE FIRST U.S. POPE CALLS FOR OWNERSHIP OF A.I. DATA NOT TO BE LEFT SOLELY IN PRIVATE HANDS, FOR POLICYMAKERS TO PROTECT RIGHTS OF WORKERS & KEEPING CHILDREN SAFE FROM THE TECHNOLOGY

Pope, urging AI regulation, warns some weapons now beyond human control

Reuters
Vatican City, May 25

POPE LEO urged governments to slow down and closely regulate the development of AI systems in his first major document, released on Monday, warning that they spread misinformation, prioritise conflict and risk leading the world down a path of unending war.

The first US pope also expressed concern at a Vatican event launching the text that some autonomous weapons systems have advanced “practically beyond any human reach to govern them.”

The event was also attended by Chris Olah, a co-founder of

Anthropic, one of the world’s top AI companies.

Leo, who has adopted a more forceful tone in recent months and has drawn the ire of US President Donald Trump after criticising the Iran war, made a range of impassioned appeals to world leaders in the lengthy document, known as an encyclical.

The first US pope called for ownership of AI data not to be left solely in private hands, for policy-makers to protect the rights of workers and keep children safe from the technology, and urged the cooling of competition between AI companies.

“What is needed is a more active political involvement

that is capable of slowing things down when everything is accelerating,” said Leo in the text, entitled “Magnifica Humanitas” (Magnificent Humanity).

The pope called for “robust legal frameworks, independent oversight, informed users and a political system that does not abdicate its responsibility.”

Encyclicals are one of the highest forms of teaching from a pontiff to the Church’s 1.4 billion members. Monday’s highly anticipated text, spanning nearly 43,000 words, has been in the works nearly since Leo’s election as pope a little more than a year ago.

The document, which addressed AI as its main theme,



Pope Leo XIV at the presentation of his first encyclical at the Vatican on Monday. AP

also decried the number of wars roiling the world, lamented the weakening of

multilateral organisations and warned that arms industry profits were a driving force be-

hind conflicts.

“The past 60 years have been marked by conflicts of astonishing brutality, often affecting civilian populations on a massive scale,” stated Leo, in the English-language text.

“Humanity is slipping into a violent culture of power, where peace no longer appears as a responsibility to be taken on, but as a fragile interval between conflicts,” he said.

At the Vatican event on Monday, Anthropic co-founder Olah thanked Leo for addressing the problems raised by the disruptive, new technology. He said firms like his faced strong commercial pressures and needed outside scrutiny.

Historic apology for Vatican’s role in legitimising slavery

Vatican City: Pope Leo XIV made a historic apology on Monday for the role the Holy See played in legitimizing slavery and for having failed to condemn it for centuries, calling the Vatican’s record a “wound in Christian memory.”

Past popes have apologized for Christians’ involvement in the trans-Atlantic slave trade. But no pope had ever publicly acknowledged, much less apologized for, the role that past popes played in giving European sov-

ereigns explicit authority to subjugate and enslave “infidels.”

“It is impossible not to feel deep sorrow when contemplating the immense suffering and humiliation endured by so many in stark contrast to their immeasurable dignity as persons infinitely loved by the Lord,” Leo wrote. In his encyclical, Leo recalled that his namesake, Pope Leo XIII, was the first to explicitly condemn slavery in 1888, long after many countries had abolished it. **AP**

SURGE IN FUEL DEMAND IN SOME POCKETS LEADING TO DRY-OUT-LIKE SITUATIONS

Govt dials states to watch supply at OMC pumps, check hoarding

‘Constraints in certain pockets are largely due to timely last-mile supply issues amid surging demand’

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, May 25

THE CENTRE has held discussions with all states and union territories (UTs) amid instances of panic buying of petrol and diesel and reports of localised supply constraints at public sector oil marketing companies’ (OMCs) retail outlets in some pockets, a senior petroleum ministry official said on Monday.

In view of the situation, state governments and UT administrations have been asked to closely monitor the situation on a regular basis as well as check any hoarding or mismanagement of fuel stocks, according to Petroleum Ministry Joint Secretary Sujata Sharma.

“A VC (video conference) has been done with all states and union territories on the issue. Discussions have been held and state governments and union territories have been requested to monitor the situation. At the level of the OMCs as well as the (petroleum) ministry, all retail

outlets and the fuel supply situation are being monitored closely so that if there are any intermittent dry-outs anywhere, they can be addressed immediately by quickly replenishing petrol and diesel stocks at retail outlets,” Sharma told reporters.

“If there is any hoarding or mismanagement in any part of the country, we would need the state government’s support to deal with that. This was also one of the specific points raised in the VC,” Sharma said, adding that overall, there are adequate stocks of petrol and diesel in the country and the constraints being seen in certain pockets are largely due to timely last-mile supply issues amid surging demand. Fuel demand, particularly that of diesel, is seeing a jump in certain pockets as a large number of bulk fuel consumers have shifted to OMCs’ retail outlets due to a wide price gap between retail prices — still below market rates — and the market-linked bulk prices, as per the Centre.

While retail pumps usually

• OMCs’ RETAIL NETWORK UNDER PRESSURE

FUEL DEMAND, particularly of diesel, is seeing a jump in certain pockets as a large number of bulk fuel consumers have shifted to public sector OMCs’ retail outlets

THE MOVE is driven by a wide price gap between retail prices — which are still below market rates — and the market-linked bulk prices

WITH CERTAIN private sector fuel retailers selling at higher prices than the OMCs, the latter is



seeing additional pressure in its retail network as consumers are preferring to buy from them

sell fuel to two-wheelers and cars, bulk and commercial buyers like state road transport corporation buses, trucks, and diesel-powered telecom towers are supposed to get theirs from designated points.

On top of that, certain private sector fuel retailers are re-tailing at higher prices than the OMCs, leading to additional pressure on the latter’s network as consumers are preferring to buy from them. Higher fuel demand due to the crop harvesting season has also led to additional demand pressure. While fuel production and supply at

the national level is stable and adequate, these factors are leading to regional imbalances and last-mile logistical challenges for the OMCs to maintain 24x7 supplies, particularly in tier-II and tier-III cities, and rural and remote areas, said industry executives. Consequently, the OMCs’ retail outlets in some areas are running out of fuel stocks faster than usual, leading to dry-out-like situations.

Industry sources said the problem gets amplified when a supply constraint at one retail outlet leads to rumours of shortage in the area, and consumers

Centre likely to remove 11% duty on cotton as prices soar amid war

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, May 25

THE UNION government is set to remove the 11% duty on cotton till October to offer relief to the textile manufacturers facing increased input cost from fuel to polyesters in the backdrop of the West Asia crisis, sources aware of the development told *The Indian Express*.

The duty was last removed between August and September 2025 when steep US tariffs had begun hurting manufacturing and investments.

Industry executives said the price of cotton has surged nearly 10-15% during the last month alone due to hoarding as cotton demand picked up in line with other input materials, particularly polyester. Domestic fuel prices have also begun to rise as the oil marketing companies have started passing on the surge in global crude oil prices to consumers.

India is the second-largest cotton producer after China, but relies on imports for about 15% of its raw cotton and about 20% of its yarn to meet demand. However, India’s cotton production has been declining due to a range of policy failures. Experts said that cotton production has stagnated for years largely due to a lack of new seeds, modern irrigation facilities, and frequent pest attacks and diseases.

Apparel Export Promotion Council (AEPCC) A. Sakthivel had earlier this month asked the government to eliminate the duty due to high cotton prices and rising input costs. In

a presentation made to the Finance, Commerce and Industry and Textile Ministry, AEPCC said that India has recently entered into several Free Trade Agreements (FTAs), but competing countries have lower input costs.

“Competing apparel exporting nations can access cotton at internationally competitive prices, whereas Indian manufacturers continue to face higher raw material costs due to the prevailing import duty structure. The delegation stated that a reduction in import duty on cotton is essential to help the Indian apparel industry secure greater business opportunities from FTA partner countries and enhance India’s competitiveness in the global market,” AEPCC Chairman said in a statement.

Unlike several other competitors, such as Bangladesh and Vietnam, India is one of the largest producers of cotton and farmers’ interests weigh on the duty-related decision. Apparel manufacturers have said some investment that had begun going out of the country due to tariffs has started to come back.

An industry executive who did not wish to be named said the sector is also seeing European investments coming into India as they are trying to diversify away from Bangladesh. “Bangladesh has signed an FTA with the US and is also seeking a deal with the EU, as India’s duty disadvantage will be eliminated soon when the deal comes into effect,” the executive said.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

SENTIMENT IMPROVES OVER POTENTIAL US-IRAN DEAL

Equity markets rally 1.4%, rupee rises to 95.23/\$ as oil prices ease

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, May 25

INDIAN EQUITY markets rallied sharply on Monday, with benchmark indices surging around 1.4%, while the rupee extended its winning streak for a third consecutive session against the US dollar.

Investor sentiment improved significantly amid growing optimism over a potential peace agreement between Iran and the US, easing concerns surrounding geopolitical tensions in West Asia.

The drop in oil prices below \$100 per barrel gave a boost to market confidence, particularly for import-dependent economies like India, where lower crude costs can help ease inflationary pressures and improve fiscal stability.

The NSE’s Nifty 50 ended the session at 24,031.70, up 312.40 points or 1.3% from its previous close. The BSE’s Sensex closed 1,073.61 points or 1.4% higher at 76,488.96.

The gains were broad-based, with over 66% of the stocks trading on the NSE ending higher, with almost all sectoral indices also gaining. These gains were led by banking, financial services, and automobile stocks.

Other global markets, led by Nikkei of Japan which rose 2.87%, also gained ground.

The rupee ended at 95.23 against the dollar on Monday and has now gained over 1.5% since hitting a record low of 96.96, aided by hopes of peace in West Asia and reported heavy intervention from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). However, the rupee is still

• Global markets gain ground as well

INDEX	% CHANGE ON MONDAY
Nikkei 225 (Japan)	2.87
CSI 300 (China)	1.58
Taiex (Taiwan)	3.26
DAX (Germany)	2.01

SOURCE: EXCHANGES

down around 5% against the greenback from its pre-war levels. The sharp fall from the pre-war levels has arguably left the currency undervalued both nominally and in terms of the real effective exchange rate (REER), RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra told *Mint* in an interview.

The REER is a mechanism to compare the weighted average value of a currency against a basket of global currencies. Malhotra’s comment also boosted sentiment in the forex market.

“The rupee traded strongly, gaining around 0.45%, as improving sentiment around the US-Iran conflict supported risk assets and eased pressure on crude oil prices. Reports suggesting progress towards a possible peace framework and reopening of the Strait of Hormuz helped strengthen the rupee and other emerging market currencies,” said Jateen Trivedi, VP Research Analyst, Commodity and Currency, LKP Securities.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Crisil: Corporate margins in FY27 may fall by 200 bps due to crisis

Mumbai: The prolonged supply-chain disruptions triggered by the ongoing West Asia conflict are expected to significantly dent corporate profitability this fiscal year, according to a report from rating agency Crisil.

Operating profitability of Indian firms could decline by nearly 200 basis points from the pre-conflict estimate of 12%, with some sectors seeing a more pronounced impact, it said.

The protracted conflict has been goading domestic companies to realign supply chains, navigate pricing issues, manage higher fuel and freight costs and contend with a depreciating rupee, the rating firm said in a report.

The decline in profitability reflects the mounting pressure from higher logistics costs, delayed shipments and volatile commodity prices.

“For companies, managing costs and profitability will be a bigger challenge than achieving topline growth. Of the 34 sectors stress-tested, 22 would see operating profitability being culled more than 10% due to higher inventory costs and inability to fully pass on the burden to consumers immediately,” said Subodh Rai, Managing Director, Crisil Ratings. ENS

Tata Sons board to meet today: focus on future growth, restructuring

George Mathew
Mumbai, May 25

THE BOARD of Tata Sons, holding company of \$180 billion Tata group, is expected to meet on Tuesday, with Chairman N Chandrasekaran likely to present a revised strategic roadmap for the conglomerate’s future growth and restructuring plans to the directors, including Vice Chairman Noel Tata.

The discussions are expected to focus on the long-term direction of key group firms, particularly the turnaround and consolidation strategy for several unlisted and loss-making businesses within the Tata portfolio.

The proposed roadmap is likely to outline priorities around operational efficiency, capital allocation, leadership alignment and strengthening the group’s overall financial performance amid evolving market conditions.

The Tata Sons board currently comprises six members: Executive Chairman N. Chandrasekaran, Vice Chairman and Non-Executive Director Noel Tata, Non-Executive Director Venu Srinivasan, Independent Directors Harish Manwani and Anita M George, along with Executive Director and Group CFO Saurabh Agrawal.

It’s not clear whether the issue of listing of Tata Sons is on the agenda. While the official position of Tata Sons is against listing, Venu Srinivasan has publicly advocated for the listing of Tata Sons.

On February 24, the outcome of the board meeting of Tata Sons was unusual as Noel Tata surprised other directors, raising questions on losses made by several unlisted companies in the group. While the extension of its Chairman N Chandrasekaran for a third



EXPRESS PHOTO

term of five years was agreed upon earlier by Tata Trusts trustees, Noel Tata proved to be a tough task master — raising several queries at the board meeting and putting across several conditions for approving another term for him.

Four Tata Sons directors were in favour of extending the tenure and were ready to put the issue for voting, but Chandrasekaran proposed postponement of the decision as he apparently felt decisions in Tata Sons should be on consensus based, a tradition followed by late Ratan Tata. In short, he wanted the approval of Noel Tata for the extension.

Chandrasekaran, 63, became the Chairman of Tata Sons in 2017 after the exit of Cyrus Mistry. He got his second extension in 2022. For a third extension, Tata Sons will have to waive the retirement norms.

As per the current policy, directors in executive position should retire on attaining 65 years of age.

Meanwhile, the board of Tata Trusts — excluding the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) — is expected to meet on June 8 to deliberate on a broad set of governance and strategic issues. Among the key matters expected to come up for discussion is the future of Venu

• BRIEFLY

India turns net importer of finished steel

New Delhi: The country turned a net importer of finished steel in April, as per the provisional government data reviewed by *Reuters* Monday. India imported 0.7 million metric tonnes of finished steel in April, up 30.8% from a year earlier. It exported 0.5 million tonnes of finished steel in April, up 24.9%. China, South Korea, Japan, Vietnam, and Russia were the top exporters of finished steel to India, data showed. Finished steel shipments to the UAE and the UK rose, while exports to Belgium and Italy fell. REUTERS

Paytm arm to invest 9 mn euro in European arm

New Delhi: Fintech firm One 97 Communications, which operates under the Paytm brand, on Monday said its wholly-owned subsidiary Paytm Cloud Technologies will invest 9 million euro in its European payment entity. “... The Board of Directors of PCTL (Paytm Cloud Technologies Ltd) has approved an additional investment by way of subscription to 9 million equity shares of EUR 1 (one euro only) each at a total consideration of EUR 9 million (nine million euro), in its wholly-owned subsidiary, Paytm Europe

• REVISED ROADMAP

● It will outline priorities on operational efficiency, capital allocation, leadership alignment and strengthening the overall financial performance amid evolving market conditions

● However, it’s not clear if the issue of Tata Sons listing is on the agenda. While the official position of Tata Sons is against listing, Srinivasan has publicly advocated for it

Srinivasan’s role as a nominee director on the board of Tata Sons. The review assumes significance because Srinivasan had reportedly diverged from the stance adopted by the Tata Trusts by supporting the view that Tata Sons should become a listed entity.

On May 16, Tata Trusts decided to defer the much-awaited board meeting of SRTT following an order from the Charity Commissioner of Maharashtra.

Interestingly, the order has made reference to representation/complaint from Tata Sons Director and Tata Trusts Trustee Venu Srinivasan and Katyayani Agrawal. It’s clear from the order of the Charity Commissioner that Srinivasan and Agrawal raised the issue of reducing the number of perpetual trustees.

The board meeting was originally supposed to be held on May 8 but the trust postponed it to May 16 without assigning any reason.

The key issues on the agenda of Tata Trusts board meet included review of Tata Trusts representation on the board of Tata Sons, differing views among trustees regarding the potential listing of Tata Sons and the issue of perpetual trustees.

Blanket ALMM extension ruled out for solar cells

New Delhi: The renewable energy ministry on Monday said it has decided that no blanket extension of the deadline for applicability of the Approved List of Models and Manufacturers (ALMM) List-II for solar PV cells beyond June 1, 2026, is required. The decision was taken after detailed examination of representations received from stakeholders and wider consultations held with the industry, the MNRE said. PTI

I-T Dept flags common errors in SFT filings

New Delhi: The Income Tax Department’s analysis of Statement of Financial Transactions filings by banks and mutual funds has identified common errors, such as duplicate reporting, incorrect transaction values, and missing PAN details, which can cause inconvenience for taxpayers, officials said Monday. Under the Income Tax Act, reporting entities are required to furnish details of prescribed financial transactions and reportable accounts in the Statement of Financial Transactions (SFT) to tax authorities. PTI

• MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▲	US Dollar ▼
76488.96	24031.70	₹1,58,857	₹95.23
1,073.61	312.40		
1.42%	1.32%	Silver ▲	Oil ▼
		₹2,71,100	\$106.26

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF MAY 22, 2026

Classifieds

PERSONAL

It is for general information that I, NAINA BINDAL D/o BHIMSEN BINDAL,R/O-24, Ashok-Mohalla, Nangloi, Delhi-41, declare that name of my Father has been wrongly written as BHIMSEN AGARWAL in my PAN-Card GZBPB3745R, Voter card UBF3051991. The actual name of my father is BHIMSEN BINDAL, which may be amended accordingly.

0040856514-10

It is for general information that I, Ritik Kumar Verma S/o Anil Kumar Verma R/o Laxmi Jwaellors, Post Nawagarh, PS Barora, Harina Market, Dist: Jharkhand- 828306, declare that name of my father has been wrongly written as Anil Verma in my 12th Class School Certificate Cum Marksheet. The actual name of my father is Anil Kumar Verma, which may be amended accordingly.

0071037872-1

I, hitherto known as Pintoo S/O Sh. Ram Singh, residing at House no.-19, Gharonda Neem ka Bangar Patparganj East Delhi-110091, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Ahirbudhya Aryaghat.It is certified that, I have complied with other legal requirements in this connection.

0040856525-3

I, hitherto known as HARSH, S/O-Sh. Krishna, R/O-54, Sector-28,Dwarka, Bamnoli, PO:Raj-Nagar-II, DIST:South West Delhi, Delhi-110077, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as HARSH KUMAR.

0040856514-4

I, V.S.KUMAR ALIAS V.SHIVA KUMAR,S/O V.SATYANARAYANA R/o, Quarter-No-27,Type-4, Kali-Bari Apartments,Udyan-Marg Sector-II, DIZ-Area,Gole-Market, G.P.O.,New Delhi-110001, have changed my name to VARANASI SHIVA KUMAR DATTA TREYA.

0040856517-7

I, TARANNUM, W/O-MEHMOOD HASAN,R/O-240,GALI GARHAIYYA BAZAR MATIA MAHALI JAMA MASJID DELHI-6 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO TARANNUM HASAN.

0040856521-3

I, Syed Mohammad Quiser Hossain, S/O- Syed Md Gazzanar, R/O F-22, 1st floor, Block-F, Lalpat Nagar-1, South Delhi-110024 Have changed my name to Syed Md Qaiser.

0040856521-1

I, Sunita Devi W/o Sh. Nand Kishor Baitha, R/O C-29, Sector-26, Noida, District- Gautam Budh Nagar (U.P.)-201301, have changed my name from Sunita to Sunita Devi. That Sunita and Sunita Devi both are one and same person.

0040856517-8

I, Sudhir Kumar, S/o-Prem Prakash Srivastava, R/o-A-3, Life-Care Hospital, Mayur-Vihar, Phase-3, Delhi-110096, have changed my name from Sudhir Kumar to Sudhir Kumar Srivastava, for all, future purposes.

0040856517-4

I, Sucheta Mishra, W/o-Deepak Goel, R/O-RZ-23, Street No.4, Main Sagarpur, Delhi, have changed my name to Sucheta Goel, for all purposes.

0040856512-4

I, OMAR AKMAL S/O SHAHZAD R/O-B-4/47, 1ST FLOOR YAMUNA VIHAR DELHI-110053, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO OMAR.

0040856497-1

I, Saloni W/o-Rohit Jain R/o-1/7386-A, F/F Gali No.2, Shivaji Park Extension, Shahdara Delhi-110032 have changed my name to Saloni Jain.

0040856497-10

I, SHAHINA PARVEEN W/O ABDUL AZIZ R/O 1997 Gali INDARA KUAN QASIM JAAN LAL KUAN DELHI 110006 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ZAHIDA BEGUM PERMANENTLY AS PER MY DOCUMENTS.

0071037858-1

I, SAKSHI ANAND W/o Amit Verma R/o House No.WZ-718A, Top-Floor, Rishi Nagar Rani Bagh Delhi-110034, have changed my name to GUNJAN VERMA

0040856517-5

I, S V RAJAGOPALAN, S/O- VASUDEVAN, R/O-C-15-2102 PRATEEK GRAND-CITY SIDDARTH-VIHAR GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH-201009, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME, FROM S V RAJAGOPALAN TO. RAJAGOPALAN VASUDEVAN SRIRANGAM, FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE

0040856514-6

I, Roy Mousumi, W/o Khagen Roy, R/o Kamranga Gurhi, Cooch Behar-1, P.O.Cooch Behar, Dist: Cooch Behar, West Bengal-736101, I have changed my name from Roy Mousumi to Mousumi Roy for all future purposes.

0040856517-12

I, Ravi Dutt Sharma S/o Satnarain, R/o Village Kassar (43), Tehsil Bahadurgarh Distt Jhajjar (Haryana), have changed my name to Ravi Dutt.

0040856517-1

I, RUKHSANA/ RUKHSANA/ RUK HSANA W/O SHAHZAD R/O, B-4/47, 1ST FLOOR YAMUNA VIHAR DELHI-110053, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RUKHSANA AKMAL

0040856497-4

I Manju Pandey W/o Pankaj Kumar Pandey R/o Flat.No-802, Hawelia Valencia Homes Plot.No. GH-078, Sector-1, Greater Noida, Gautam Buddh Nagar-201306 have changed my name from Manju Pandey to Manju Mishra. Henceforth I would be Known by the name of Manju Mishra for all future purposes.

0071037841-1

I, RUKHSANA AKMAL, W/O-SHAHZAD R/O B-4/47 1ST FLOOR YAMUNA VIHAR DELHI-110053, HAVE CHANGED MY CHILD NEME ZOHAN TO ZOHAN SHAHZAD.

0040856497-3

I, RUKHSANA AKMAL, W/O SHAHZAD R/O B-4/47 1ST FLOOR YAMUNA VIHAR DELHI-110053, HAVE CHANGED MY CHILD NEME AKSA TO AKSA SHAHZAD.

0040856497-2

I, RAMPHAL SHARMA alias RAMPAL SHARMA, S/O-SHIV KUMAR SHARMA, R/O-V.P.O.BAPORA, DIST.BHIWANI, HARYANA-127111, I HEREBY DECLARE THAT BOTH THE NAMES RAMPHAL SHARMA AND RAMPAL SHARMA PERTAINS TO ME AND IS THE SAME PERSON.

0040856497-7

I, Panchami Haldar W/o Sh. Subir Kumar Mandal, R/o F-56, Sector-21, Noida, Gautam Budh Nagar (U.P.)-201301, have changed my name from Panchami to Panchami Haldar. That Panchami and Panchami Haldar both are one and same person.

0040856517-9

I, PARDEEP THAKKAR ALIAS PARDEEP THAKUR S/O PUNJARA LAL R/o, H.No.64, Upper Ground-Floor, Pocket-4A, Sector-23, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed my name to PARDEEP KUMAR THAKUR.

0040856517-6

I, Mrs. Neeru Bhatteja @ Rani Bhatteja W/O Late Shri Shyam Bhatteja R/O 391, Third Floor, Kohat Enclave, Pitampura, Delhi-110034, hereby state, that, my name is recorded as Neeru Bhatteja in certain records/documents, whereas, my correct, and current, legal name, is Rani Bhatteja. Henceforth, I shall be known, and identified, as Rani Bhatteja for, all purposes.

0040856525-1

I, Manoj S/o Ram Kishan, R/o H.NO-211 TAKIA CHOUK, NEAR JULAHA BASTI, burari, North Delhi-110084, Have changed my name to Manoj Kumar

0040856514-3

I, MURTI DEVI alias MONIKA SHARMA, W/O RAMPHAL SHARMA, R/O V.P.O.BAPORA, DIST.BHIWANI, HARYANA-127111, I HEREBY DECLARE THAT BOTH THE NAMES MURTI DEVI AND MONIKA SHARMA PERTAINS TO ME AND IS THE SAME PERSON

0040856497-8

I, Rahim Boukhs, S/o Mohamad Baksh, R/o-Z-2/476, Street No.4, J.J.colony, Welcome, Seelampur, East Delhi-110053, have changed my name to Rahim Baksh for all purposes.

0040856497-11

I, MAHMOOD HASAN, S/O-MOHD HASAN, R/O-240, GALI GARHAIYYA-BAZAR MATIA MAHALI JAMA MASJID DELHI-6, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MEHMOOD HASAN.

0040856521-2

I, Lourenco Severiano Dosouza, S/o- Late Agapito Antonio De Souza, R/o-F-13, 3rd floor South Extension- Part2, New Delhi-110049, have changed my name to Lourenco Severiano De Souza.

0040856517-4

I, L.N. BANSAL, C/O-LATE, SH.PRASHADI LAL, H.No-C-10, UG-FLOOR, RAMPRASTHA, NEAR-CITY CENTER MARKET, GHAZIABAD, CHANDER NAGAR, P.O.CHANDER NAGAR, DIST. GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH-201011, have changed my name to LAXMI NARAIN BANSAL.

0040856514-5

I, Kunal S/o Manoj Kumar R/o A-5/28, Sector-15, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed the name to Kunal Verma.

0040856517-3

I, KARAN S/O MOHAN LAL, R/o 16/590-H, SF HARDAYAN SINGH, ROAD BAPA NAGAR Near VishnumANDIR KAROL-BAGH Central, Delhi-110005, Have changed my name to KARAN MUNDOTIA.

0040856514-9

I, Gurpreet C/o-Manjit Singh Khanna, R/o-H.No.201, New Raja Garden, Mithapur Road, Jalandhar, Punjab-144022, have changed my name from Gurpreet to Gurpreet Kaur Khanna, for all future purposes.

0040856512-2

I, Gauri D/o- Gurpreet Kaur Khanna, R/o-H.No.201, New Raja Garden, Mithapur Road, Jalandhar, Punjab-144022, have changed my name from Gurpreet to Gurpreet Kaur Khanna, for all future purposes.

0040856512-2

I, Gauri D/o- Gurpreet Kaur Khanna, R/o-H.No.201, New Raja Garden, Mithapur Road, Jalandhar, Punjab-144022, have changed my name to FARHAN and also change my father name to MOHD SALEEM.

0040856497-5

I, Chhavi, D/o Chander Prakash, W/o Neeraj Sharma, R/o-B-23, Golden Park, Shiv Puri, Krishna Nagar, Delhi-110051, have changed my name to Sneha Sharma, for all purposes.

0040856497-9

I, Anubha, W/o Tushar Sharma, R/O-The Merlin Flat.No-1009 Sector-13 GH-1, Vasundhara Ghaziabad U.P.-201012 have changed my name to Abubha Gaur Sharma.

0040856514-1

I, Surender Singh Nandal S/O Randhir Singh Nandal R/O 13/GH1 Archana Apts. Paschim Vihar N-Delhi-63 have changed my name to Surender Singh

0071037820-1

I Pinki alias Pinki Ravikant R/o Maheshwar W/o Ravikant R/o L-2/155-B, PDA Lig Flats, Kalkaji, PO: Kalkaji, Dist: South Delhi, Delhi-110019 have changed my name to Pinki Ravikant for all purposes.

0040856367-2

I, Anju Mishra W/o Puneet Mishra R/o Awash Homes, 2nd-Floor, Ajnara Colony, Street-No.2, Sector-121, Noida (U.P) have changed my name to Anju Mani Tripathi for all purposes.

0040856436-1

I, Varsha Yadav D/o Vijay Pal Yadav R/o Tower 2 Flat No-518 Veridia, Sector-1, Wavacity NH24, Kavi Nagar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201002, have changed my name to Varsha Yadav.

0071037853-1

I, TRIPTI DEVI, D/o SATYAVIR SINGH, R/o B-243, Gharoli Dairy Farm, Mayur Vihar Phase-III, Delhi-110096, declare that name of my father has been wrongly written as SATYAVEER in my 10th Class & 12th class school record. The actual name of my father is SATYAVIR SINGH, which may be amended accordingly.

0040856470-1

I, Simran Dhamija, W/o Manmeet Singh, R/o-Flat-No.203, Ajit-Residency, Vikas Nagar, Sector-2, Lucknow-226022, have changed my name Simran Kaur, for all purposes.

0040856366-1

I, Shri Ram S/o Babu Lal Nishad R/o G-49 sector-27, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Noida Uttar Pradesh-201301, have changed my name to Shri Ram Nishad for all future purposes

0071037842-1

I, Deepika Rana, W/o-Rijul Sharma, R/o-H No-D-302, Jal Vayu Tower, Jhajar, Dehradun Uttarakhand-248007 have changed my name to Deepika Sharma

0040856514-2

I, Shikha Ramandeep Singh W/o Ramandeep Singh R/o Kothi No-7, R A Line, Meerut, Uttar Pradesh-520001, I have changed the name of my minor daughter Diyana Yadav to Diyanna Yadav aged 16 years.

0071037855-1

I, Saurabh Jain S/o Sunil Kumar Jain R/o H.No.353, First Floor, Sadbhawna Society, Niti Khand-II, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, UP-201014, have changed my name to SAURABH SUNIL KUMAR JAIN for all future purposes.

0071037816-1

I, Sanjeev Kumar Tyagi S/o Surendra Singh, aged 55, R/o-314, Main Gali, Near Gali No-16, Brij Vihar Colony, Muradnagar, Ghaziabad, UP.201206, have changed my name from Sanjay Kumar S/o Surendra to Sanjeev Singh. My name appears as Sanjay Kumar S/o Surendra in revenue records and Sanjiv Kumar S/o Surendra Singh in Nagar Palika Muradnagar records. I am also known as Sanjeev Tyagi, Sanjiv Kumar, Sanjay Tyagi. All names pertain to me. Henceforth I shall be known as Sanjeev Kumar Tyagi S/o Surendra Singh for all purposes.

0040856412-1

I, SUGANDHA SAXENA W/O SACHIN BHARDWAJ, R/o 9261, Gali Mata Wali, Tokri Walan Library Road, Azad Market, Delhi-06, have changed my name to SUGANDHA BHARDWAJ for all purposes.

0040856375-1

I, SISY B JOSE W/o No. JC-331104-F Rank EX SUB MAJ BENNY JOSE R/O WZ-10 B/3rd Floor Plot No-126 and 127, Gali No-8, Krishna Park Tilak Nagar, Delhi-110018 have changed my name to SISY BENNY vide affidavit date 23-5-26 before Delhi.

0071037819-1

I, SATISH PARKASH SHARMA C/o Prakash Sharma, HR-266/7, Pul Pehlad Pur, Badarpur, Delhi-44 have changed my name to SATISH SHARMA.

0071037860-1

I, SADAQAT ALI S/o SARAFAT ALI R/o J-3/22, Khirki Extn. Malviya Nagar Delhi-17 have changed my name to SIDAQAT ALI.

0071037887-1

I, Rishav Kumar, S/o Late Sh. Pawan Kumar, R/o H.No. 312/313, 3rd Floor, Triveni Apartment, Jhilmil Colony, Vivek Vihar, Delhi-95 have changed my name from Rishav to Rishav Kumar for all future purposes.

0040856446-1

I, Ratankumar Rao S/o Mahesh Sham Rao, S1/58, UGF, Old Mahavir Nagar, Tilak Nagar, Delhi-18 have changed my name to RATANKUMAR MAHESH RAO.

0071037899-1

I, Rahul, S/o Satish Kumar, R/o Moi (79), Sonipat, Haryana-131301, have changed my name to Rahul Bhardwaj. Henceforth, I shall be known as Rahul Bhardwaj.

0130065018-1

I, RAJNISH, S/O JAGPHUL SINGH KINHA, R/O H.NO-483/28, GALI NO-8, JYOTI PARK, GURGAON, HARYANA-122001. Have changed my name to RAJNISH SINGH For all future purposes.

0071037856-1

I, Payari W/o No 272165 Rank EX CORPORAL (Late) NS Dagar R/o 31, Mohammad Pur Village, Dist: South West Delhi, Delhi-110066 have changed my name to Pyari vide affidavit date 23-5-26 before Delhi.

0071037825-1

I, Naresh Kumar, S/o Ram Singh, R/o-House.No-116, Village-New Roshan Pura Najafgarh, Delhi-110043, have changed my name to Naresh, Permanently

0040856366-2

I, Namra, D/o Mohammad Parvez Nasir Khan, R/o-326, Kote-Qilla, Teachers Colony, Post-Sadar Azamgarh, Uttar Pradesh-276001, have changed my name to Namra Mohammad Parvez, Permanently

0040856366-3

I Rajeev Mudikattu Narayanan S/O, Mudikattu Narayanan Nair R/o Florence D 305 Grand Omaxe Forest Marg Sector 93 B Noida UP 201304 have changed my name to Rajeev M N Nair.

0040856468-1

I, Meena Sharma W/o Nekpal Sharma R/o Village-Surajpur Greater Noida Distt G.B.Nagar U.P.-201306 have changed my name to Meena Devi for all future purposes.

0071037865-1

I, Madhvi Tomar W/o No. JC-797782P Rank EX RISALDAR Jaswant Singh R/O RZ-3/F UGF, Gali No-4, Kailashpuri Bus Stand, Indra Park, Palam Village, Delhi-110045 have changed my name to Madhvi Tomar vide affidavit date 23-5-26 before Delhi.

0071037821-1

I, MEENA GOEL, W/O VINOD GOYAL, R/O FLAT NO.411, STARLITE APPARTMENT, ROHINI, SECTOR-14, NORTH WEST DELHI, DELHI-110085. Have changed my name to MEENA GOYAL For all future purposes.

0071037857-1

I, MANMINDER SINGH MUDHAR, S/O NIRMAL SINGH, R/O HOUSE NO 715 SECTOR 21 HUDA SECTOR 21 INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX DUNDAHERA INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX GURGAON HARYANA 122016, have changed my name MANMINDER SINGH for all future purposes.

0071037861-1

I, MAMTA, W/O MADAN KUMAR, R/O H NO 263 STREET 13 KARKAR DOOMA EAST DELHI 110092, have changed my name MAMTA DEVI for all future purposes.

0071037863-1

I, MADAN PAL, S/O LOTI RAM, R/O H NO 263 STREET 13 MARG KARKAR DOOMA EAST DELHI 110092, have changed my name MADAN KUMAR for all future purposes.

0071037864-1

I, Lalitas Devi W/o No 2671841W Rank Ex HAV Diwan Singh R/o 2, Post Office Rawta, Deorala, Delhi-110073 have changed my name to Laltesh vide affidavit date 23-5-26 before Delhi.

0071037817-1

I, Kum. Saroj Agarwal W/o Yashwant Gupta R/o A-54/18, Jharsa Road, Narayani Hospital, Friends Colony, Gurugram-122001 have changed my name to Saroj Gupta.

0071037905-1

I, Jasbir Singh S/o Manmohan Singh, R/o B-4/2 Gali-8, South Anarkali, Krishna Nagar, Delhi-110051, alias Jasbir Singh Bhola, am one and the same person.

0071037867-1

I, JASAR KHAN, son of SAJID KHAN residing at 3296 Bazar Delhi Gate, Daryaganj, New Delhi-110002, hereby state that my name has been changed from JASIR KHAN to JASAR KHAN and henceforth I shall be known as JASAR KHAN for all purposes.

0040856466-1

I, Israr S/o Ishaq Ahmed, R/o-E-130, Jasola Village, New Friends Colony, New Delhi-110025, have changed my name to Israr Ahmad.

0040856512-3

I, HAMZA, S/O MOHD ASLAM, R/O-786, 3RD FLOOR, GALI.NO-12, SHAHZAD CHOWK ZAKIR NAGAR NEW FRIENDS-COLONY SOUTH, DELHI-110025, Changed my name to HUMZA, for all future purposes.

0040856514-8

I, Divanshu s/o Vijay Kumar, r/o H.No.438, I-Block, Karampura, New Delhi-110015, have changed my name from Divanshu to Divanshu Rathore, for all future purposes.

0040856375-2

I, DIKSHA SATIJA W/o Ratan Kumar Mahesh Rao, S1/58, UGF, Old Mahavir Nagar, Tilak Nagar, Delhi-18 have changed my name to DIKSHA CHANDRAKANT SATIJA.

0071037866-1

I, Bhaskar Pandey S/o Govind Ballabh Pandey R/o Flat 18 061 G.C. Grand, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Bhaskar Chandra Pandey for all future purposes.

0040856376-1

I, ANUJ SHARMA S/o Sushil Kumar Sharma, R/o 722, 2nd Floor, Faridabad, Behind Huda Market Sec-29, Haryana -121008, have changed my name to ANUJ DEV SHARMA for all purposes.

0040856375-3

I, MOHIT S/o-SURINDER PASRICHA, R/o16, PANDIT PARK KRISHNA NAGAR EAST DELHI-110051, have changed my name to MOHIT PASRICHA

0040856497-6

I, ANIS AHMAD S/O SAGIR AHMAD R/O J-3/A13, Khirki Exention Malviya Nagar Delhi-17 have changed my name to ANIS AHMED.

0071037895-1

I Yash S/o Sh. Surender Singh R/o H.No.283 to 286, F-4 Block, Sultan Puri, Delhi-110086 have changed my name to Yash Pal for all purposes.

0040856367-3

I Vinay Kumar Gupta S/o Late Sh. Panna Lal Gupta R/O H. No. 5/17-B, Near Police Station, Roop Nagar, Delhi-110007, hereby declare that my name has been wrongly mentioned as VINAY KUMAR in my passport records. Both names i.e. Vinay Kumar and Vinay Kumar Gupta refer to one and the same person i.e. me only.

0071037814-1

I Nikita Sharma D/o Amit Shikma W/o Rohan Nagpal R/o A-195, Derawal Nagar, Delhi-110099 have changed my name to Nikita Nagpal for all purposes.

0040856367-1

I Munni Devi W/o Ramnath Sah R/o Village Khurian, Konki, Rohtas, Takia Bazar, Bihar-821113, have changed my name to Kalpato Devi

0071037869-1

I Chunnu Singh S/o Uttam Singh R/o 2203, Y-Block Mangolpuri, Mangolpuri N Block, North West Delhi, Delhi -110083, have changed my name to Chander Bhushan

0071037859-1

I Kamla Gandhi w/o Late Sh Satish Katyal R/O 703, Mahalaxmi Apptt Sec 43, Sushant Lok I Gurgaon that my name Kamla Gandhi appears in my Aadhar and PAN and all other personal details and I,m called Kamla Gandhi for all purposes.

0040856386-



UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 438
Date extension Notice-3
Date: 25/05/2026

Due to unavoidable reasons the date of submission & opening of bid e- NIT No. 01/EE(Civil)/MB-I/TN/2026-27is being extended as below:-
Last date & Time for submission of bid on portal:- upto 17:00hrs. of 01.06.2026.
Last date & Time for submission of hard copies:- upto 15:00hrs of 03.06.2026
Date & Time Opening of bid on the portal:- At 17:00hrs. of 04.06.2026.
Other terms, conditions of bid shall remain same.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit "e-procurement portal http://uktenders.gov.in".

Executive Engineer (Civil) MB-I, Maneri

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"



JHARKHAND URBAN INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT COMPANY LIMITED
(Govt. of Jharkhand Undertaking)
JUIDCO Bhawan, Kutchery Road, Ranchi-834001, Jharkhand.
Ph No.: +91-651-2225878,
CIN: U45200JH2013SGC0001752,
e-mail Id-juidcolimited@gmail.com

Corrigendum - 2

Name of Work: Construction of Giridih Bus Stand at Giridih Nagar Nigam, Jharkhand
NIT No.: JUIDCO/NIT/BS/GIRIDIHBUSSTAND/700
Tender ID: 2026 UDD_113298_1
Ref PR No.: 378169

Sl. No.	Particulars	As per Corrigendum - 1	As per Corrigendum
7	Last Date/Time of Bid Submission	25.05.2026 at 17:00 Hrs	01.06.2026 at 17:00 Hrs
8	Date/Time of Opening of Bid	26.05.2026 at 17:00 Hrs	02.06.2026 at 17:00 Hrs

Further details available on: <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>
Sd/-
Project Director (Technical)
JUIDCO Ltd., Ranchi

PR.NO.380746 Urban Development(26-27):D



दक्षिणांचल विद्युत वितरण निगम लि०

अल्ट्कालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना (ई-निविदा)
दक्षिणांचल विद्युत वितरण निगम लि०
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, विद्युत जानपद मण्डल (वितरण) अगारा ई-निविदा सूचना

पत्राक 24०/वि०ज०म०(वि०)/आ०/टी-2 दिनांक 25.05.2026

निविदा सं० एवं कार्य का संक्षिप्त विवरण

95/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: 33/11 के०वी० विद्युत उपकेन्द्र एस०एन० हॉस्पिटल पर कन्ट्रोल रूम भवन के विस्तारीकरण एवं विद्युत नगरीय वितरण खण्ड द्वितीय के कार्यालय भवन जनपद फिरोजाबाद का जीर्णोद्धार एवं अनुक्षण सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 3540.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 16500.00

96/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: विद्युत कार्यालय भवन लेकर कॉलोनी पर विभिन्न कार्यालय भवनों की छत मरम्मत एवं अनुक्षण सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 3540.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 14000.00

97/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: 33/11 के०वी० विद्युत उपकेन्द्र आसफाबाद जनपद फिरोजाबाद परिसर में स्थापित विद्युत चोरी निरोधक थाना भवन की छत मरम्मत एवं अनुक्षण सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 3540.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 15500.00

98/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: 33/11 के०वी० विद्युत उपकेन्द्र फरिहा जनपद फिरोजाबाद पर कन्ट्रोल रूम भवन पर विस्तारीकरण, शौचालय निर्माण एवं मरम्मत सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 3540.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 15000.00

99/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: 33/11 के०वी० विद्युत उपकेन्द्र ककरऊ कोठी जनपद फिरोजाबाद पर सिस्मोटीटी फेंसिंग निर्माण कार्य एवं कार्यालय विद्युत प्रवर्तनदल फिरोजाबाद पर मरम्मत एवं अनुक्षण सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 1180.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 9000.00

1००/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: जनपद फिरोजाबाद में विद्युत भण्डार पर मरम्मत सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 1180.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 2500.00

1०1/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: 33/11 के०वी० विद्युत उपकेन्द्र माधौगंज एवं नसीपुर जनपद फिरोजाबाद पर छत एवं अन्य मरम्मत सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 1180.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 8500.00

1०2/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: 33/11 के०वी० विद्युत उपकेन्द्र आवास विकास एवं कार्यालय विद्युत वितरण खण्ड शिकोहाबाद जनपद फिरोजाबाद पर छत एवं अन्य मरम्मत सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 3540. 00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 12000.00

1०3/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: 33/11 के०वी० विद्युत उपकेन्द्र रूपसपुर जनपद फिरोजाबाद पर छत एवं मरम्मत सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 1180.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 8000.00

1०4/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: 33/11 के०वी० विद्युत उपकेन्द्र मक्कखनपुर जनपद फिरोजाबाद पर बारण्डोवाल का निर्माण कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 1180.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 10000.00

1०5/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: 33/11 के०वी० विद्युत उपकेन्द्र सराय लुकमान एवं पैगू जनपद फिरोजाबाद पर छत एवं अन्य मरम्मत सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 3540.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 11000.00

1०6/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: जनपद फिरोजाबाद में खण्डीय एवं उपखण्ड कार्यालय द्वितीय सिरसागंज पर छत एवं मरम्मत सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू० 1180.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 9000.00

1०7/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: 33/11 के०वी० विद्युत उपकेन्द्र बरनाहल पर रोड निर्माण का कार्य एवं 33/11 के०वी० विद्युत उपकेन्द्र कुचेल जनपद मैनुपुरी पर कन्ट्रोल रूम भवन एवं शौचालय का जीर्णोद्धार, रंगाई पुताई सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 3540.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 23000.00

1०8/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: 33/11 के०वी० विद्युत उपकेन्द्र बरनाहल जनपद मैनुपुरी पर बारण्डोवाल एवं फेंसिंग का निर्माण कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 3540.00 धरोहर राशि रू० 23500.00

1०9/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: 33/11 के०वी० विद्युत उपकेन्द्र करहल रोड जनपद मैनुपुरी के कन्ट्रोल रूम भवन की छत एवं 375 पुराना अस्पताल कैश काउण्टर के भवन का जीर्णोद्धार एवं अन्य मरम्मत सम्बन्धित कार्य सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 1180.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 8500.00

11०/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: 33/11 के०वी० विद्युत उपकेन्द्र शाहजहापुर एवं औख जनपद मैनुपुरी के कन्ट्रोल रूम भवन का जीर्णोद्धार एवं रंगाई पुताई से मरम्मत सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 1180.00 धरोहर राशि रू० 1०500.00

111/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: 33/11 के०वी० विद्युत उपकेन्द्र एवं उपखण्ड कार्यालय करहल जनपद मैनुपुरी पर मरम्मत से सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू० 1180.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 7000.00

112/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: 33/11 के०वी० विद्युत उपकेन्द्र सिविल लाइन द्वितीय एवं सैदपुर बघौली जनपद मैनुपुरी के कन्ट्रोल रूम भवन का जीर्णोद्धार एवं रंगाई पुताई से मरम्मत सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 3540.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 12500.00

113/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: विद्युत वितरण मण्डल एवं खण्ड जनपद मैनुपुरी पर छत एवं अन्य मरम्मत सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 3540.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 15000.00

114/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: विद्युत वितरण खण्ड तृतीय जनपद मैनुपुरी पर जीने की रेलिंग एवं 33/11 के०वी० विद्युत उपकेन्द्र पावर हाउस कॉलोनी पर दिवचयार्ड, फेंसिंग का निर्माण सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 3540.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 12500.00

115/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: थाना एण्टी पावर थैप्ट जनपद मैनुपुरी में कर्नालय का जीर्णोद्धार का कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 3540.00 धरोहर राशि रू० 11500.00

116/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: जनपद मैनुपुरी में विद्युत भण्डार केन्द्र पर विभिन्न आवश्यक मरम्मत से सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 3540.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 14000.00

117/ECC(D)Ag/2026-27-: जनपद मैनुपुरी में पावर हाउस कॉलोनी में बने विभागीय आवास संख्या (बी० एवं सी० डाइप 37 नम) की क्षतिग्रस्त छातों, फर्श एवं रंगाई पुताई से सम्बन्धित जानपदीय कार्य। प्रपत्र शुल्क रू०: 3540.00 धरोहर राशि रू०: 87000.00।

ई-निविदा की ऑनलाइन तिथि: 17.06.2026, 16:०० बजे

विस्तृत जानकारी एवं प्रपत्र वेबसाइट <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है अग्रेतर समस्त सूचनाएं वेबसाइट पर ही प्रदर्शित की जाएगी।

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Rasid Ali** S/o Fariyad Ali R/o H. No. 2654, Main Bazaar, Shadipur, Patel Nagar, Central Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 595/2022 U/s 188 IPC, PS Anand Parbat, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Rasid Ali** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rasid Ali** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Rasid Ali** in **FIR No. 595/2022 U/s 188 IPC, PS Anand Parbat, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.06.2026**.

By order
Shri Ankur Panghal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
West, Room No. 336-A
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/5322/CD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely: **Deepak, S/o. Rajveer Singh, R/o.: H.No.C-495, Gali No.10, Ashok Nagar, Mandoli Road, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR No.79/2018 Dt.09.04.2018 U/S 379/356/411/34 IPC** registered at **P.S. Jagatpuri, Shahdara District, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Deepak** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Deepak** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Deepak**, accused of Case **FIR No. 79/2018 Dt.09.04.2018 U/S 379/356/411/34 IPC** registered at **P.S. Jagatpuri, Shahdara District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.07.2026**.

By Order, Ms. Anushtha Srivastava,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05,
Room No.07, Second Floor, Shahdara District,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/6721/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Jitender, S/o Hira Lal, R/o. Plot No RZ 63A, Khasra No. 132/18, Gali No. 7, Dichaon Enclave Colony, Najafgarh, New Delhi-110043**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Ct. Cases/382/2021**, registered at **P.S.: Baba Hari Dass Nagar, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Jitender**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Jitender**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Jitender, Ct. Cases/382/2021**, registered at **P.S.: Baba Hari Dass Nagar, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Harleen Singh
Additional District and Sessions Judge,
Special Court-Electricity(South West),
Court No. 609, Dwarka Courts, Delhi

DP/6400/DW/2026
(Court Matter)

HARYANA STATE WAREHOUSING CORPORATION
BAY NO. 15-18, SECTOR 2, PANCHKULA (HARYANA)
OFFERS E-AUCTION OF AGRI-COMMODITIES: BRL Rice
E-Auction Notice

The Haryana State Warehousing Corporation intends to e-auction of FRK (Fortified Rice Kernel) Rice KMS-2022-23 BRL (Beyond Rejection Limit) stored in State Warehouses on "as is where is" basis at locations across Haryana mentioned below:

Sr. No.	Name of the District	Name of the Warehouse	Quantity
		Bags	Weight (in qtl)
1	Karnal	Sugarfed godown Karnal.	3489 1722.9638
2	Palwal	SWH-Palwal-1	20880 10095.396

Interested parties are requested to see the detailed terms & conditions/instructions to participate in bid for one or more locations by visiting the Star Agri (Agribazaar) Portal URL (<https://www.agribazaar.com>). **The e-Auction will commence on daily basis during the m/o May, 2026 as per following schedule:**

BRL Rice	28.05.2026 to 05.06.2026
	10:00 to11:00 AM 12:00 Noon to 01:00 PM 02:00 to 03:00 PM 04:00-05:00 PM

Haryana State Warehousing Corporation reserves the right to accept /reject/increase/decrease/alter the auction date & quantity without assigning any reason/notice.

For any query:-
Whatsapp Link: <https://wa.me/+918360417650>,
<https://t.me/m/yb/vf/KSufOGQ9>
Whatsapp QR Code:

For any query:-
Telegram Link:
Telegram QR Code:

No.- 45556/HRY

GOVT. OF JHARKHAND
CABINET SECRETARIAT AND VIGILANCE DEPARTMENT (CIVIL AVIATION DIVISION)
STATE HANGAR, BIRSA MUNDA AIRPORT ROAD, HINOO, RANCHI-834002
Email: dir_ops@jharkhandaviation.in; govtflyops@gmail.com
Telefax: 0651-2250319, 2251090
e-Tender Ref N o.: XI/Special Tools/01/2026-ना०वि०/३7०, / Ranchi /Dated:21.05.2026

e-TENDER NOTICE
Offers under **TWO BID SYSTEM** are hereby invited by Civil Aviation Division (CAD), Govt. of Jharkhand from OEM/OEM Authorized Representative /OEM Authorized Vendor / Agency involved in the aircraft spare parts supply business for procurement and supply of Aircraft Special Tools/Equipment, spares etc. on requirement basis for the type of Aircraft in use according to selected quoted price (No consortium bid will be entertained).

1. Bidder has to deposit Rs. 1,00,000/- (One Lakh Rupees) EMD through online mode. Other terms and conditions and technical parameters are specified in the Detailed Tender Document.
2. Tender Document can be downloaded from the website www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in. The bidders have to submit their bids online through e-tendering mode only at www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in.
3. Last date and time of submission of bid online at www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in will be as per the Schedule of Events mentioned in the Tender Document.
a) e-Tenders will be opened in the office chamber of The Director (Ops), CAD, State Hangar, B M Airport, Hinoo, Ranchi by a committee duly constituted by CAD. If intervened by a holiday, bids will be received /opened at the same time on next working day.
b) The Technical Bids shall be opened first for scrutiny of the bid documents and technical data etc. The schedule of events for different activities is given below:

Scheduled of Events			Date
Detail of Events			
1.	Publish of Tender on website & Start of Downloading Tender Documents		21/05/2026, 06:00 P.M.
2.	Pre Bid Meeting		25/05/2026, 04:00 P.M.
3.	Start of Submission of e-bids		26/05/2026, 04:00 P.M.
4.	Last date for submission of e-bids.		06/06/2026, 04:00 P.M.
5.	Opening of Technical Bids.		08/06/2026, 04:00 P.M.
6.	Opening of Financial Bids.	After scrutiny of the Technical Bid	
7.	Award of agreement	Shall be notified later.	

NOTE: If Technical Bid of any bidder is found incomplete, not supported by requisite EMD and /or required documents or deficient of any technical parameters as specified in the Detailed Tender Document, their Financial Bid shall not be opened.
4. Bidders are requested to check www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in on a regular basis for updates.
5. CAD, Govt. of Jharkhand reserves the right to cancel or modify any of the above conditions or cancel any or all tender terms without assigning any reason.

Sd/-
Capt. S. P. Sinha
Director (Ops) Civil Aviation Division

PR 380664 Civil Aviation(26-27):D

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Amrit Pal Singh** through its proprietor **M/s Ikara Freight Carries** At Plot No. CW/250, Sanjay Gandhi Transport Nagar, Delhi-110042 also at No. 302, Vijay Court, 1-2-593/4/9, Second Floor, Domalguda, Opp. Ramchandra Mission, Hyderabad-500029 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **Ct. No. 1) 5028/2019, 2) 5029/2019, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Model Town, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Amrit Pal Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Amrit Pal Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Amrit Pal Singh** accused of **Ct. No. 1) 5028/2019, 2) 5029/2019, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Model Town, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.07.2026**.

By Order - Sh. Himanshu Sehloth
Judicial Magistrate First Class, North
Room No. 213, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/6709/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Rahul S/o Shiv Chauhan R/o 778, Scooter Market, Jheel, Geeta Colony, Delhi** No. of accused person Market, Jheel, Geeta Colony, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 166/2023, U/s 380/457/411/34 IPC, Date 13.03.2023, PS Jagatpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Rahul** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Rahul** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Rahul** of case **FIR No. 166/2023, U/s 380/457/411/34 IPC, Date 13.03.2023, PS Jagatpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **25.06.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Anushtha Srivastava
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Room No. 7, 2nd Floor, Shahdara Dist.
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/6662/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Faisal** S/o Mohd. Gaffar R/o H. No. C-216, Gali No. 08, Chauhan Banger, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 659/2022 U/s 380/411 IPC, PS Jafrabad, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Faisal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Faisal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Faisal** in **FIR No. 659/2022 U/s 380/411 IPC, PS Jafrabad, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.06.2026**.

By order
Ms. Anushtha Srivastava LD
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Room No. 07
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/5910/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rinku Ray, S/o: Keshari Ray, R/o: Shankar Dharam Kanta Wali Gali, Mahavir Colony, Village Bhorgarh, Delhi**, Also at: **Village Panariya, PS Dawat, District Rohtash, Bihar** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 203/2019, Date: 15.04.2019, U/s: 33 Delhi Excise Act, Police Station Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rinku Ray** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rinku Ray** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rinku Ray** of **Police Station Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Jyoti Nain
JMFC-07, North, 1st Floor, Room No. 06,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/6699/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Deepanshu S/o Narendar, R/o: H.No. 70, Gali No. 4, A-Block, Baba Colony, Burari, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 167/26, Dt. 04.03.26, U/S: 103(1)/109(1)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Burari, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Deepanshu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Deepanshu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Deepanshu** of **FIR No. 167/26, Dt. 04.03.26, U/S: 103(1)/109(1)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Burari, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Payal Singal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-09
Central District Room No. 286
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/6590/N/2026
(Court Matter)

Office of the Nagar Panchayat Hariharganj
Short E-Procurement Notice
NIT No:- NPH-NIT-02/2026-27

Sr. No.	Particulars	Details
1	Name of Work	Construction & Commissioning of Fecal Sludge Treatment Plant of Capacity 10 KLD at Hariharganj town (Jharkhand) followed by Operation and Maintenance including desludging operations for 5 years
2	Estimated Cost (INR)	Construction Cost: ₹ 2,46,28,185.20 Operation & Maintenance Cost: ₹ 1,05,44,700.71 Total: ₹ 3,51,72,885.91
3	Bid Security (INR)	₹ 3,52,000/- (Rupees Three Lakhs fifty Thousand Only)
4	Cost of Bid Document (INR)	₹ 10,000/- (Rupees Ten Thousand Only); non-refundable
5	Time of Completion	1 year of construction which comprises 9 months of construction and 3 months of defect liability period Including one month of trial run and 5 years of O&M post DLP
6	Date of e-publication of tender	27-05-2026
7	Document downloading start Date	02-06-2026
8	Bid submission end date	17-06-2026
9	Last day for the submission of Bid Security, cost of bid document	17-06-2026
10	Bid opening date (online)	19-06-2026
11	Mode of Submission of Bids	e-tendering (https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
12	Name & Address of office inviting Tender	Executive Officer, Nagar Panchayat Hariharganj
13	Helpline Number	8574103378

Note: Only e-Tender will be accepted
Complete bid document is available on website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>
PR 380658 (District)26-27*D
कार्यपालक पदाधिकारी
नगर पंचायत हरिहरगंज



GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA



TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP/ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP/ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS(EMAIL)
1	MICADA, JHAJAR	RD 4000-R SIWANA MAJRA MINOR EXTENSION OF WATER COURSE + 3 WORKS	20.05.2026 01.06.2026	Rs. 20,97,964/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9899000779 anjubijarcal@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No.- 45563/HRY



Uttarakhand Power Corporation Ltd.
Executive Engineer, Electricity Distribution Division (South)
18 EC Road, Dehradun

Letter no: 723/ Lekha
Date: 25/05/2026

TENDER NOTICE

Executive Engineer, EDD(South), Uttarahand Power Corporation Ltd. Dehradun invites tender for following work, as detailed below: -

Sl. No	Name of the work	Tender Specification No.	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Cost of tender document including GST (in Rs.)	Last Date of Sale of tender document	Last Date of submission of Tender	Date of opening of Part-1 of tender
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	R & R Work of T/F under EDD (South) Dehradun	08/EDD(S) /2026-27	40500.00	1180.00 (including GST)	08.06.2026 upto 14.00 hrs	09.06.2026 upto 14.00 hrs	09.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs
2	Preventing Maintenance of Existing T/F of various capacity under EDSO Turner Road under EDD(South), Dehradun	09/EDD(S) /2026-27	45000.00	1180.00 (including GST)	08.06.2026 upto 14.00 hrs	09.06.2026 upto 14.00 hrs	09.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs
3	Preventing Maintenance of Existing T/F of various capacity under EDSO vasant Vihar/Bhandari Bagh/ Niranjanpur under EDD (South), Dehradun	10/EDD(S) /2026-27	45000.00	1180.00 (including GST)	08.06.2026 upto 14.00 hrs	09.06.2026 upto 14.00 hrs	09.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs

THE PRE-QUALIFYING REQUIREMENTS ARE AS UNDER: -
1. The Bidder must be registered with Electrical Inspector in 'A' class category, for electrical works/Suppliers, GST, EPF, ESI Department.
2- The Bidder must have successfully executed the similar work as an agreement with UPCL.
3- Income tax return (Latest filed) of the bidder must be attached.
4- An undertaking on Rs 100/-non-judicial stamp paper duly notarized by that the bidder has not been blacklisted/debarred by any Govt undertaking/Govt. Departments/SEB's/ Power Sector Utilities in last three years. In case same is found then their tender/ order shall be treated as cancelled at any stage and EMD/Performance security shall be forfeited.
5- Bidder must have validity of offer for 180 days from the date of opening of tender on 100/- stamp paper along with Rs 1/- revenue stamp (as per sheet enclosed).
6- Completion Period: - Completion period shall be as per terms &



समाहरणालय, गया
(खनन शाखा)

गया जिलान्तर्गत भण्डारित बालू की नीलामी हेतु अल्पकालीन आम सूचना

एतद् द्वारा सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि PR No.-003765 (Mines & Geo.) 2025-26 एवं PR No.-021535 (District) 2025-26 से गया जिलान्तर्गत भण्डारित जप्त बालू की नीलामी हेतु प्रकाशित अल्पकालीन आम सूचना में शून्य निविदा प्राप्त निम्नांकित भण्डारण स्थल पर भण्डारित जप्त बालू की नीलामी / बिक्री दिनांक-15.06.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे से समाहरणालय, गया स्थित समानगर में खुले ढाक के माध्यम से निर्धारित शर्तों के अधीन किया जाएगा। अपरिहार्य कारण से यदि निर्धारित तिथि को नीलामी नहीं होती है, तो वैसी स्थिति में अगले कार्य दिवस दिनांक-16.06.2026 को खुली नीलामी करायी जाएगी। इसके लिए सुयोग्य व्यक्ति / फर्म / कम्पनी से निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

भण्डारित जप्त बालू के स्थल एवं मात्रा की विवरणी							
क्र०	अनुमंडल का नाम	अंचल	जप्त बालू का स्थल	भू-निर्देशांक (Geo Co-ordinates)	बालू की मात्रा (घनफीट में)	सुरक्षित जमा राशि (₹० में)	अग्रघन राशि (सुरक्षित जमा राशि का 25 प्रतिशत)
1	टिकारी	टिकारी	मौजा- मंडार	Lat.-25.043199N Long.-84.873054E	15,000 घनफीट	2,54,850 /-	63,713 /-
2	शेरघाटी	होमी	मौजा- कोठवाहा	Lat.-24.499843N Long.-84.873722E	3,00,000 घनफीट	50,97,000 /-	12,74,250 /-
3	शेरघाटी	भोरघाटी	मौजा- मंझनपुर	Lat.-24.599245N Long.-84.822801E	50,000 घनफीट	8,49,500 /-	2,12,375 /-
4	शेरघाटी	आमस	मौजा- बाजीतपुर	Lat.-24.566581N Long.-84.775901E	8,000 घनफीट	1,35,920 /-	33,980 /-

अतः सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि नीलामी में भाग लेने हेतु इच्छुक व्यक्ति / फर्म / कम्पनी निविदा दस्तावेज एवं निविदा प्रपत्र से संबंधित जानकारी गया जिला के वेबसाइट gaya.nic.in से प्राप्त कर सकते हैं।

खुले ढाक के माध्यम से नीलामी कार्यक्रम-			
गया जिला के वेबसाइट gaya.nic.in से निविदा दस्तावेज डाउनलोड प्रारंभ करने की तिथि	जिला खनन कार्यालय, गया में अग्रघन राशि एवं निविदा दस्तावेज जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	तकनीकी निविदा की जाँच / मूल्यांकन कर योग्य / सफल निविदादाताओं की सूची जिला खनन कार्यालय, गया के सूचना-पट्ट पर प्रकाशित करने की अंतिम तिथि	खुले ढाक के माध्यम से नीलामी की तिथि, समय एवं स्थान
25.05.2026	09.06.2026 अपराह्न 05:00 बजे तक	12.06.2026	15.06.2026 पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे से समाहरणालय, गया स्थित समावृद्ध

नीलामी से संबंधित किसी भी प्रकार की आपत्ति अथवा CLARIFICATION के लिए जिला खनन कार्यालय, गया (मौ०-9122408906) से सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।

नीलामी की विस्तृत जानकारी state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

PR- 004249 (Mines) 2026-27

समाहर्ता, गया

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।



न्यायालय अनुमण्डल दण्डाधिकारी, बक्सर

में मद्य निषेध अधिनियम, 2016 के अन्तर्गत संचालित राज्यसात वाद में संबंधित वाहन को अंतिम रूप से न्यायालय में उपस्थित होने के संबंध में।

अल्पकालीन आम सूचना

चूं बजरीसे न्यायालय नोटिस द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि बिहार मद्य निषेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम, 2016 की धारा 56 (घ) के अन्तर्गत अवैध रूप से देशी / विदेशी शराब का परिवहन करने के आरोप में निम्नलिखित वाहन विभिन्न थाना काण्डों में जप्त कर अधिहरण-प्रस्ताव, पुलिस अधीक्षक, बक्सर / अधीक्षक उत्पाद, बक्सर के माध्यम से प्राप्त होने के फलस्वरूप, निषिद्ध उत्पाद अधिहरण वाद प्रारम्भ किया गया है। नोटिस किए जाने के बावजूद / नोटिस वापस होने के फलस्वरूप इन वाहन के लिए कोई दायित्वारी / अपना पक्ष प्रस्तुत नहीं किया जा रहा है। इस आधार पर उक्त जप्त वाहन अधिहरण करने योग्य हैं।

नव संशोधित नियमावली, 2023 के नियम 12 (क) (2) में निहित उपबंधों के आधार पर नवीनतम बीमाकृत मूल्य / विभागीय प्रावधान के आलोक में अनुमण्डल दण्डाधिकारी द्वारा निर्धारित किये जाने वाले शাস्रि (Penalty) की राशि जमा कर वाहन मुक्त कराना चाहते हो, तो 15 दिनों के अन्दर प्रपत्र-IV में अपना आवेदन पत्र अधोहस्ताक्षरी के न्यायालय में समर्पित करें। वाहनों की विवरणी निम्नवत है:-

अक्र	राज्यसात वाद संक्र	थाना काण्ड संक्र	जप्त वाहन का प्रकार	जप्त वाहन का विवरण संक्र का निरूपण	परिवहन कार्यालय से प्राप्त सूचना के अनुसार गाड़ी मालिक का नाम व पता	मुमर्दाई की अंगाली तिथि
(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)
01	17/2025/25/20 25	इटाही थाना काण्ड संक्र-99 / 20 24	TVS अपची मोटरसाईकिल	निबन्धन संक्र-DL-35CN-3886	रोहित कुमार पिता-भी श्रमंत पासवान ग्राम-बकसाड़ा,थाना -इटाही, जिला-बक्सर।	05.06.2026
02	55/2025/235/2 025	बक्सर उत्पाद काण्ड संक्र-130 / 2025	टाटा कन्टेनर ट्रक	निबन्धन संक्र-DL-1MA-5897 (Fake) निबन्धन संख्या-DL-1MA-6335 (Original)	अमित कुमार, पिता-बहारी लाल पता-B-132 Hind Vihar Prem Nagar-3 Kirai, Suleman Nahar, North West Delhi 110086	05.06.2026

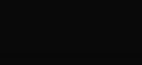
एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि यदि कॉलम 05 में अंकित जप्त वाहन में से कॉलम 06 में अंकित वाहन स्वामी अथवा अन्य किसी व्यक्ति / संस्था का हित निहित हो तो उक्त कॉलम 07 में वर्णित निर्धारित तिथि को स्वयं या वकालतन, अनुमण्डल दण्डाधिकारी बक्सर के न्यायालय, में उपस्थित होकर अपने-अपने वाहन के मालिकाना हक से संबंधित दावा / पक्ष व कागजात प्रस्तुत करें। अनुपस्थित होने की स्थिति में यह समझा जायेगा कि उक्त गाड़ी से आपको कोई सरोकार नहीं है। तत्पश्चात उक्त जप्त वाहन को सुनवाई उपरान्त बिहार मद्य निषेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम, 2016 की धारा-58 (2) के अन्तर्गत राज्यहित में अधिहरण कर लिया जायेगा। इसे संरक्ष ताकीद समझें।

अनुमण्डल दण्डाधिकारी
बक्सर सदर

PR- 004092 (District) 2026-27

उक्त सूचना state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।



Govt. of Bihar

Name of the District ULB HQ Ara Nagar Nigam
Address: Near old Police, Line
Phone No: 06182-241025
Email: mucommissionerara@gmail.com

RFP for Selection of an Agency for the Implementation of Animal Birth Control (ABC) Program in Bhojpur District of Bihar

SECTION - I: NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

1. Ara Nagar nigam, Bhojpur, Bihar invites proposals from eligible firms for "Selection of an Agency for the Implementation of Animal Birth Control (ABC) Program in Bhojpur District of Bihar".

2. Interested Consultancy Firms may download the complete Request for Proposals (RFP) Document, from website: <https://state.bihar.gov.in/urban>

PARTICULARS	
1	Website for submission of bid/proposal
2	Mode of Submission
3	Last date and time for Submission of hard copies of Technical Bid/proposal along with financial bid/proposal in separate sealed envelopes inside one envelop.
4	Date and time of Pre bid meeting
5	Submission of bids through eproc portal
6	Date and time of opening of Technical Bids
7	Date and time of opening of Financial Bids
8	Method of Selection
3.	Agencies/ Firms may download the complete Request for Proposal (RFP) Document, from website: https://state.bihar.gov.in/urban
This information is available on www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar also	
PR. No. 004148 (B&C) 2026-27	
बिहार में शराब का व्यापार, बिक्री एवं सेवन अवैध है। इससे संबंधित शिकायत इस नंबर पर दर्ज कराया, आपकी जानकारी गुप्त रखी जाएगी। टॉल फ्री नं- 15545 या 1800 345 6268	



GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER,
CENTRAL RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BHUBANESWAR

2500/1243/2627
No. 2689
"e" Procurement Notice for Road Works
Date:15.05.2026

1	Name of the Work	: Road Works under Mukhya Mantri Sadak Yojana (MMSY)
2	Total No. of works	: 10 Nos. of Road works for the year 2026-27
3	Estimated Cost of the work	: Varies from Rs.303.97 lakh to Rs.682.20 lakh
4	Class of Contractor	: B Class (of Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authorities
	a) Estimated cost more than Rs. 20.00 lakh up to Rs. 3.00 Crores.	: A Class (of Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authorities
	b) Estimated cost more than Rs. 1.00 Crore up to Rs. 20.00 Crores.	: Special Class (of Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authorities
	c) Estimated cost more than Rs. 6.00 Crore up to Rs. 50.00 Crores.	: Super Class (of Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authorities
	d) Estimated cost more than Rs. 20.00 Crores	: As mentioned in Column-7 of Annexure
5	Period of completion	: Offered rates by bidder
6	Offered rates by bidder	: The offered rate by the contractor shall be excluding GST.
7	Other details	:

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender online for bidding	Date & Time of opening of tender		
1	2	3	4	5	6
Chief Construction Engineer, Central Rural Works Circle, Bhubaneswar	Tender-Online-C.C.09 of 2026	01.06.2025 at 11.00 A.M.	18.06.2025 up to 5.00 P.M.	19.06.2025 at 11.00 A.M.	To be intimated later on

Further details can be seen from the web site www.tendersodisha.gov.in

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Central Rural Works Circle, Bhubaneswar

OIPR- 25001/25082/1/26-27/0008



जल संसाधन विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
बाद नियंत्रण प्रमंडल, कादागोला
पत्रांक- 1054 कादागोला दिनांक :- 21.05.2026
अल्पकालीन राष्ट्रीय स्पर्धा निविदा आमंत्रण
अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या 02/ 2026-27
(केवल ई-टेंडर पद्धति के अनुसार (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in))

1. कार्य का विवरण :-

क्र. सं	कार्य का नाम	प्राप्तकालित राशि (लाख ₹० में)	अग्रघन की राशि (₹० में)	परिमाण-विषय का मूल्य (केवल ऑनलाईन मोड में मुद्रित) (₹० में)	बेट्टिंग को देव "बिड प्रोसेसिंग की" (अप्रत्यर्णणीय) (केवल ऑनलाईन मोड में मुद्रित) (₹० में)	कार्य समाप्ति की तिथि
1	बाद नियंत्रण प्रमंडल, कादागोला अन्तर्गत विभिन्न तटको एवं सरो पर जमल सफाई कार्य।	30.00000	60000.00	5000.00	590.00	2.5 माह

2. निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्गत करने की तिथि :- दिनांक- 21.05.2026

3. निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की अवधि :- दिनांक 29.05.2026 से दिनांक 03.06.2026 के 3.00 बजे अपराह्न तक (सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)

4. प्री-बीड मीटिंग का समय, स्थान एवं तिथि :- दिनांक 01.06.2026 के 3.00 बजे अपराह्न में, मुख्य अभियंता बाद नियंत्रण एवं जल निस्सरण, जल संसाधन विभाग, कटिहार (कैम्प पूर्णिया) के कार्यालय कम में

5. तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :- दिनांक 05.06.2026 समय 3.30 बजे अपराह्न। (सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)

6. वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :- सक्षम पदाधिकारी द्वारा बाद में घोषित की जायेगी (सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)

7. निविदा खोलने का स्थान :- www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर

8. निविदा की केषता अवधि :- 120 दिन

9. विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता :- कार्यपालक अभियंता, बाद नियंत्रण प्रमण्डल, कादागोला मौ० नं० 7463889260

विशेष जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in एवं www.wrd.bih.nic.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
बाद नियंत्रण प्रमंडल, कादागोला
मौ०नं०- 7463889260

PR. No. 004082 (WRD) 2026-27

उक्त सूचना www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

सुरक्षित जीवन अपनाओ, अपनी नियमित एच.आई.वी. जाँच कराओ।



Govt. of Bihar

OFFICE OF THE RESIDENT ENGINEER
BUILDING DIVISION, BIHAR BHAWAN, NEW DELHI
E.O.I No. 01/2026-27
Website www.eproc.bihar.gov.in

E- Quotation in two bid system (Technical and Price bid) is invited from experienced firms/Any Contractor Registered with Central Government/ Any State Government/Any Public Sector unit Undertaking or an Agency of National or International repute for the work of Comprehensive Housekeeping, Maintenance and Operation (for 5 years) of Bihar Sadan, Dwarka, New Delhi.

1. Designation and Address of Advertiser : R.E, Building Division, Bihar Bhawan, New Delhi.

2. Date of Inviting Quotation : 22.05.2026

3. Last date and time of Sale (Download) of B.O.Q : From 06.06.2026 to 30.06.2026, 15:00 HOURS

4. Last date and time of Submission (upload) of Quotation : 01.07.2026, 15:00 HOURS

5. Date of Time of opening of Quotation (Technical Bid) : 02.07.2026, 15:30 HOURS

6. Date and time of opening of financial bid : After decision of Technical bid

7. Date, Time & Place of Pre-Bid meeting : (i) 12.06.2026 15:00 Hours at CE (Patna) Office, BCD, Vishweswaraiya Bhawan, Patna, (ii) 16.06.2026, 15:00 Hours at Bihar Bhawan 05 Kautiliya Marg, Chanakyapuri, New Delhi.

8. Period of BID Validity : 120 days

9. Post of tender Sanction officer : Competent Authority

10. Place of Sale of tender document : only on website www.eproc.bihar.gov.in

11. Place of Receive of tender : only on website www.eproc.bihar.gov.in

12. Details of Work

Sl No.	Name of work	Estimated cost (In Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs)	Cost of BOQ (in Rs)	Bid Processing Fee (Non Refundable)(Rs.)	Time of completion of work
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	Comprehensive Housekeeping, Maintenance and operation Contract (for 5 years) of Bihar Sadan, Dwarka, New Delhi 2026-31	8,17,71,796/-	16,35,500/-	10,000/-	As Per eproc2	5 year (will be renewed every year after Satisfactory performance, with an annual increment @ 5 % every year

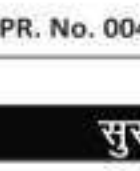
Other information can be obtained and downloaded from website www.bcd.bih.nic.in/prdbihar.gov.in/www.eproc.bihar.gov.in

PR. No. 004125 (BCD) 2026-27

Resident Engineer
Building Division, Bihar Bhawan, New Delhi.

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

सुरक्षित जीवन अपनाओ, अपनी नियमित एच.आई.वी. जाँच कराओ।



Govt. of Bihar

Bihar Urban Infrastructure Development Corporation Limited
A Government of Bihar Undertaking

NOTICE INVITING Re-TENDER
(Through e-procurement mode only- www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
NIT.No- BUIDCo/Yo-3399/25-39

1. Bihar Urban Infrastructure Development Corporation Limited (BUIDCo) invites bids from eligible experienced Firms/Contractors/Agencies.

Name of Work	Estimated Cost	Bid Document cost	Bid Security (EMD) in Lakh.	Time for completion	Bid Processing Fee
Construction of PCC Road and Drain from Shitla Sthan Chowk to Aliganj via Mirjanhat Bagbari under Bhagalpur Nagar Nigam Area.	Rs. 5,13,88,003.00	Rs. 23,600.00	Rs. 10.28	09 Months	As per eproc2

2. Date of Downloading of Bid Document : From 29.05.2026 to 07.06.2026 up to 05:00 P.M. Through website : www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in.

3. Place & Date of pre-bid meeting : Date:-01.06.2026, Time 03.00 P.M.; BUIDCo Office, West Boring Canal Road (RajapurPul) Patna, Bihar, India, PIN -800 001 Query may be send only on e-mail id- pdbhqbuidco@gmail.com up to date 01.06.2026, Time 05.00 P.M. No Query will be entertained after the last date time of submission of queries & other than the given e-mail.

4. Last Date and time for uploading of bid. : Date:-07.06.2026 up to 05.00 P.M. Through website : www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in.

5. Last Date and time for submission of hard copy of EMD : Date:- 08.06.2026, Time 03.00 P.M

6. Time & Date of opening technical bids : Date:-08.06.2026, Time 03.30 P.M

7. Time & date of opening financial bids : To be communicated later on.

8. Place of opening of Bid : Through website : www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in.

9. Periods of bids validity : 120 Days.

10. Officer inviting bids : Chief General Manager, South Bihar, BUIDCo.

Chief General Manager
South Bihar, BUIDCo.

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

PR. No.004112 (B&C) 2026-27

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।



EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

The Divisional Railway Manager (Engg./ E.C. Railway/Samastipur for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open Tender from experienced and financially capable tenderers for the following works in e-Tendering mode of IREPS web portal of Indian Railways :-

Sl. No.: 1, Tender Notice No: TC-48-2026-SPJ, Name of Work: Cess Repair of Raxaul (RXL)- Narkatiyaganj (NKE) Total - 7.35 Tkm, Tender Value (in Rs.) : 18594277.30, Earnest Money (in Rs.): 371900.00, Completion period of the work: 06 Months

Sl. No.: 2, Tender Notice No: TC-49-2026-SPJ, Name of Work: Cess Repair of Sitamarhi (SMI)- Raxaul (RXL) Total - 9.30 Tkm, Tender Value (in Rs.) : 23527452.91, Earnest Money (in Rs.) : 470600.00, Completion period of the work: 06 Months

Sl. No.: 3, Tender Notice No: TC-50-2026-SPJ, Name of Work: Special repairs to Type- IV and Type-V Bungalow in Officer's Colony and Gandhi- Park Colony under the jurisdiction of SSE/W/SPJ, Tender Value (in Rs.) : 10551045.45, Earnest Money (in Rs.) : 211000.00, Completion period of the work: 09 Months

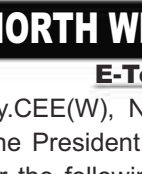
Sl. No.: 4, Tender Notice No: TC-51-2026-SPJ, Name of Work: Special repairs of ORH at Sitamarhi, Changing of leaky shed of Escalator at Darbhanga under the jurisdiction of ADEN-UDBG, Tender Value (in Rs.) : 8055589.94, Earnest Money (in Rs.): 161100.00, Completion period of the work: 04 Months

1. Last Date & time for receiving of Tender in E-Tender mode on IREPS web portal: 15.06.2026 upto 12.00 hrs.

2. Opening Date & time for E-Tender: 15.06.2026 after 12.00 hours.

3. Website particulars where complete details of tender & tender document can be seen on Website:www.ireps.gov.in. Amendments / modifications if any shall not be published in the newspapers but the same shall be uploaded in the website.

Sr. Divisional Engineer / Co-ord E.C. Railway/Samastipur
PR/0282/SPJ/ENG/TT-26-27/64



NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice

Dy.CEE(W), NWR, Ajmer on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tender for the following work up to 15.00 Hrs. on the mention date. **Tender No.: EL/50/25/2025-26RT. Name of work: Repair, Servicing and overhauling of Cummins make Diesel Alternator Set 500KVA, 750V in Power Cars during POH at carriage workshop Ajmer.**

Approximate cost: Rs. 270476613.19/-

Earnest money: Rs. 549500/-

& Time of closing of E-Tender: 05.06.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. एवं Date & Time of opening of E-Tender: 05.06.2026 at 15.30 Hrs. The details of above E-Tender is available on website www.ireps.gov.in.

772-MG/26

Follow us on:              



WESTERN RAILWAY

PROVISION OF LIFTS

Sr.DEE/P/BCT invites E-Tender Notice No. EL-166-160-WA-84 (R-1) dt-21-05-2026 (Two Packet System). Work and Location: Mumbai Division (Non Suburban Section):-Provision of Lifts (27 Nos) on Foot Over Bridges of stations (Composite tender for Electrical and Civil work). **Approx. Cost of Work: ₹ 17,09,47,471.81. EMD: ₹ 34,19,000/-.** **Date & Time of Submission:** Till 16.06.2026, 15:00 hrs. **Date & Time of Opening:** On 16.06.2026 at 15:30 hrs. For further details please visit our website www.ireps.gov.in

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CPSIDA

उपग्रह राज्य औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
रोहतास सिटी, गाँजियाबाद। E-Mail- cd3@cpsida.co.in

अल्पकालीन/पूर्वकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना

एतद्द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि विभिन्न औद्योगिक क्षेत्रों के अल्पकालीन विकास / अनुसंधान कार्य हेतु सरकार विभाग / सार्वजनिक उपक्रम / निगमों / प्राधिकरण / परिवहन / नगर निकायों में पंजीकृत फर्म / ठेकेदारों से ई-निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है, जिसको अपलोड करने की समयसीमा निम्नवत् है:-

क्रमांक 01 की निविदा दिनांक 26.05.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे से दिनांक 02.06.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक अपलोड की जा सकती है, जिसे दिनांक 02.06.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे खोला जायेगा (अल्पकालीन) तथा क्रमांक 02 एवं 03 की निविदा दिनांक 26.05.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे से दिनांक 15.06.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक अपलोड की जा सकती है, जिसे दिनांक 16.06.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे खोला जायेगा (पूर्वकालीन)। निविदादाताओं द्वारा केवल शपथपत्रों की मूल प्रतियाँ निविदा प्रपत्रों में उल्लिखित दिनांक तक कार्यालय में जमा की जा सकतीं। ई-निविदा के माध्यम से आमंत्रित की जाने वाली निविदाओं का विवरण निम्नवत् है:-

क्र.सं.	कार्य का नाम	सर्वसाधारण दर
1.	Maintenance Work for One Year at I.A. Baghapat Distt-Baghapat.	Rs. 27.31
2.	Annual Maintenance of Administrative Building in Sector B-3 of I.A. Trans Delhi Signature City, Ghaziabad.	Rs. 07.15
3.	Dewatering Work at I.A. Trans Delhi Signature City, Ghaziabad.	Rs. 06.19

नोट:- निविदादाता अपने निविदापत्रों में समस्त कर सहित दरें अंकित करें। जी०एच०टी० अलग से देय होगा। निविदा सम्बन्धी विस्तृत जानकारी प्राधिकरण की website: www.onlineupsida.com पर क्लिक ई-निविदा एवं पूर्वाह्न की वेबसाइट <http://tenderup.nic.in> पर देखी जा सकती है। अन्य जानकारी हेतु कार्यालय के प्रबंधक (निविदा) के संचालन नं०-920569/1284 पर सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।

संचालक (निविदा): उपग्रह राज्य औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण



बिहार सरकार

कार्यालय, आरा नगर निगम आरा
Invitation for Bids
Tender

invites online proposals for Bio-Remediation / Bio-Mining of Legacy Wastes Sites Utilizing Various Methodologies/Technology in NAGAR NIGAM ARA , BHOJPUR
NIT No. 03/2026-27

Name of the Work	Bio-Remediation / Bio-Mining of Legacy Wastes Sites Utilizing Various Methodologies /Technology in NAGAR NIGAM ARA , BHOJPUR
Estimated Project Cost (Rs)	9,31,74,287.00
Bid Security/EMD (2 %)	Rs. 18,63,486.00
Cost of Bid Document	Rs. 10,000.00
Start of Bid /Downloading of RFP Document:	From 13-06-2026 (11.00 AM) www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in .
Last Date of Online Bid Submission	30-06-2026 Till 5.00 PM.
Period during which hard copies of documents shall be physically submitted.	01-07-2025 Till 5.00 PM at NAGAR NIGAM ARA , BHOJPUR
Time & date of online opening of documents. (Mandatory documents) Technical bid	03-07-2026 at 02.00 PM at NAGAR NIGAM ARA , BHOJPUR
Periods of Bids Validity	180 Days

Head - 15th Finance Commission

The bid forms and other details can be seen &

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM
 Corrigendum Notice No.W.584/E-
 Tendering/30-DHN-2026-27 Dhanbad,
 dt. 22.05.2026.
 It is further to notify that, in the E-Tender
 No. 30-DHN-2026-27 dtd. 30.04.2026 is
 hereby **Canceled** due to administrative
 reason.
 Divisional Railway Manager (Engg.)/
 ECR/Dhanbad
 PR/0299/DHN/Engg./C/26-27/16

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

No. DNR/S&T/Sig/2026/6 Danapur,
dtd. 21.05.2026

Divisional Railway Manager (Signal & Telecom), East Central Railway, Danapur Division, for and on behalf of President of India invites tenders on web portal www.reps.gov.in for the following work:-

1. Name of work with its location: Provision of RDSO approved make aspiration type fire alarm system for replacing Non-RDSO Fire alarm system at 34 station under Danapur Division.

2. Approximate cost of work: Rs. 30,43,71,04.00.

3. Earnest Money: Rs. 608800.00.

4. Last Date & Time of Submission: Up to 15.00 hrs. on 15.06.2026.

5. Opening of tender: 15.00 hrs. on 15.06.2026.

6. Website Particulars where detail of the work and criteria can be seen: www.reps.gov.in.

7. Address of the office from where detail information can be obtained: Sr. Divl. Signal & Telecommunication Engineer, East Central Railway, Danapur

Note: Any Corrigendum if required will be uploaded on above website before 14 days.

Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer
East Central Railway, Danapur

PR/026/DNR/S&T/Sig/21/26-27/36

15.06.2026 Due Date : 14.00 :
SI. No. : 4, Tender No. : 14265013, Brief Description: 10 KVA/25 KV/240V, 1-Phase, Oil Type Auxiliary Transformer compatible, Quantity: 234 Nos. Due Date : 15.06.2026, Due Date : 14.00 :
SI. No. : 5, Tender No. : 14255052, Brief Description: 21.6/30.24 MVA, 132/27 KV, Traction Power Transformer, Quantity: 3 Set. Due Date : 22.06.2026. Due Date : 14.00 :
Note: All the above-mentioned tenders are e-tenders and all tenders are requested to submit their bids on-line through the IREPS website at www.ireps.gov.in.
 All corrigendum to above-mentioned tenders shall also be published online in IREPS website only. For more details regarding the above-mentioned tenders and other supply tenders please visit IREPS website.
AMM-cum Secy to PCMM E.C. Railway, Hajipur
PR/0287/HQ/ST/026-27/52

Telecom), East Central Railway, Danapur Division, for and on behalf of President of India and invites tenders on web portal www.ireps.gov.in for the following work:-
 1. Name of work with its location: Provision of RDSO approved make of aspirating type fire alarm system for replacing Non-RDSO Fire alarm system at 30 station under Danapur Division.,
 2. Approximate cost of work : Rs.30437104.00, 3. Earnest Money: Rs. 6088000.00, 4. Last Date & Time of Submission: Up to 15.00 hrs. on 15.06.2026, 5. Opening of tender: 15.00 hrs. on 15.06.2026, 6. Website: Particulars where detail of the work and criteria can be seen : www.ireps.gov.in, 7. Address of the office from where detail information can be obtained: Sr. Divl. Signal & Telecommunication Engineer, East Central Railway, Danapur
Note: Any Corrigendum if required will be uploaded on above website before 14 days.
Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer
East Central Railway, Danapur
PR/0286/DNR/ST/021/26-27/36

of Jammu and Kashmir
ENGINEER PMGSY (JKRRDA) JAMMU.
BIDDING e-TENDERS
816 of 2026-27 Dated:- 22/05/2026

U.T.Govt, CPWD, Railways or equivalent and other State/U.T.Govts up to 1700 Hrs.

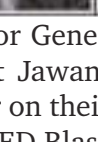
(Rs. Crores)	Total (Rs. In Lacs)	Cost of Documents (Rs. In Lacs)	Bid Security (EMD) @2% of total cost rounded to the nearest thousand (Rs. In Lacs)	Time Allowed for completion	Call of tender	Time and date of opening of technical bids	Class of Contractor
	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
01	1633.65	0.20	32.67	17 months	1st	17-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
10	770.87	0.10	15.42	11 months	1st		
71	1265.15	0.20	25.30	15 months	1st		
10	716.92	0.10	14.34	11 months	1st	17-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
34	1597.64	0.20	31.95	16 months	1st		
55	1668.00	0.20	33.36	17 Months	1st		
46	721.76	0.10	14.44	11 months	1st		
76	1603.32	0.20	32.07	17 months	1st		
59	1412.05	0.20	28.24	16 months	1st	17-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
69	3168.38	0.20	63.37	25 months	1st		
33	2259.00	0.20	45.18	20 months	1st		
28	989.40	0.10	19.79	12 months	1st	17-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
71	1872.70	0.20	37.45	18 months	1st		
24	1272.35	0.20	25.45	15 months	1st		
90	1024.71	0.20	20.49	15 months	1st		

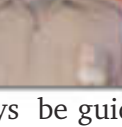
Date	Time
25-05-2026	1700 hrs
25-05-2026	1855 hrs
29-05-2026	1200 hrs
30-05-2026	1000 hrs
15-06-2026	1700 hrs
17-06-2026	1100 hrs

To be notified after technical evaluation is completed

document(SBD),
ersjk.gov.in

Chief Engineer PMGSY (JKRRDA) Jammu
For and on behalf of The Government
of Jammu and Kashmir

SALUTE THE SOLDIER BORDER SECURITY FORCE	
	CONSTABLE B K DAS 162 BN BSF 03.04.1969 – 26.05.2002
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable B K Das, on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries during counter part firing in area of Sunderbani, J&K and made supreme sacrifice in the line of duty.	
	SH VICKRAM ANAND LAL, ASSISTANT COMMANDANT 75 BN BSF 03.05.1968 – 26.05.1995
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Officer Sh Vickram Anand Lal, Assistant Commandant, on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries in an IED Blast in area of BOP Chinaz, Jammu and made supreme sacrifice in the line of duty.	
	SH S S YADAV DEPUTY COMMANDANT 171 BN BSF 20.06.1962 – 26.05.1999
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Officer Sh. S S Yadav, Deputy Commandant on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries during counter part firing in area of Chenenigund, J&K and made supreme sacrifice in the line of duty.	
	HEAD CONSTABLE TOMAS SORANG 181 BN BSF 03.06.1952 – 26.05.1999
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans Head Constable Tomas Sorang and Constable Kamal Kumar on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal injuries in an IED Blast, triggered by militants in area of Bindi, Rajouri, Jammu and made supreme sacrifice in the line of duty.	
	CONSTABLE KAMAL KUMAR 181 BN BSF 15.03.1969 – 26.05.1999
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Kamal Kumar, on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries in an IED Blast, triggered by militants in area of Bindi, Rajouri, Jammu and made supreme sacrifice in the line of duty.	

	GURMEET SINGH, PMG 132 BN BSF 12.04.1958 – 26.05.1991	Security Force remember its gallant Jawan, Lance Naik Gurmeet Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries during a counter terror operation in area of Kupwara, J&K. He fought bravely and made supreme sacrifice in the line of duty. His sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding him with PMG (Posthumously).
GORKHA RIFLES		
LNK RAM KUMAR PRADHAN		
	On this day 9419439P LNK Ram Kumar Pradhan of 1/11 Gorkha Rifles (BATALLIK) in a true act of valour made the supreme sacrifice during "OP VIJAY" on 26 May 1999. The brave soldier will always be remembered for his raw courage and indomitable spirit. To this braveheart we pledge that we shall always be guided by his immortal spirit and make his name proud.	
INDO-TIBETAN BORDER POLICE(ITBP)		
CONSTABLE JAVID ALI KHAN		
	ITBP salutes its braveheart Constable Javid Ali Khan of 24th Battalion, who made the supreme sacrifice in the line of duty on this day in Jammu & Kashmir in 1996.	
Constable Ramu Lal Raigar		
	ITBP salutes its braveheart Constable Ramu Lal Raigar of 23th Bn & further attached with 19th Bn, who made	

the supreme sacrifice in the line of duty on this day in Jammu & Kashmir in 1997.

कायालय नगरपालिका पारषद् तिल्दा नेवरा जिला-सयपुर (छ.ग.)
 Email - npalika_tilda@yahoo.in
 No/139/N.P / Pwd/2026-27 Tilda-Neora Date-25.05.2026

// ई-प्रोक्युरमेंट निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना //
e-Procurement Tender Notice (3rd Call)

System Tender No. :- 191417

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Physical Doc. Submission:- 12.06.2026 at 4:30 P.M.

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Delhi

‘Want to score 200 in a T20’: Sooryavanshi on his next goal

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 25

MOST YOUNG cricketers dream of scoring their first T20 century. Vaibhav Sooryavanshi is already thinking far beyond that. In a candid chat with former England captain Kevin Pietersen on *The Switch*, the youngster revealed an ambition that instantly grabbed attention – he wants to score 200 in a T20 innings and break Chris Gayle’s iconic record of 175*.

What made the moment memorable wasn’t just the scale of the dream, but how casually and confidently he spoke about it. The conversation began with Pietersen asking whether he enjoyed celebrating half-centuries. Sooryavanshi’s response was short, almost dismissive. “No, not that much.”

Revealing mindset

That single line revealed plenty about his mindset. For him, fifty runs aren’t an achievement to celebrate — they’re only the beginning.

Pietersen then asked whether he preferred batting first or chasing in T20 cricket. Once again, the youngster kept it simple. “Anything, but I want to score 200 in T20.”

Even in today’s era of explosive batting, a T20 double century still feels almost unimaginable. The highest individual score in men’s T20 cricket remains Gayle’s unforgettable unbeaten 175 during the 2013 IPL season.

Pietersen quickly reminded him of that milestone. “So Chris Gayle’s got 175.”

But Sooryavanshi didn’t hesitate. “Yeah, I want to break his record. I want to score 200.”

Pietersen, clearly amused and impressed by the youngster’s attitude, wrapped up the interaction by telling him that sessions like these would help prepare him for achieving such milestones. Meanwhile, Sooryavanshi’s IPL franchise strengthened the mood around the camp by securing a place in the IPL 2026 playoffs after a 30-run win over Mumbai Indians on Sunday.

INDIAN PREMIER LEAGUE: QUALIFIER 1

How Bengaluru learned to win without changing themselves

Preparation, clarity, composure transformed RCB from perennial chaos merchants into most complete outfit, now comes the test against GT

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, May 25

BHUVNESHWAR KUMAR has been bowling in the IPL for sixteen years. The action has not changed. The wrist position, the seam held upright, the slight adjustment that makes the ball go in or out — none of it has changed. What has changed is that batsmen have had sixteen years to study it and still cannot pick it. At 36, leading the Purple Cap standings with 24 wickets in fourteen matches, he is having the best wicket-taking season of his career. The numbers do not explain it. The action does.

Mo Bobat explains it differently. “He’s brilliant with the new ball, can turn a game in the middle overs, and is excellent at the death,” RCB’s Director of Cricket says. “He’s got attacking skills and defensive skills.” Then he adds, almost as an aside: “I think alongside Bumrah, he’s probably the standout fast bowler in India.” It is the kind of thing people say and don’t mean. Bobat appears to mean it.

But the more revealing thing Bobat says about Bhuvneshwar has nothing to do with wickets. “When the young boys see him operate, see how calm he is, see how clear he is, see the level of preparation that goes into things, they’ll just be copying that — in the same way that people copy the way Virat goes about his business, or Rajat or Krunal.” He is not someone overly expressive, Bobat notes. He leads by example. Six three-wicket hauls this season. A four-wicket spell in Raipur, followed by a match-winning six in the final over with the bat. Example upon example.

Rajat Patidar, the captain, operates in the same register. When Bobat is asked whether it surprised him to see Patidar win the IPL in his first season leading the side, he almost dismisses the question.

“No, not at all. We went into the season knowing we’re good enough to win the competition.” The credit he volunteers is for something quieter. “Rajat hasn’t changed at all. That’s probably the biggest thing I’d give him credit for.”

In an environment where IPL captaincy can remake a player’s public identity overnight, staying unchanged is harder than it sounds. This season Patidar has made 326 runs in ten innings at a strike rate of 195. His record-breaking hundredth IPL six — faster than any Indian before him, only Russell and Pooran quicker all-time — arrived during a losing chase against SRH last week, on a night when securing a top-two finish mattered more than the scoreline. He understood the difference.

Devdutt Padikkal’s transformation has been less visible but no less deliberate. He returned to RCB at the auction as a player who had drifted through three franchises in three years, managing 38 runs across seven innings for Lucknow last season. What RCB offered him was unusual: they would not judge him on volume. “We are going to judge him on the impact he has for the team,” Bobat says. “And as soon as he heard that, I think he probably felt quite liberated.”

Whether liberation has a measurable strike rate is debatable. Between Dinesh Karthik and Andy Flower, the work on his strengths and how he could put pressure on the opposition



Bhuvneshwar Kumar, 36, is leading the Purple Cap standings with 24 wickets in fourteen matches. CREIMAS

was precise. Padikkal made 247 runs in 10 games before injury interrupted his season. It was not the runs that told the story. It was the manner of them.

‘Aggressive’ Kohli

Virat Kohli, at 281 appearances the most capped player in IPL history, still attracts the question about method — whether the conventional can survive in a format built for the unconventional. Bobat is impatient with it.

“I would say he’s batting very aggressively. He’s consistently been striking above 150 or 160 most of the time. He’s doing his job. He’s leading from the front. He’s finding moments to apply pressure, but he’s also good enough to absorb pressure when we need to.”

Then, with a finality that closes the subject: “That’s what happens when you’ve got a champion player.”

Bobat had come to RCB

with structural questions that nobody else was asking. He found clarity where there had been noise, and built the conditions for everything that followed. Nine wins from fourteen matches, top of the table. On workload, the one problem that remains, he is honest. “I don’t think workload management is going to solve it. Cricket needs to probably do a better job of its schedule.” The T20 specialist, he observes, now has a career shaped less like a cricketer’s and more like a tennis player’s or a golfer’s. “They’re almost self-employed. They move from event to event, travelling around the world.”

On Tuesday, in the first qualifier against Gujarat Titans, Bhuvneshwar Kumar will run in, seam upright, wrist in the same position it has been for sixteen years. The batsmen may hit him. In T20 cricket, they usually try. But they will not pick it.



“When the young boys see him operate, see how clear he is, see the level of preparation that goes into things, they’ll just be copying that — in the same way that people copy the way Virat goes about his business.”

MO BOBAT,
ON BHUVNESHWAR KUMAR

Where a total of 200 isn’t safe: Dharamsala’s real test for RCB, GT

Express News Service
Chennai, May 25

WHEN PUNJAB Kings moved their base to Dharamsala, there were fears that the conditions could severely hamper their progress to the play-offs. As it played out, in all three matches they were out-batted by their opponents as totals of 200 became the norm.

As Royal Challengers Bengaluru and Gujarat Titans square off with the Dhauladhar ranges in the background, here is what they would encounter.

Chasing the best

In both the night fixtures, though teams batting first posted over 200, there were periods where the bowlers were

in the game early on. Thanks to the daytime temperatures, the dry surface made for the odd ball to hold.

But as the game wore on and temperatures dipped, the strip settled down, allowing batsmen to play their shots more freely.

Delhi Capitals, despite being 49/3 at the end of the powerplay chasing 211, won the game with an over to spare. Given how effective both these teams are with the ball in the powerplay, there is still scope for the opposition to find a way back, particularly in the chase.

Help for spinners In their first match, both Punjab and Delhi did not bowl a single over of spin. With short boundaries and high altitude allowing the



200-plus totals have become a norm at the HPCA Stadium. CREIMAS

ball to travel, teams overlooked the dryness of the surface.

In the next game, Mumbai and Punjab did lean on the

spinners in the middle overs, though they went for runs. This being the fourth match at the venue, there could be more as-

Number Plate

For Gujarat Titans, the playing conditions in Dharamsala may be unfamiliar as they have never played a match at the HPCA Stadium from the time they joined the IPL in 2022.

stance on offer.

Plan A for seamers

The pitches in Dharamsala tend to have bounce, and pace on that surface usually means runs will flow.

While the likes of Kagiso Rabada, Bhuvneshwar Kumar, Josh Hazlewood and Mo-

ammed Siraj would enjoy the seam movement, these skillful pacers would rely heavily on cutters. Those cutters and slower balls have been hard to score off, as the bounce on the surface produces a spongy effect.

The match-up Both teams excel in the powerplay with the ball. GT have taken 30 wickets in the powerplay, while RCB have 28.

How well the top orders of both sides cope when tested with challenging lengths in the powerplay could well determine the outcome. For the record, this will be Gujarat’s first outing at Dharamsala.

Playing tonight: RCB vs GT, 7.30pm, Live on Jio Hotstar and Star Sports Network

Gujarat Titans take unfashionable route to qualifier

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, May 25

KAGISO RABADA runs in with the new ball, seam held upright, presenting it at an angle that belongs in a Test match. The length is fuller than T20 batsmen expect, the line tighter, and when the ball pitches it moves either way off the surface. The bounce arrives chest-high. Modern T20 batting is built for pace and yorkers. Rabada offers seam and length. Seventeen of his twenty-four wickets this season have come in the first six overs. The batsmen cannot find rhythm against something they were not prepared to face.

In IPL 2026, the powerplay scoring rate has reached 10.47 runs per over. Teams chase sixes. Gujarat Titans chose something else. Shubman Gill and B Sai Sudharsan open together but don’t slog and do not provide high-flying starts. Gill was dropped from India’s T20 World Cup squad at the eleventh hour because his approach did not fit the current era. Sudharsan, a bright batting prospect in Tests, has not replicated that form in the shortest format. Most T20 outfits would not pair such openers together. Gujarat’s think-tank, led by Ashish Nehra, did exactly that.

“We knew what we had in the middle order,” Nehra says. “It wasn’t going to give us fireworks. So the top three had to do the work. But we weren’t going to ask them to be something they’re not.”

Gill and Sudharsan are solid. In the powerplay, they average 58 runs, the best among all teams and the only partnership above 50. Their strike rate is 151.09, seventh-highest in the league. They have hit 31 sixes in the phase, second-lowest. Vaibhav Suryavanshi alone has hit 37. The numbers describe a choice: establish the base, then expand. Gill has made 616 runs this season. Sudharsan leads the tournament with 638. The work gets done without announcement.

Gujarat’s middle-order strike rate in the death overs is 158.41, the lowest among all teams. It is a reflection of what they do not have. The top order does not hand over momentum. It carries the innings through. When opposition bowlers come hard at Gill and Sudharsan, expecting them to crack under pressure, they absorb it. Calculated aggression, not recklessness.

The bowling follows the same philosophy. Since 2024, Gujarat have used a seamer who bowls Test-match lengths and probes batsmen with movement. Mohammed Shami did it in the past. This season, Rabada has taken up the role. With Mohammed Siraj and Prasidh Krishna as second and third seam options, the plan is simple: unleash Rabada when the ball is hard and new.

The hard ball generates bounce. The seam moves it either way. Rabada’s pace means batsmen cannot settle into a rhythm. When they try to



GT’s Kagiso Rabada, who has been most effective in the powerplay, has dismissed Kohli five times in 16 innings. CREIMAS

Gill and Sudharsan are solid. In the powerplay, they average 58 runs, the best among all teams and the only partnership above 50.

go hard at him, his response is predictable but effective: the short ball, throat-high. Virat Kohli fell to it. So did Urvil Patel. Gujarat have not hesitated to use three of Rabada’s overs in the powerplay itself.

Mohammed Siraj complements him from the other end. Thirteen powerplay wickets. Pressure from both sides means T20 batsmen, built for aggression, have no space to attack. They cannot find the boundary. They cannot rotate strike. The rhythm never arrives.

With Rashid Khan to bowl in the middle overs, Gujarat’s powerplay wickets mean teams cannot embrace an all-out attack. Even on bad days, they keep totals within range. In fourteen matches this season, only twice have they been out of the game with the ball.

The philosophy is clarity. Do not chase what others are chasing. Identify what you have. Build around it. In a format that rewards six-hitting, they chose accumulation. In a phase where teams go at 10.47 runs per over, they went at 151. In an era of yorkers and pace, they bowled seam and length.

Nine wins in fourteen matches. Top two finish secured. Gill and Sudharsan have done the work at the top. Rabada and Siraj have dismantled opposition powerplays. The middle order has held when needed. It is not the loudest approach. It is the one that has worked. RCB await in Qualifier 1 at Dharamsala. The head-to-head record this season is 1-1. On Tuesday, Rabada will run in with the new ball, seam held upright, presenting it at an angle that belongs in a Test match. The RCB batsmen will face what sixteen other teams have faced this season: seam and bounce when they expected pace and yorkers. Whether they pick it better than the others remains the only question that matters.

{ FRENCH OPEN }

Emotional Wawrinka bids farewell to Roland Garros

Reuters
Paris, May 25

SWISS STAN Wawrinka made his final French Open appearance in a 6-3 3-6 6-3 6-4 loss to Dutchman Jesper de Jong on Monday before departing Roland Garros to a standing ovation and loud applause that reflected the enduring affection for the 2015 champion.

The 41-year-old, who made his Grand Slam breakthrough at the Australian Open by winning the 2014 title before adding trophies at the French Open and the U.S. Open in subsequent years, is set to end his storied playing career later this season.

He delighted fans with a run to the Melbourne third round earlier this year, but there was to be no extended farewell in Paris after lucky loser De Jong cruised through the first set and held his nerve to prevail after a mid-match blip.

“Thank you all. It’s hard, I don’t want to say goodbye to you here,” Wawrinka said, before thanking tournament director Amelie Mauresmo and French Tennis Federation chief Gilles Moretton. “It’s thanks to tournaments like this one that I dreamed of becoming a tennis player. I grew up with the goal of competing here one day. It was an amazing experience to be able to share this moment here on court. Well done to Jesper for the match.”

Fans on Court Simonne Mathieu chanted Wawrinka’s name and cheered when he unleashed winners and erupted after the Swiss levelled the clash at one set apiece, but De Jong was soon on the front foot again.

The world number 106, who only advanced to the main draw after Frenchman Arthur Fils’ withdrawal through injury, bagged the third set after an early arm-wrestle and de-



Stanislas Wawrinka reacts after losing to Jesper de Jong. AP

livered the knockout blow in a tight fourth set. “It’s not about me today,” the 25-year-old De Jong said. “A funny story about Stan, he played my coach when I was a ball kid. I don’t want to say he’s old. But it’s all about Stan today, especially the way he fought.”

• ORDER OF PLAY

COURT PHILIPPE-CHATRIER: 1-Aryna Sabalenka (Belarus) v Jessica Bouzas Maneiro (Spain); 4-Coco Gauff (U.S.) v Taylor Townsend (U.S.); 1-Jannik Sinner (Italy) v Clement Tabur (France)

COURT SUZANNE LENGLEN: Adam Walton (Australia) v 6-Daniil Medvedev (Russia); 4-Felix Auger-Aliassime (Canada) v Daniel Altmaier (Germany)

After a short video tribute played on the big screen, an emotional Wawrinka hailed fans for making his final appearance in Paris special.

“Three hours of emotion, three hours of battle thanks to you, thanks to the support you’ve given me all these years,” Wawrinka added.

“I wanted to keep going, to go as far as possible until I was

41 to experience emotions like today. I’ve been lucky enough to experience them for a very long time. You never want to say goodbye when you’re passionate about something.

“I know it was the end; I gave everything for this sport, and I know it’s the right choice. I would have loved to be back here, in front of you but unfortunately this was my last match at Roland Garros.”

A second tribute followed shortly afterwards, with Roger Federer, Rafa Nadal, Novak Djokovic, Carlos Alcaraz, Jannik Sinner and Gael Monfils all celebrating Wawrinka’s career.

Djokovic survives scare

Novak Djokovic survived an opening round scare to beat Giovanni Mpetshi Perricard 5-7, 5-6, 6-1, 6-4 in the first round. He broke the record with his 82nd appearance in the men’s singles main draw, surpassing

Heat wave changes clay courts, playing conditions turn faster

Associated Press
Paris, May 25

TENNIS PLAYERS at the French Open say they haven’t experienced conditions this hot at Roland Garros since the Paris Olympics. And the 2024 Olympics were held in July and August. Temperatures for the opening two days of the clay-court Grand Slam have soared to 33 degrees C (91 F) - far beyond normal for late May in the French capital. And it’s forecast to stay that way for the entire first week.

Besides making it uncomfortable for fans and players alike, the sultry conditions have also created faster conditions on court — changing the pace of the game.

“It’s much different. Maybe it was that hot in the Olympics but the balls were different, so



Spectators cool themselves with water from sprinklers. AP

I wouldn’t treat it as the same tournament,” four-time French Open champion Iga Swiatek said after routing Emerson Jones 6-1, 6-2 in the first round on Monday.

Players have been putting bags of ice around their necks on changeovers to stay cool, while fans are refreshing themselves under sprinklers. When

workers water the clay courts between sets, they have taken to directing their hoses at spectators begging to be doused, too. “I don’t remember the last time it was so hot at Roland Garros,” Russian-born Australian player Daria Kasatkina said after beating Zeynep Sonmez 6-4, 6-4. “Maybe one day. But we’re going to have it for the whole week.” Kasatkina said the energy-sapping temperatures made for more up-and-down matches.

“You can suddenly just get out of the bench and feel that your focus dropped,” she said. “So this is a battle which you have to also win. ” Whoever adapts better to today’s conditions gets it.”

The French Open is usually cool compared to the traditional heat at the Australian Open and U.S. Open.

Messi latest injury concern before 2026 FIFA World Cup



Lionel Messi. AP

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 25

DAYS BEFORE the 2026 FIFA World Cup begins, Argentina have been given an almighty scare with their captain Lionel Messi walking off injured during an Inter Miami match and casting doubts over his fitness ahead of what could be his final World Cup.

Messi kitted out for Miami against Philadelphia – his final game for his American club before joining the Argentine national team camp ahead of the World Cup. Around the 70th minute, Messi started to clutch his thigh. Then after a freekick in the 73rd minute, the diagnosis was immediate by the maestro – there would be no more playing. Signalling to be substituted, the fear that Messi might have picked up an injury grew.

But after the match, Inter Miami manager Guillermo Hoyos allayed most of those fears and said that his substitution was precautionary and that Messi had some muscle fatigue and the call in the situation was to give him rest.

"We have no information indicating any injury. He was truly fatigued; it was just fatigue," the manager stated. "He was tired, and the pitch was heavy. When in doubt, it's always best not to take risks," Hoyos added.

Injury list grows

Argentina coach Lionel Scaloni has yet to announce the 26-man Argentina team to defend their World Cup crown but it's understood that Messi will be part of the proceedings. The Argentine attacker has taken a limited role at his club in the MLS and has preserved himself over the last four years to make it to the 2026 World Cup. This World Cup will also see Neymar and Cristiano Ronaldo be a part of the Brazil and Portugal squads, marking what could possibly be the last FIFA WC where the trio are present.

Argentina start their defense on June 16 against Algeria and are in a tough group alongside Jordan and Austria. Kylian Mbappé and Mohamed Salah have recovered from injuries ahead of the tournament co-hosted by the United States, Canada and Mexico. Lamine Yamal missed the final weeks of the season for Barcelona because of a muscle injury in his left leg but should be healed in time to play at the World Cup.

Others have not been so fortunate. France striker Hugo Ekitike sustained an Achilles injury in April that could take more than six months to heal, ruling him out of the tournament. So is Germany forward Serge Gnabry after injuring his adductor in training.

FEDERATION CUP

From medium-pace to 20.46m: Gill crosses shot put's barrier

In Ranchi, a cricketer-turned-shot-putter defeated national record holder, broke the 20m mark for the first time

Prithish Raj
Ranchi, May 25

THE FIRST three throws were wrong. Samardeep Singh Gill was not getting enough height on the ball, and his coach Sandeep Singh could see exactly why. Between throws, he pulled Samardeep aside and told him one thing: raise your hand a little while rotating in the circle. Samardeep went back, adjusted, and threw 20.46m.

The first time in his career he had crossed the mark he had been chasing for over a year. He then threw beyond 20m twice more. By the end of the night he had won gold at the National Inter-State Athletics Championships in Ranchi, defeated national record holder Tajinderpal Singh Toor, and qualified for the Commonwealth Games. Three things, one evening, one small adjustment.

"I think crossing 20m is about mindset," Samardeep said afterwards. "Your body will fail you at times but your mind will always stay with you. Now that I have crossed the mark, I think the mark will improve for me."

The journey to that throw began not in a shot put circle but on a cricket ground. Samardeep bowled medium pace and played till district level. When his father Mahender Singh Gill was posted in Ratlam, he wanted his son to stay fit and started sending him to the Railways ground. A coach named Jagminder was there. There was a shot put lying around. Samardeep picked it up.

The early years were not straightforward. An ankle injury during his junior career set him back badly. "He didn't have great technique and while rotating in the circle, his ankle got injured," his current coach Sandeep Singh said. "But after surgery, he came to train under me and that's when his journey towards excellence started."

The improvement under Sandeep was rapid. By 2024 Samardeep had crossed 19m for the first time. The following year came his first statement win —

at the Inter-State Championships, he threw 19.82m, a personal best at the time, and defeated Toor for the first time. It announced him as a serious presence in an event that had, for years, belonged to one man.

Toor has dominated Indian shot put for the better part of a decade. He holds the national record of 21.77m, set in 2023, and is a two-time Asian Games champion. For years, no one came close consistently — Karanveer Singh showed promise but could not sustain it. Toor came into Ranchi with a season best of 21.03m — not a faded force, but a man being challenged seriously for the first time. On Sunday he finished second with 20.07m.

Samardeep, who has studied and admired him throughout his own career, was careful about how he framed the victory. "I don't see Tajinder paaji as competition. I get motivated looking at him. There is no one who has the centre of balance like him."

Then he added something that speaks to the unusual dynamic between them: "During my throws, he keeps motivating me and telling me to do better. Whenever I compete with him, his coach keeps giving me suggestions on where to improve."

At 6 feet 5 inches, Samardeep has the frame for the event. "That gives him a lot of reach and his body is apt for shot put," his coach Sandeep said. The ceiling, he believes, is distant. "There are technical adjustments like improving his movement in the circle — we will work on that."

With Toor absent from the Commonwealth Games squad, Samardeep will carry India's shot put hopes at the Games. "I am happy it will give me a chance to represent my country. I will try my best to improve my personal best and win a medal there," he said. It is a significant ask for an athlete who, earlier this year, had not yet thrown beyond 19.82m.

The hand was a little higher. The ball travelled a little further. Sometimes that is all it takes.



Samardeep Singh Gill played cricket till the district level and was a medium pacer. AFI

Javelin throwers miss modest Commonwealth Games mark

Prithish Raj
Ranchi, May 25

AFTER THREE days of record-breaking action at the Federation Cup in Ranchi, the finale turned out to be a let-down, with the javelin throw event not living up to expectations.

Despite six throwers with personal bests of over 80m and the presence of Asian Games silver medallist Kishore Kumar Jena, World Championships finalist Sachin Yadav, and Rohit Yadav, the event was subdued, with youngster Shivam Lohakare winning the competition with a new personal best of 81.71m.

The major shock came when none of the throwers breached 82.61m, the Commonwealth Games benchmark. Shivam's effort was the only positive in the competition as he threw four 80m+ throws while favourite Sachin (79.4m) failed to touch the



Shivam Lohakare won the Javelin event with a best of 81.71m, below the 82.61 that was set as the CWG games benchmark. AFI

80m mark.

While Sachin tried multiple things to counter the wind, like throwing a flat throw and giving a lot of flight to the javelin, but nothing worked for him on the night. "An athlete can have an off day. I don't think it would derail him. We will do better at

the Inter-State," his coach, Naval Singh, said.

"The wind was a little inconsistent today, but we can't keep it as an excuse. I had prepared well for the event, but despite four 80m marks, I think I didn't execute my plans well. I think I'm learning competition by competition," Shivam said after the event.

With Neeraj Chopra not starting his season yet and none of the throwers breaching the CWG qualification mark, it puts the Athletics Federation of India in a fix.

CWG organisers have asked every country to send only a 32-member contingent for Athletics with 16 male and 16 female athletes. "Selection committee will meet tonight, and we will get to know. Javelin Throw is a prestigious event, and India has always done well there. It will be a shame if we don't have anyone there," an AFI official said on condition of anonymity.

Salah signs off with assist in emotional Liverpool exit

Reuters
Liverpool, May 25

MOHAMED SALAH may not have got the goal he wanted to end his nine-year spell at Liverpool, but the Egyptian did manage an assist before making an emotional departure as his side secured a 1-1 Premier League draw at home to Brentford and a fifth-place finish that ensured Champions League football next season.

Included in the starting team despite recently criticising the playing style of coach Arne Slot, Salah looked lively throughout and smacked a free kick off a post in the first half before teeing

up Curtis Jones with the outside of his left foot to give the home side the lead in the 58th minute.

In doing so, he recorded his 93rd assist for Liverpool, breaking Steven Gerrard's record of 92.

Salah's replacement 16 minutes later prompted a tidal wave of emotion on Merseyside, his eyes filling with tears as he embraced teammates, the crowd singing his name loudly as he made his way to the sideline for the final time, stopping only to drop to his knees for a brief prayer.

"I think I cried more than in my whole life. I'm not really an emotional guy. We lived our



Mohamed Salah (above) and Andy Robertson both played their final games for Liverpool on Sunday. REUTERS

youth here, sharing everything from the beginning to the end. We put this club back where it belongs," Salah told Sky Sports.

Robertson farewell

There was more emotion in the 83rd minute as left back Andy Robertson, signed in the same transfer window as Salah, also took his leave of Liverpool, and the crowd gave the Scottish defender a loud ovation as he was replaced by Milos Kerkez.

The game over and Champions League football secured, the Liverpool players and staff formed a guard of honour for the departing players, and there

were more tears as their titles and achievements in red were read out over the PA system.

Salah stayed on the field long after the final whistle, wringing every bit of emotion out of his last appearance before addressing his departure.

"It's life. I look back and wonder if I would have wanted more than I achieved, (and) not really - we won it all, we see the love from the fans, and this is the most important thing for me," he said.

"I will be far away from here. I will be emotional every time (I visit), I hope the team stays in the position, fighting for everything."

NORWAY CHESS

Carlsen, Gukesh and the press conference that chess needed

Amit Kamath
Oslo, May 25

MAGNUS CARLSEN heard the question — would Gukesh make him slam the table in anger again by beating him — and burst out laughing. On his right, the teenager who now holds the world champion's title tried to hold a straight face for a few seconds, exchanged a glance with Praggnanandhaa beside him, and gave up. The room at the Thon Opera Hotel in Oslo had been waiting for a press conference like this for a long time. Chess, it turns out, had been waiting longer.

A year ago, at the same pre-tournament press conference before Norway Chess 2025, a reporter had asked the 12 grandmasters on the dais how boring they found press conferences. Nobody wanted to answer. They exchanged glances. Eventually Hikaru Nakamura, the most outspoken of them,

admitted the truth: very boring. This year was different.

The mood shifted with every question. One minute the grandmasters were giggling about challenges set by the Norway Chess social media team. The next, Carlsen, Gukesh and Ju Wenjun — three world champions across formats, sharing a dais — were peeling back something they rarely show. The question that unlocked it was simple: what has been the hardest thing about being world champion?

Carlsen went first. He has won the title five times and walked away from it four years ago, a decision that still baffles the chess world. What he said explained something about why.

"The hardest thing about being a world champion was that there were a lot of expectations of me to find the world championship as important as the others did," he said. "I never



GMs ahead of Norway Chess' opener. MICHAL WALLUSZA / NORWAY CHESS

really felt that way. I felt like I was doing it a lot for others rather than for myself. The motivation didn't come from within a lot of the time."

He paused, then went further. "Having so much of my identity — in other people's eyes

and, to some extent, my own eyes — connected to just that one thing that I didn't even completely like was difficult. I guess that is a personal problem. But that's one of the reasons why I'm not a part of that at all."

Then it was Gukesh's turn.

The hardest thing about being a world champion was that there were a lot of expectations of me to find the World Championship as important as the others did. I never really felt that way."

MAGNUS CARLSEN
ON WHY HE STOPPED COMPETING AT THE CLASSICAL WORLDS

The boy who became the youngest world champion at 18 has since struggled for form, drawing criticism from Carlsen and Garry Kasparov among others. For once, he did not deflect it.

"I think everybody underestimates the pressure and ex-

pectations that come with being a world champion," he said. "Sometimes I have struggled to deal with these expectations. But it also gave me a chance to grow and build character."

In a sport where stoicism is the professional default, the two world champions had just found common ground in something neither usually admits: that the crown is heavier than it looks.

The conference ended the way only a Carlsen press conference can. Asked how hungry he was to win Norway Chess for a record eighth time, he smiled. He had been on holiday in Spain before flying to Oslo, he noted. Then: "As for hunger, I think I'll find hunger when I see the meal in front of me."

Chess rarely does press conferences. After Monday in Oslo, it should reconsider.

(THE WRITER IS IN OSLO AT THE INVITATION OF NORWAY CHESS)

BRIEFLY



Lakshya Sen will look to bounce back from his Thailand open exit. FILE

Lakshya, Sindhu lead Indian challenge at Singapore Open

LAKSHYA SEN and PV Sindhu will look to regain consistency and end their title drought when they spearhead the country's challenge at the USD 1,000,000 Singapore Open Super 750 tournament beginning on Tuesday. Lakshya, who won the Australia Open last November, will hope to bounce back from last week's first-round exit and make a deep run when he opens his campaign against China's Lu Guang Zu. In women's singles Sindhu will begin her campaign against Indonesia's 5th seed Putri Kusuma Wardani. PTI

Akshay, Vicky win gold in Asian U23 freestyle

INDIA CONTINUED their impressive run at the U23 Wrestling Asian Championships with Akshay T Dhere and Vicky claiming gold medals on Monday. Akshay set the tone in the 57kg by edging past Kazakhstan's Yelaman Amangeldi with a gritty 4-2 victory. Vicky soon doubled the joy in the 97kg division, pulling off a 7-5 win against Uzbekistan's Sherzod Poyonov to secure the top spot on the podium. PTI

Spain leave out Madrid players from WC squad

EUROPEAN CHAMPIONS Spain will travel to next month's World Cup with plenty of Barcelona swagger but no-one from Real Madrid after manager Luis de la Fuente named a 26-man squad on Monday built around eight players from the Catalan club. It is the first time that Spain will go to a World Cup without a Real Madrid player in their squad, a striking absence for the 15-times UCL winners. REUTERS

Samrat and Babuta to lead Indian challenge

TWO FINALS in the men's 10m air pistol and 10m air rifle events are scheduled on the opening day of competitions at the Munich leg of the ISSF World Cup Rifle/Pistol with Samrat Rana and Arjun Babuta leading the Indian challenge. The India squad includes four debutants in the senior level — Suraj Sharma, Sakshi Padekar, Ajendra Singh Chauhan and Udhayveer Sidhu. PTI

Women's hockey team ready for Aus challenge

THE INDIAN women's hockey team would look to kickstart its preparations for the FIH Nations Cup on a positive note when it takes on Australia in the four-match series starting here on Tuesday. The Salima Tete-led side will aim to build vital momentum ahead of the crucial FIH Hockey Women's Nations Cup to be held in Auckland from June 15 to 21. PTI

Head's wife alleges abuse after Kohli tiff

TRAVIS HEAD'S wife, Jessica, has alleged that her social media feed has been flooded by abusive comments after her husband got embroiled in an on-field spat with Indian superstar Virat Kohli during an IPL match. Head's Sunrisers Hyderabad defeated Kohli's Royal Challengers Bengaluru by 55 runs in the game played in Hyderabad on Friday last week. PTI

Allegri fired by Milan as club miss out on UCL

AC MILAN have sacked manager Massimiliano Allegri following a late-season collapse that ownership branded an "unequivocal failure" after the club ended the season in fifth place and missed out on UCL qualification, the Serie A club said. The veteran coach was dismissed as part of a sweeping overhaul aimed at restructuring the club's football operations. REUTERS

Gukesh wants FIDE World C'ship in India

Amit Kamath
Oslo, May 25

IN LITTLE less than a week from now, the window for prospective host cities to bid for hosting the World Chess Championship will shut. And D Gukesh, the boy who will defend his crown from Javokhir Sindarov in November-December, thinks that playing a world championship match on Indian soil would be "a lot of fun."

"A World Championship match, if it's in India, it will be super cool," Gukesh said at the pre-tournament press conference on Sunday ahead of the first round of Norway Chess. "It will attract a lot of energy around it. I will be very happy to play a World Championship match in India."

Bid incoming

Reports from Tamil Nadu have indicated that the state government is preparing to bid for the upcoming World Championship in six months' time. FIDE has announced that the tentative slot for the 14-game battle royale will be from November 23 to December 17 later this year.

Playing a World Championship at home is treacherous



Playing a home World C'ship can be daunting, but D Gukesh has expressed his willingness. MICHAL WALLUSZA / NORWAY CHESS

business, one that has made former world champions like Magnus Carlsen and Viswanathan Anand baulk. Unlike other sports, many elite grandmasters do not believe that there's anything like home advantage when it comes to being in the cauldron of pressure that is a World Championship match.

But it was at the World Championship in Chennai where the ambitions of many of India's current lot were sparked. Gukesh was one of those whose dream of becoming a world champion someday was fuelled by witnessing the 2013 World Championship games from close quarters.